



AFTER A NEARLY TWO-YEAR SUSPENSION

## From Sunday, India will resume tourist visas for Bangladesh nationals: Trivedi

Envoy presents credentials in Dhaka, Delhi grants him Cabinet Minister status

**Divya A**  
*New Delhi, June 25*

MOVING TO improve bilateral relations, India Thursday announced the resumption of tourist visas for Bangladeshi nationals after a nearly two-year suspension.

The announcement was made by the newly appointed Indian High Commissioner to Bangladesh, Dinesh Trivedi, during a visit to the Indian Visa Application Centre (IVAC) in Dhaka.

Delhi suspended tourist visas for Bangladeshi nationals in August 2024 following political unrest and the ouster of the Sheikh Hasina-led government.

Trivedi announced that tourist visa applications will resume on June 28, at five visa centres, including the one in Dhaka.

This was his first announcement after presenting his credentials to the President of Bangladesh, Mohammed Shahabuddin, Thursday after-



Indian envoy to Bangladesh Dinesh Trivedi with President Mohammed Shahabuddin in Dhaka. @IHCDHAKA

THE EDITORIAL PAGE

MY ABSENCE IS NOT SILENCE. I WILL RETURN THROUGH THE STRENGTH OF THE PEOPLE

**SHEIKH HASINA WAZED,**  
FORMER BANGLADESH PM  
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noon, signalling that he has been tasked with repairing ties between the two countries.

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Rescue workers search through the rubble after powerful earthquakes in Caracas, Venezuela on Wednesday. AP MORE REPORTS, [PAGE 14](#)

## Thousands feared killed as twin quakes rock Venezuela, many trapped under rubble

Official toll 188 so far, USGS says may cross 10,000

**Vivian Sequera, Mayela Armas & Deisy Buitrago**  
*La Guaira, Caracas, June 25*

THOUSANDS OF Venezuelans were feared dead on Thursday after two powerful earthquakes, including the country's

strongest in over a century, wreaked havoc in and around the capital Caracas, trapping people beneath the rubble of collapsed buildings and setting off powerful aftershocks.

A magnitude 7.2 earthquake hit about 160 km west of Caracas on Wednesday evening, followed less than a minute later by a magnitude 7.5 tremor, according to the US Geological Survey (USGS).

The disaster struck a country already grappling with

**EXPLAINED** [PAGE 12](#)  
BEHIND EARTHQUAKE DEVASTATION: RARE 'SEISMIC DOUBLET', VULNERABLE LOCATION

years of economic turmoil that had left much of its infrastructure fragile, complicating rescue and recovery efforts. In some areas, emergency workers scrambled over the debris of collapsed buildings

through the evening and into Thursday. In others, residents decried a lack of help.

Jorge Rodriguez, who heads Venezuela's national assembly and is the brother of interim President Delcy Rodriguez, said at least 188 people were confirmed dead and 200 were trapped. He said 1,520 people were injured and at least 250 buildings had been damaged or destroyed.

The worst-affected area, »CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

## Happening today

● **UNION HOME** Minister Amit Shah will chair the 10th apex-level meeting of the Narco-Coordination Centre with focus on tackling the challenges posed by synthetic drugs, darknet-enabled trafficking and expanding the reach of rehabilitation centres.

● **ACCOMMODATING** VAIBHAV Sooryavanshi in the team will be the toughest riddle for the management when India step into a new T20 era under Shreyas Iyer in the first of a two-match series against Ireland.

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POLITICS [PAGE 6](#)



## NOT ME IN VIDEO, ACTOR WEARING MASK WITH MY FACE, SAYS MANN

EXPLAINED

IF PASSPORT IS NOT PROOF OF CITIZENSHIP, WHAT IS? [PAGE 12](#)

## Amazon ramps up AI, cloud infra investment in India, takes total to \$48 billion by 2030

'Aligns with democratising access to AI, digitising small businesses, creating jobs'



PM Narendra Modi with Amazon CEO Andy Jassy on Thursday. PTI

**George Mathew**  
*Mumbai, June 25*

STEPPING UP its investment plans in India, US e-commerce giant Amazon has proposed to invest an additional \$13 billion to expand artificial intelligence (AI) and cloud infrastructure in India, taking its total investment in the country to \$48 billion between 2026 and 2030.

In 2025, Amazon announced a \$35-billion investment across all its businesses in India. This additional \$13 billion, the company said, will expand AWS data centre capacity in Mumbai and Hyderabad,

giving startups, enterprises and government organisations access to custom AI chips, managed AI services, secure and reliable cloud technologies, and developer tools to innovate faster, scale further and serve customers globally.

The announcement came after Amazon CEO Andy Jassy met Prime Minister Narendra Modi in New Delhi Thursday. Jassy highlighted the growing importance of India, where Amazon operates several businesses including e-commerce, AI and cloud, and entertainment among others, in his

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

## BJP defends MP CM, silent on his firm buying land, 4-fold jump since 2021

Firm where Mohan Yadav, wife Seema hold 73% bought at least 2.6 acres for Rs 1.43 cr after he became Chief Minister

**Express News Service**  
*New Delhi, Bhopal, June 25*

AS THE Congress stepped up its attack on Madhya Pradesh Chief Minister Mohan Yadav over *The Indian Express* investigation on land purchases by his family and their real estate firms, national convener of the BJP's IT cell Amit Malviya, BJP state president Hemant Khandelwal and ministers of the Madhya Pradesh government

dismissed the allegations as "baseless... bereft of substance" and "politically motivated."

However, the party is silent on the investigation's key findings that the Yadav family's land holdings doubled between 2021 and 2023, when Mohan Yadav was a Minister, and doubled again between 2024 and 2025 after he became Chief Minister.

In a post on X Thursday, Malviya said: "The entire edi-

fice of allegations built around *The Indian Express* report rests on the insinuation that Mohan Yadav or his family benefitted from privileged access to information after he became Chief Minister. But even a cursory examination of the facts exposes how baseless and bereft of substance this campaign really is."

As "the most crucial fact," Malviya claimed that "the land

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## Govt expands QR code-tracking to curb fake cancer drugs, vaccines

**Anonna Dutt**  
*New Delhi, June 25*

IN A move to check the circulation of counterfeit medicines, the Union Ministry of Health and Family Welfare has expanded the ambit of the 'QR code-based track-and-trace framework' to include all vaccines, antimicrobials, anti-cancer medicines and narcotic and psychotropic drugs.

The ministry has notified amendments to the Drugs Rules, 1945, bringing these categories of medicines under

Schedule H2, which mandates the use of bar codes or Quick Response (QR) codes for product identification and verification.

This means manufacturers of all such medicines must affix a QR code either on the primary packaging, or on the secondary packaging in case of space constraints, that can identify each individual unit — thereby helping regulators trace its journey from the manufacturing unit to the market.

"The enhanced traceability mechanism will facilitate authentication of medicines at vari-

ous stages of the supply chain and enable improved tracking and verification of drug products. The measure is expected to strengthen regulatory oversight and support efforts to curb the distribution of spurious medicines in the market. It will also contribute to the national fight against Anti-Microbial Resistance (AMR) by enabling better identification and monitoring of counterfeit and substandard antimicrobial products," the ministry said in a statement on Thursday.

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

AYODHYA TRUST MEMBER COMPLAINANT

## FIR against 8 over theft of donations at Ram temple

Ex-driver of Trust gen secy among those named; action after SIT report goes to CM

**Bhupendra Pandey & Shyamlal Yadav**  
*Lucknow, New Delhi, June 25*

POLICE IN Ayodhya registered an FIR Thursday against eight individuals and unidentified others on a complaint alleging theft, misappropriation of cash, embezzlement of funds and valuables donated to the Ram temple.

The FIR was lodged at Kotwali Ramjanmabhoomi police station on a complaint by Krishna Mohan, a member of the Shri Ram Janmbhoomi Teerth Kshetra Trust, two days after a Special Investigation Team (SIT), probing the allegations, submitted its preliminary findings to the UP government.

The eight individuals named in the FIR are Avinash Shukla, Lavkush Mishra, Anukalp Mishra, Manish Kumar Yadav, Karunesh Pandey, Ramashankar Mishra, Ram Shankar Yadav alias Tinnu Yadav and Subhash Srivastav.

Late Thursday, all eight were brought to the police station for questioning. Most were involved in the donation counting work.



The building which houses the counting centre. SHYAMLAL YADAV

● **The role of the eight** **SUBHASH SRIVASTAV:** A retired bank employee, he was in-charge of the donation counting shifts at the Pilgrim Facility Centre.

**RAM SHANKAR YADAV ALIAS TINNU YADAV:** Ex-driver of Trust general secretary Champat Rai, looked after temple functioning.

**COUNTING STAFF:** Avinash Shukla, Lavkush Mishra, Anukalp Mishra, Manish Kumar Yadav, Karunesh Pandey, Ramashankar Mishra.

Tinnu Yadav used to work as a driver for Champat Rai, »CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

## NCERT's new Social Science textbook for Class 9 has SIR, more details on Emergency

**Abhinaya Harigovind**  
*New Delhi, June 25*

A YEAR after the Election Commission (EC) ordered a Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls, starting with Bihar as Assembly elections were due there, the exercise has found a mention in the NCERT's new Social Science textbook for Class 9. Through SIR, the EC "ensures that no eligible citizen is left out and no ineligible person is included in the electoral roll," it says.

The book — 'Understanding Society India and Beyond: Part 1' — released Thursday, also features a section on the Emergency, as part of the topic, 'Challenges to democratic practices in India', in a chapter titled 'Democracy'.

"One of the major challenges to democracy in India was recorded when an Emergency was imposed in 1975-77. In

### Business as Usual

By EP UNNY



the early 1970s, public dissatisfaction with the government led by Indira Gandhi was growing. Rising unemployment, inflation, and allegations of mis-governance led to widespread protests," it says.

"In June 1975, a National »CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

● AMONG MEASURES PROPOSED WERE AN SOS PHONE NUMBER, GPS AMBULANCES, GOOD SAMARITAN LAW AND A TRAUMA REGISTRY

## Saving lives on road: SC told states to put in 5 key measures, hardly any state did

**PAGE 1**  
**anchor**

**Dheeraj Mishra**  
*New Delhi, June 25*

INDIA'S DISMAL road safety record of 1.77 lakh fatalities a year has a revealing backstory. Not a single state has a complete trauma care architecture the Supreme Court sought for saving lives, according to data submitted to it by 34 states and Union Territories over the last nine months.

A common emergency phone number, GPS-equipped ambulances, a Good Samaritan law, a trauma registry and a res-

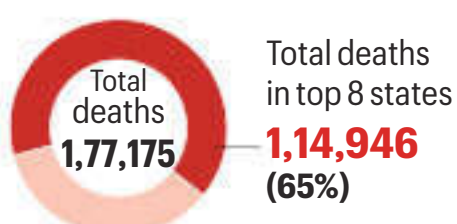
● TWO-THIRDS OF DEATHS IN 8 STATES ALONE

| State          | Road Deaths (2024) | 112 NERS Integration | Good Samaritan Grievance | Trauma Registry | Ambulance: Public GPS Dashboard |
|----------------|--------------------|----------------------|--------------------------|-----------------|---------------------------------|
| Uttar Pradesh  | 24,118             | Partial              | No                       | No              | Yes                             |
| Tamil Nadu     | 18,449             | Partial              | NA                       | Yes             | Yes                             |
| Maharashtra    | 15,715             | Partial              | Yes                      | Yes             | No                              |
| Madhya Pradesh | 14,791             | Partial              | No                       | Yes             | No                              |
| Karnataka      | 12,390             | NA                   | Yes                      | No              | No                              |
| Rajasthan      | 11,790             | Partial              | No                       | No              | No                              |
| Bihar          | 9,347              | Partial              | No                       | No              | No                              |
| Andhra Pradesh | 8,346              | No                   | NA                       | No              | No                              |

cue protocol — these are the five most important measures of the total nine the Supreme Court

had asked states to put in place in its May 26 order.

These five measures form a



● Most of the states did not provide GPS device data on private ambulances

● Only 1 of 8 states has linked GPS dashboard with 112 NERS

● Except Karnataka, seven states have their own rescue protocol

SOURCE: STATES'S SUBMISSIONS IN SUPREME COURT

crucial framework to prepare for the "Golden Hour" — the first 60 minutes after an accident critical

to saving lives.

The top court's order came in a petition filed by SaveLIFE Foundation, a Delhi-based road safety organisation, which had recommended a uniform trauma care system across states.

A comprehensive reading of the 1,200 pages of court submissions shows that of the eight states — Uttar Pradesh, Tamil Nadu, Maharashtra, Madhya Pradesh, Karnataka, Rajasthan, Bihar and Andhra Pradesh — that account for two out of every three accident deaths in the country, seven are yet to merge all their emergency numbers into 112; one

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 8

## Why states are dragging their feet in establishing a trauma system

**Dheeraj Mishra**  
*New Delhi, June 25*

POOR COORDINATION among agencies, multiplicity of departments and missing standard operating procedures (SOPs) are some of the key reasons why states have not built a trauma response system as directed by the Supreme Court.

A road fatality involves at least six departments viz., po-

lice, health, road agency, district magistrate office, insurance company and the death registration office, which makes a quick response in emergency cases difficult.

The first challenge whenever an accident happens is which number to call. There are many emergency numbers — police (100), fire (101), medical (102), ambulance (108), highway (1033), women (181),

cyber crime (1930), etc. A single number 112 has been conceived, but this will work only when there is a command centre at the district or state level to deploy required resources from all concerned agencies promptly during an accident.

"The integration to 112 is not just an integration of two computers. It is an integration of two different ecosystems. Currently, the API level integration »CONTINUED ON PAGE 8





All set for Amarnath Yatra

Security personnel stand guard at the Nunwan Base Camp in J&K's Pahalgam on Thursday ahead of the Amarnath Yatra. The pilgrimage will begin on July 3. A two-day international conference titled 'The Sacred Journey to Shri Amarnath Ji: A Multi-Dimensional Perspective' was held in Anantnag. At the conference, L-G Manoj Sinha said the yatra 'stands for social unity and deep inner reflection'. PTI

Soldiers storm J&K police post; Colonel, Major and others booked

FIR alleges assault on police officers, trespassing, public property damage

Arun Sharma

Jammu, Jun 25

THE JAMMU and Kashmir Police Wednesday booked the Commanding Officer of the 17 Rashtriya Rifles and several other Indian Army personnel in Kishtwar district for allegedly assaulting police officers and damaging public property. Apart from Colonel N Arun Gandhi, Commanding Officer of 17 Rashtriya Rifles, Major Vikas Sharma, Subedar Shanker Gurmke, Raj Kumar, Sepoy Rahul Kumar, Anoop Singh, Omkar Ingale, and 30-40 unnamed Army personnel have been named in the FIR. Pointing out that the attack took place on Wednesday afternoon, the FIR said that the identity of those unidentified Army jawans will be ascertained during the course of the investigation. The accused have been charged for unlawful assembly, rioting, house-trespass/criminal trespass, voluntarily causing grievous hurt, assault on public servants while discharging official duties, attempt to murder, criminal intimidation, mischief causing damage to government property, and other allied offences under the BNS, apart from offences punishable under the Prevention of Damage to Public Property Act. Meanwhile, Lieutenant Colonel Suneel Barawat, Public Relations Officer (Defence), released a statement, "The matter is under examination through the appropriate insti-

tutional mechanisms. Indian Army will extend full cooperation in the legal process. Appropriate actions will be taken based on the outcome of the joint investigation. At this stage it would be premature to comment further while the investigations are in progress." Sources said the confrontation started when the Kishtwar deputy commissioner's convoy was passing through a narrow road in the district. An Army vehicle coming from the opposite side was asked to move aside, leading to an altercation between the two sides. Following this, the police took the Army vehicle to the local police station, and the Army jawans reportedly attacked the premises. According to the FIR, the Station House Officer of the Atholi police station was on official duty attending the Block Diwas program of the Kishtwar deputy commissioner when he was informed on the telephone about the "conspiracy and a criminal assault" having taken place within the police station premises. The FIR further said that "a group of 30-40 Army personnel led by Major Vikas Sharma and Nb Subedar Shanker Gurmke from 17 RR, launched a pre-planned attack... under the direct instructions and command of the Commanding Officer, Colonel N Arun Gandhi." Armed with lathis, iron rods, arms, and ammunition, the group allegedly trespassed into the premises of Atholi police station by forcefully combing over the main gate and the boundary walls, the complaint added. The FIR went on to state that "their common intention was to cause fatal injuries and kill the police personnel on duty". After the SHO reached the police station, he, too, was "physically assaulted by the Army personnel."

Jacqueline withdraws plea from Supreme Court in money laundering case

Express News Service

New Delhi, June 25

BOLLYWOOD ACTOR Jacqueline Fernandez Thursday withdrew from the Supreme Court her plea challenging the trial court proceedings in the Rs200-crore money laundering case involving alleged conman Sukesh Chandrashekhar.

The counsel appearing for Fernandez urged a bench of Justices B V Nagarathna and Joy-malya Bagchi to allow her to withdraw the appeal challenging the special court order framing charges against her and others in the case investigated by the Enforcement Directorate (ED), while also reserving her right to avail of the appropriate legal remedies. The bench allowed the request and dismissed the appeal as withdrawn. The ED case stems from the extortion case filed by the Economic Offences Wing (EOW) of Delhi Police in August 2022 against Chandrashekhar for allegedly extorting money from Aditi Singh, the wife of former Fortis Healthcare promoter Shivinder Singh, by posing as the Union law secretary and calling her with an offer to bail her jailed husband. Fernandez has been named as a co-accused in the ED case for allegedly receiving "proceeds of crime" as gifts. Though Fernandez attempted to turn approver in the case, claiming she was also



Jacqueline Fernandez

a victim, the central agency opposed this. It said she chose to continue to "enjoy the proceeds of crime for herself and her family members, thereby demonstrating a conscious disregard for the source of funds and actively participating in the money laundering process". The actor subsequently withdrew her plea. It said she chose to continue to "enjoy the proceeds of crime... thereby demonstrating a conscious disregard for the source of funds and actively participating in the money laundering process". The actor subsequently withdrew her plea. On May 30, the special court framed money laundering charges against Fernandez, Chandrashekhar and other accused, saying there was enough material on record to prima facie suspect their roles. The actor had also moved the Delhi HC and the SC seeking an order to cancel the case, but failed to get any relief.

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Ram temple donations: FIR against 8

general secretary of the Trust. According to an official, ever since the consecration of the idol in 2022, Tinnu had been involved in the functioning of affairs inside the temple. Subhash Srivastav, a retired bank employee, was in-charge of the donation counting shifts at the counting room in the Pilgrim Facility Centre (PFC) in Ayodhya. Sources in Ayodhya said there were allegations that some among the counting staff had been slipping extra notes into currency bundles of 100 each and these were later shared. There could be action against more people, sources said. The FIR stated: "It is clear from the preliminary report of the SIT and available oral, documentary and electronic evidence that certain employees deployed for counting of donations have committed crime by stealing, misappropriating frequently. Based on the facts mentioned in the preliminary report of SIT and available oral, documentary and electronic evidence and financial records, registration of FIR is necessary..." The FIR invoked BNS sections 305 (theft in protected place of worship), 306 (theft by an employee), 316 (5) (criminal breach of trust by an employee), 317 (4) (habitual dealing in stolen property), 317 (5) (assisting in concealing or disposal of stolen property), 61 (criminal conspiracy), 3(5) (acts committed with common intention) and section 13 (1) a of Prevention of Corruption Act (criminal misconduct by a public servant). On Tuesday, the SIT — its members are Vijay Vishwas Pant, Lucknow Divisional Commissioner; Kiran S, IG Lucknow Range; and Neel Ratan, Special Secretary, Finance Department — handed over a preliminary report to Sanjay Prasad, Additional Chief Secretary to the CM. Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath, who had been travelling,

was said to have gone through the report Thursday morning upon his return to Lucknow. Sources in the government said the CM directed senior police officers to act in the matter. An Ayodhya police officer approached the Trust and, following a formal complaint, the FIR was registered, sources said. Sources said the preliminary report by the SIT mentioned the suspicious role of those engaged by the Trust to count the donated cash and valuables. The SIT is likely to make more visits to Ayodhya before it drafts a detailed report with recommendations and suggestions for strict norms on the management of temple affairs. Sources said the final report could be submitted to the CM within 15 days. The SIT has questioned those involved in the temple management work including the private agency hired by a bankasked by the Trust to manage donations and temple funds.

Amazon

meeting with the PM. "For over a decade, we have been serving customers, sellers, developers, startups, and enterprises through our different businesses. The response has been tremendous, with strong growth especially across our e-commerce, AI and cloud businesses," Jassy said. "As we grow Amazon in India, our business priorities align with India's priorities of democratising access to AI, digitising small businesses, creating jobs, and enabling exports, and we are investing over \$48 billion in the coming five years to meet the strong demand across our business in India and to help India achieve these priorities," he said. Top US tech companies are pouring billions into India to develop AI infrastructure. In October 2025, Google announced an investment of \$15 billion over the next five years to establish one gigawatt-scale AI hub in Visakhapatnam, Andhra Pradesh. This is the company's largest AI hub centre outside the US. In December 2025, Microsoft announced its largest investment in Asia — \$17.5 billion over four years (CY 2026 to 2029) — to advance India's cloud and AI infrastructure, skilling and ongoing operations. This investment builds on the \$3 billion investment announced earlier this year which, it said, is on track to spend by the end of CY2026. In addition to expanding AI and cloud infrastructure, Amazon will continue investing in the operations network powering its e-commerce and quick commerce business in India. The company plans to launch more than 20 new fulfillment centres and over 100 new last-mile delivery stations this year alone, bringing faster deliveries to customers nationwide, especially in Tier 3 and 4 cities. "Amazon runs one of the largest, safest, fastest and the most reliable operations network in India which serves customers in every single pin-code across the country," the company said.

He then met the President and presented his credentials. A Bangabhaban presidential palace spokesman said a contingent of the President Guard Regiment offered Trivedi a guard of honour before he presented his diplomatic papers. Meanwhile, the Centre has granted Trivedi a status equivalent to that of a Union Cabinet Minister. An order issued by the MHA said Trivedi "has been assigned the equivalent status of Union Cabinet Minister in the Table of Precedence (ToP) as a measure personal to him, without amending the Table of Precedence." "The position in the Table of Precedence is for ceremonial functions only," it said. According to figures provided by Bangladesh High Commission to *The Indian Express*, over 13,000 visas have been issued to Indian citizens in the first two months since resumption of operations around February 20. Bangladesh has been India's top source of foreign tourist arrivals, often accounting for over 20% of total arrivals.

Bangladesh

"I am very happy to be able to announce the launch of general travel visas again. Visa applications can be submitted starting June 28," Trivedi said, adding visas would be issued from all five centres — Dhaka, Rajshahi, Chattogram, Sylhet and Khulna — and the process would be expanded further in the future. Urgent medical visas, he said, would continue to be provided for humanitarian reasons. Last month, *The Indian Express* reported that India and Bangladesh were planning to resume visa services soon. As both countries sought to normalise their relationship after a period of significant turmoil, the full-scale resumption of visa services was agreed upon by both sides as an important first step. Bangladesh resumed issuing visas to Indian citizens across all categories following the swearing-in of the Tarique Rahman government in February this year. During Bangladesh For-

nesses' footage during the earthquakes showed scenes of panic as ceilings came down. Residents rush into the streets Many Venezuelans were at home when the quakes struck during a public holiday. Residents fled shaking buildings and poured into the streets as structures collapsed across Caracas and nearby coastal areas. "When we went downstairs, the scene was like a horror movie," said Caracas resident Maria Alejandra. "We had to climb over the rubble and everything. The building superintendent with the baby and all the neighbors coming down. But from that building, I only saw that one family got out." Houses collapsed near the quake's epicenter in Morón, a small seaside town in the state of Carabobo, where there was no water or electricity. Three children were among at least eight killed in the area, municipal Mayor Emily Riera told Reuters. Website shows over 35,000 people unaccounted for The US Geological Survey, using predictive modeling to estimate the death toll, said it would most likely run into the thousands, with a substantial probability of exceeding 10,000. A website set up to track missing people and shared by leaders from the country's Opposition, many of whom are outside Venezuela, listed more than 35,000 people as unaccounted for just after 1:30 pm local time. Reuters could not verify the veracity of every report. The 7.5 magnitude quake was Venezuela's strongest since 1900. The country lies on the boundary between the Caribbean and South American plates and has suffered devastating earthquakes, including one that killed an estimated 30,000 people in 1812. Maria Romero, an 80-year-old pensioner in southern Caracas, said police helped her out of her home. "This earthquake was horrible, even worse than the one in 1967," she said, referring to a magnitude 6.3 quake that the USGS said killed 240 people.

Venezuela

La Guaira state, near Caracas, "has become a disaster zone," President Rodriguez said, adding that her government was working with businesses to deploy heavy machinery to accelerate rescue efforts. "He's under the slabs and there's no machinery to get him out," said La Guaira resident Yamileth Jimenez, whose 19-year-old son is believed trapped in the rubble of their seven-story apartment building. "My father died three days ago and now this happens. It's just my son and me," said Jimenez. Rescue workers were scarce in the state's coastal capital, also called La Guaira, where volunteers were digging with their bare hands. "We lost everything. We have no food or medicines. We managed to get out in time and only have minor injuries... we hope help arrives quickly," said Pedro Perez, 64, the owner of an upholstery workshop. He said he lost his home and business and had been forced out onto the streets with his wife and children. Others in La Guaira searched for food and water. Reuters witnessed looting at two stores there. Caracas's main airport in La Guaira was closed on Thursday after suffering damage. With-

Expatriate groups representing Venezuela's diaspora, which numbers in the millions after years of mass migration, began organizing aid collections abroad as relatives worked to contact family members back home. Rodriguez called for unity in Venezuela, where anti-government protests over annual inflation of more than 500% have become more frequent since Trump ordered the capture of President Nicolas Maduro in a violent raid in January. Trump said the US was "ready, willing and able to help" and that the US would "be there for our new and great friends," while US Secretary of State Marco Rubio said rescue teams were being deployed and the Pentagon would send assets to Caracas's badly damaged airport. UN aid chief Tom Fletcher said the organization was coordinating the rapid deployment of international rescue teams, adding that "a massive collective effort" would be needed in a country where even before the quake, 8 million people needed humanitarian aid. The UN's Venezuela human rights mission urged the government to lift restrictions on some social media, saying it was a "matter of life and death". Access became available in some areas of the country, where cell services are unreliable. REUTERS

NCERT's new Social Science textbook

Emergency was imposed by the government on the grounds of internal disturbance. During this period, a majority of fundamental rights were suspended, the press was censored, and numerous political leaders and activists were arrested," it says. "Democratic institutions came under severe strain, and citizens' freedom was restricted. Mass movements led by Jayaprakash Narayan -- a political leader and socialist thinker, popularly known as Lok Nayak -- mobilized students and citizens, especially in Bihar and Gujarat," it says. Referring to the general elections held after the Emergency was lifted in 1977, it says: "Defeat of the ruling government demonstrated the strength of Indian democracy and highlighted the importance of constitutional safeguards, civil liberties, and active citizen participation in protecting democratic values." The only mention of the Emergency in the old Class 9 textbook was in a chapter on electoral politics. Referring to the "save democracy" slogan "given by Janata Party under the leadership of Jayaprakash Narayan, in the Lok Sabha election held in 1977", it said the party "promised to undo the excesses committed during Emergency and restore civil liberties." However, NCERT's Class 12 Political Science textbook -- Politics in India Since Independence -- has a chapter titled 'The crisis of democratic order', which provides details on the Emergency, including the background leading up to it, the response to it, and politics after the Emergency. Speaking to reporters in Chandigarh, Education Minister Dharmendra Pradhan said, "NCERT has done the right thing. Future generations should know, read and understand dark deeds like the Emergency, so that such a situation does not arise again." The SIR finds a mention in a chapter on elections in the new Class 9 book, in a section on the poll panel's functions. "The EC also conducts Special Intensive Revision (SIR), which involves updating, verifying and correcting the electoral rolls... Through SIR, it ensures that no eligible citizen is left out and no ineligible person is included in the electoral roll. This exercise ensures the addition of all voters, especially the young voters who have just turned 18 and may be left out due to a lack of awareness of any other reason," it says. "The SIR also deletes the names of the voters on the basis of death of the voter, change of residence, duplicate enrollment, and being permanently untraceable," it states, adding that the EC gives time to raise claims or objections against the revised electoral roll, and settles these claims and objections before publishing the final electoral roll. The old Class 9 textbook, in a chapter on electoral politics, had a section on voters' lists, where it mentioned that "a complete revision of the list takes place every five years", and this is done to ensure that it remains up to date. NCERT Director Dinesh Prasad Saklani did not respond to calls and texts seeking his comment.

QR code-tracking to curb fake cancer drugs

In April this year, an investigation by *The Indian Express*, in association with The International Consortium of Investigative Journalists (ICIJ), had revealed a multi-city counterfeit racket in Keytruda, an expensive cancer drug, in which empty vials were being refilled with anti-fungal medication and resold cheaper. Usually, drug packages carry only a batch number, which can be easily copied by counterfeiters. According to the ministry, the QR code will contain key product information such as a unique product identification code, generic and brand names, manufacturer's name and address, batch number, manufacturing and expiry dates, manufacturing licence number, and details of excipients, wherever applicable. Specialised track-and-trace platforms will be able to access this information, to trace the journey of each unit to the market. According to a gazette notification dated June 22, the change in packaging will be implemented over the next two years — by July 2027 for vaccines, narcotics and anti-cancer drugs, and by July 2028 for antimicrobials. Currently, the QR code-based identification is applicable to the top 300 pharmaceutical brands in the country. "With each unit of the drug carrying a unique code, counterfeiting will become difficult. Of course, sometimes counterfeiters may use the same packaging to beat the system. But even then, it would only work if the fake product is purchased and logged into the system before the genuine product. This is a good move towards ensuring that only genuine products enter the market," said an industry expert. "Importantly, the government has given enough time for implementing the changes, so companies should be able to exhaust the current stock before the new packaging becomes mandatory," said the expert. The matter was first discussed at a meeting of the Drug Technical Advisory Board (DTAB) in August 2024. "The Board was apprised that in New Delhi... unscrupulous criminals, in collusion with hospital pharmacies, were found refilling empty vials of expensive anti-cancer medicines with counterfeit drugs. These fake drugs were then mixed with genuine stocks and sold to unsuspecting cancer patients, putting their life at risk," said the minutes of the meeting. "These anti-cancer drugs must be issued under strict directives to implement mandatory QR codes and rigorous track-and-trace mechanisms on every vial and strip of medication that are marketed in India... DTAB deliberated the matter and agreed for the proposed amendment to include all anti-cancer medicines under Schedule H2," the minutes said.

opened up for development in Ujjain Master Plan 2035, in March-April 2023 — weeks before the document was made public in May 2023. The family continued acquiring land in these zones in the months that followed. The investigation also reported that while some infrastructure projects were already under consideration, Mohan Yadav announced a slew of road projects after becoming Chief Minister. Nearly two-thirds of the 168 acres purchased by the family in Ujjain after Yadav became the chief minister are re-located near these new road links and highways. Earlier this week, state BJP chief Khandelwal termed the Congress charges "completely baseless, factually incorrect and politically motivated". He said that in the affidavit filed by Yadav for the 2023 Assembly elections declared all land holding in his name and that of his wife, which has not increased since. He further stated that the

16 acres of land owned by Yadav's son Vaibhav Yadav before 2023 had also not increased after Yadav became Chief Minister. On Shri Siddhivinayak Devcons Pvt Ltd where Yadav and wife Seema own 73 per cent stake, Khandelwal said the firm owned around 68 acres during the 2023 Assembly elections and that its holdings had since reduced to approximately 65 acres. He claimed that Mohan Yadav had no connection with the company's current activities since he had resigned as a director of the company in 2017. Khandelwal added that relatives of the Chief Minister conduct their businesses and financial activities independently and that linking their private transactions or businesses to Yadav was "factually incorrect". Madhya Pradesh PWD Minister Rakesh Singh, however, said that he had "no objection" to the Congress demand for an investigation. "If someone raises a call for an investigation, then there should be one. There is no

objection to that... I think that if there are properties which have been accumulated illegally, then that should also come forward," he said. On June 23, *The Indian Express* reported that Chief Minister Mohan Yadav and his family acquired, either directly or through one of their real estate companies, at least 85 acres of land in Ujjain between 2021 and 2023, when Yadav served as education minister. The report further stated that they purchased at least 168 additional acres between 2024 and 2025 after Yadav became chief minister. *The Indian Express* also found that the Yadav family owned at least another 82 acres in Ujjain, either as longstanding holdings or properties whose acquisition dates could not be determined. Even assuming the family's 82 acres of longstanding or undated holdings were already owned by 2020, their land holding doubled to 167 acres during

2021-2023 after Yadav became a minister. This further doubled to 335 acres during 2024-2025 after Yadav became the chief minister. *The Indian Express* report said that CM Yadav and wife Seema owned 17 and 11 acres, respectively, in their name, which was declared in Yadav's election affidavit in 2023. They co-own at least another 27.5 acres through Shri Siddhivinayak Devcons Pvt Ltd, a company where they hold 73% stake. *The Indian Express* also reported that weeks before Ujjain master Plan 2023 was released in May 2023, the Yadav family purchased at least 30 acres in Sawarakhedi in March-April 2023. Of the 168 acres purchased in 2024-25, 111 acres are close to new road links and highways, and 33 acres are in areas opened up for residential or commercial use in the new master plan. Detailed queries sent by *The Indian Express* to Chief Minister Mohan Yadav and his office on April 13 remain unanswered.



# ED seeks records linked to Rs 350 cr ‘procurement fraud’ case from CPA

Ankita Upadhyay  
New Delhi, June 25

THE ENFORCEMENT Directorate (ED) has sought documents related to the medical equipment procurement fraud case involving the Central Procurement Agency (CPA), which was so far being probed by the Delhi government’s Anti-Corruption Branch (ACB). Investigators suspect that tailor-made specifications during the procurements were framed to favour select suppliers, and genuine competitors were excluded from the bidding process. Government funds worth more than Rs 350 crore were allegedly misutilised, according to sources.

The ED has sought records and documents pertaining to CPA and the Directorate General of Health Services (DGHS) under the provisions of Prevention of Money Laundering Act, 2002. It has also sought details such as procurement of portable X-ray machines, C-Arm radiological equipment, anaesthesia workstations, oral rehydration solution (ORS), bed sheets covers, surgical items, including dressings, sutures, cannulas and gloves, and medicines.

In a letter to Director General Health Services (DGHS) Dr Sushma Jain, the investigation

agency has also sought the details of the tendering process, technical and financial evaluation, award of contracts, supply, inspection, acceptance and release of payments related to the procurements, under scanner, including transactions and dealings involving manufacturers and their authorised distributors or vendors; and other entities associated with the aforesaid procurements.

This comes after the ACB last week arrested Dr Vinod Kumar Ranga in the case over alleged discrepancies in the procurement of medicines and medical equipment for government hospitals in the national capital. Now in judicial custody, Dr Ranga was serving as the Head of Office of the CPA, the nodal agency responsible for procuring medicines and equipment for public health-care facilities. He was suspended after the Directorate of Vigilance conducted raids at the CPA office in May.

According to ACB officials, the Directorate of Vigilance, Government of National Capital Territory of Delhi (GNCTD), had submitted a complaint alleging large-scale irregularities in the procurement of medicines, surgical items, consumables and medical equipment by the CPA under the Director-

## Major rejig: Ministers’ aides, senior health officers among 50 transferred

Express News Service  
New Delhi, June 25

IN A major bureaucratic reshuffle, the Delhi government has transferred over 50 IAS and DANICS officers, including secretaries of four ministers and secretary-level officials in the Health department, with some given additional charges.

Sources said the transfers in the Health department follow alleged irregularities in the procurement of medical equipment. Last week, the Delhi Anti-Corruption Branch (ACB) arrested a doctor in connection with a Rs 350-crore fraud case involving the procurement of medicines and medical equipment for government hospitals.

Secretaries of ministers Pan-kaj Kumar Singh, Kapil Mishra, Ravinder Indraj and Manjinder Singh Sirsa have also been transferred to other departments.



CM Rekha Gupta ordered a probe against two senior health officers earlier this week. FILE

“Another order is likely to be issued. One of the reason for this major bureaucratic reshuffle is the ongoing row over alleged irregularities in the Central Procurement Agency (CPA) and medicine procurement. Recently, the CPA head was arrested by the Anti-Corruption Branch (ACB). The CM also ordered a probe against two senior health officers earlier this week,” said officials.

### Key transfers

■ IAS officer Sanjeev Kumar, posted as Special Secretary, Health, has been transferred to the Trade and Taxes department as Special Commissioner.

■ 2013-batch DANICS officer Vaibhav Rikhari, posted as Secretary to the Minister of Health and Family Welfare, is now posted as Director, Delhi Jal Board (DJB). Mukesh Rajora (DANICS 2013) ADM (HQ) will be the new secretary of Singh, who also holds the Transport and IT department charge.

■ Yash Chaudhary, Special Secretary (Health), has been given additional charge of the Central Procurement Agency (CPA) with delegated financial powers of head of department (HoD), divesting the Directorate General of Health Services (DGHS) of its HoD-level financial powers.

cesses, tender conditions and technical specifications to provide undue advantage to selected firms and suppliers, causing wrongful loss to the government exchequer and

corresponding gain to private parties.

Dr Vatsala Aggarwal, the former DGHS, was also suspended amid allegations of the massive scam.

## MCD to intensify action on evasion of toll tax

Drishti Jain  
New Delhi, June 25

MONTHS BEFORE the Municipal Corporation of Delhi (MCD) plans to shift to a barrier-free and technology-driven toll system across entry points to the Capital, the civic body is set to rejig the bylaws to curb toll tax evasions. The House on Thursday passed the proposal to amend the existing Delhi Municipal Corporation (Toll-Tax) By-laws 2007.

The move comes in line with Supreme Court directions, a letter from MCD Commissioner Sanjeev Khirwar to the Municipal Secretary last month underlined, adding that the proposed amendments would allow automatic detection of toll and environment charge evasion, digital issuance of notices to defaulters, and technology-enabled recovery process against vehicle owners who evade the tax.

Earlier in January, the apex court had passed recommendations to the civic body to ensure the “installation of a barrier-free Multi-Lane Free Flow (MLFF) System, which has to be integrated with Radio-Frequency Identification (RFID) and Automatic Number Plate Recognition (ANPR), at all 126 toll collection points by October to avoid vehicular stoppage and reducing congestion at Delhi border points.”

Govt approves Rs 264 crore for upgrade of 75 CM SHRI schools

Express News Service  
New Delhi, June 25

ABOUT 75 CM SHRI schools across Delhi are going to get a major upgrade, including renovation and upgradation of boundary walls and classrooms walls facing seepage, painting, lighting, developed sports facilities, at a cost of Rs 264 crore. The proposal was approved by the Expenditure Finance Committee (EFC) chaired by Chief Minister Rekha Gupta on Thursday during a meeting, also attended by PWD Minister Parvesh Sahib Singh, Education Minister Ashish Sood and senior officials of departments concerned.

Gupta said entrance gates of schools will feature the new CM SHRI logo. “Our objective is not merely to repair school buildings but to develop government schools into modern educational campuses where students have access to a safe, inclusive, technology-enabled and high-quality learning environment.”

### MEHRAULI RAPE-MURDER

## Murder weapon recovered, accused ‘waited for 45 minutes’ to abduct girl

Express News Service  
New Delhi, June 25

DAYS AFTER a 10-year-old homeless girl was abducted from South Delhi’s Mehrauli area, raped and killed, police on Thursday said they have recovered the murder weapon. Cab driver Bashu Kumar Singh, accused in the rape-murder case, was arrested on Monday hours after he allegedly committed the crime.

“Police recovered the cotton towel used by him to strangle the girl and the stone with which he hit her. Both murder weapons were found near a forested area where the incident happened. Strands of hair were also recovered from the cab of the accused,” said a source.

Officers said that during questioning, Singh told police that he waited for 45 minutes for the “right time” to abduct her, another police source said. The incident took place in the early hours of Monday when



Bashu Kumar Singh in police custody. FILE

father. Her younger sisters were also sleeping with her parents on the footpath, the accused told police.

So he parked his vehicle and waited for 45 minutes until she rolled away in her sleep around 4.15 am. The accused claimed he covered her face, forced her into the already running car and sped off.

The girl’s father woke up hearing the commotion. He told police he heard his daughter cry out. “Papa, save me,” but by the time he tried to

stop the car, the accused had driven away.

According to a police source, Singh claimed he slapped the girl when she tried to resist and threatened her. He then drove to an isolated spot near a forested area where he allegedly raped her.

Police said he then drove back to the spot where he had abducted the child, but spotted police and the victim’s parents searching for her.

Officers said the accused claimed that he turned around, drove towards the Gurgaon-Faridabad border, strangled the girl with a “gamcha (scarf)”, and dumped her body near the Aravalli hills after smashing her face with bricks to conceal her identity.

Later, Singh picked up another passenger and dropped them in Vikaspuri in West Delhi from where the Delhi Police nabbed him

around 11 am — more than seven hours after the crime.

### AFTER KIN SAY DELAY IN TREATMENT LED TO PATIENT’S DEATH

## CM orders inquiry into ‘irregularities’, ‘negligence’ in treatment at Fortis

Express News Service  
New Delhi, June 25

FOLLOWING COMPLAINTS against alleged irregularities and negligence in treatment of patients at Fortis Hospital, Shalimar Bagh, Delhi Chief Minister Rekha Gupta on Thursday ordered an inquiry.

The CM’s Office said the inquiry was ordered after a complaint was made during a public hearing at the Mukhyamantri Jan Seva Sadan. The family of a youth, who had sustained stab injuries in an incident in Shalimar Bagh, said he was taken to Fortis Hospital, but that a delay in the treatment allegedly led to his death.

According to the family, the hospital allegedly wanted them to make the payment before beginning the treatment.

Taking cognisance of the allegations, Chief Minister Gupta directed authorities to conduct an investigation into

the matter.

On Thursday, a multi-departmental inspection team, led by Central-North District Magistrate S S Parihar, visited the hospital. Officials from the state Health department, municipal body, the Fire department and other agencies were part of the team.

### Violations of norms

According to officials, the inspection unearthed several irregularities, including alleged violations of building by-laws, illegal construction, deficiencies in fire safety measures, misuse of basement areas and lapses in compliance with standard operating procedures governing medical treatment.

The inquiry team also scanned CCTV footage related to the incident flagged by the youth’s family. Officials said footage showed that the youth, who had suffered a stab injury, walked into the hospital’s emergency department on his

own. The team stated that this indicated that timely medical intervention could potentially have improved his chances of survival.

Investigators also reviewed records maintained by the hospital’s emergency department as part of the inquiry. District Magistrate Parihar said that in view of the irregularities identified during the inspection and the alleged negligence in patient care, action against the hospital would be initiated. He added that a detailed inquiry report is currently being prepared.

Meanwhile, the hospital told *The Indian Express*: “Fortis remains committed to the highest standards of patient care, clinical excellence, and regulatory compliance. We will review the details once formally shared with us and extend our full cooperation to the authorities. Patient safety and well-being continue to be our foremost priority.”

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WEEK AFTER AIIMS OKAYED THE TERMINATION, FLAGGED THAT ‘CONTINUATION OF PREGNANCY CAN HAVE ADVERSE IMPACT’

# Delhi High Court allows sexual assault survivor to terminate 28-week pregnancy

Nirbhay Thakur  
New Delhi, June 25

THE DELHI High Court on Wednesday allowed a sexual assault survivor, who is a minor, to medically terminate her 28-week pregnancy, observing that such a permission — that goes beyond the 24-week timeline prescribed by law — can be granted in view of grave mental injury and trauma inflicted upon the girl.

This comes less than a week after All India Institute of Medical Science (AIIMS) okayed the termination in a report dated June 19, stating that its continuation was likely to have an "adverse impact" on the minor.

"...although the Medical Termination of Pregnancy Act (MTP Act) does not provide for termination of pregnancy over the gestational age 24 weeks, the extraordinary jurisdiction of the constitutional courts can be invoked for termination of pregnancy in cases of rape, as in such cases, grave mental injury and trauma is inflicted upon the mind of the minor," Justice Mini Pushkarna said in her order.

"The Medical Board of AIIMS, New Delhi, conducted a thorough clinical assessment of the petitioner, including obstetric ultrasound, psychiatric and psychological evaluation. After the clinical assessment, the

**Justice Pushkarna directed authorities to offer medical support and assistance to the victim in case the child is born alive.**

Medical Board of AIIMS, New Delhi, has clearly given its opinion that the termination of pregnancy can be allowed as continuation of the pregnancy is likely to have an adverse psychological impact on the minor petitioner," she added.

In its medical report, AIIMS

had concluded that the petitioner was medically fit to undergo the procedure for medical termination of pregnancy and that continuing the pregnancy would likely have an adverse psychological impact on the minor.

The Delhi government said that it had no objection if the termination was carried out in this case.

"The petitioner is permitted to get herself admitted at AIIMS, New Delhi, on the strength of the present order for medical termination of her pregnancy. Let the procedure for termination of pregnancy be carried out by a team of competent doctors (as per law)," the

court added.

Justice Pushkarna directed authorities to offer medical support and assistance to the victim in case the child is born alive.

"In case the child is born alive, the Medical Superintendent, AIIMS, New Delhi, in conjunction with the State Authorities would ensure that medical support, as well as every possible and feasible assistance is offered to such child, and the child shall be kept in an incubator...in that case, as per the wish of the minor and her father, such child be given in adoption as per the prescribed procedure," she said in her order.

The court also directed

AIIMS Delhi to preserve the foetus tissue for DNA testing, which would be required in the criminal case against the accused.

The court also further stated that the Delhi government would bear the expenses of the pregnancy.

"Needless to say, respondent no. 2, i.e., Government of National Capital Territory of Delhi (GNCTD) shall bear all the expenses necessary for the termination of the pregnancy of the minor in question and her stay at the hospital during such period. The expenditure towards the post-operative period shall also be borne by the State," it said.

# Now, an ‘IVF’ claim emerges in child trafficking racket probe

Pragynesh  
New Delhi, June 25

INVESTIGATION INTO an interstate child-trafficking racket busted last week has found that arrested doctor Viveki, owner of Hira Hospital in Delhi's Rohini, was likely duping her 'customers' -- couples wanting babies -- police sources said.

After the Delhi Police rescued a one-month-old infant from Rishikesh on Monday, a 32-year-old woman, from whom they recovered the baby, claimed she was told it was her child born through IVF.

She claimed she had approached the hospital as she couldn't conceive. But, sources said, investigators found that the baby was bought from other parents willing to sell their children for as little as Rs 5,000.

Police said the woman has been apprehended, and they are verifying her claims.

Fifteen people — including Dr Viveki — have been arrested in the case so far while seven children have been rescued.

According to sources, the 32-year-old woman told police she had been married for 12 years and was unable to conceive as her husband is paralysed.

A relative later told her about Dr Viveki, describing her as an "expert" in treating couples facing infertility. "The woman claimed she went to Dr Viveki last year, where she was told that she can have a child through IVF and the hospital would arrange for a donor who would carry the pregnancy," said a police officer.

Over the next nine months, the woman claimed they kept visiting the hospital, during which the husband's semen sample was taken.

She said they were later informed that their child had been conceived through the donor.

"On June 4, the woman claimed they were handed over the child, and were made to sign papers which showed that the child was born out of an IVF procedure," said a source, adding that it is being probed if the papers were forged. Police are verifying if Hira Hospital provided IVF services or made such

**Police apprehended a woman when they rescued a child 'sold' by the accused. The woman, however, claimed she was told it was her child born through IVF.**

claims.

**Arrests, the modus operandi**

Among the others arrested are Mukesh (37), a truck driver, and his wife, Reema Pal, from Gwalior. Police said they had allegedly purchased two newborns after they were unable to have their own children.

Prathiba, an intermediary, was also arrested.

Investigators have also arrested another couple, Sunny Arora and Ritu Arora from Haryana's Panipat. According to police, they allegedly purchased a baby boy for Rs 6 lakh.

The alleged mastermind, Sayabhai Ghamar alias Kalia, has also been arrested. Officials privy to the investigation said Kalia initially worked with a man known as 'Sardar', whom he met outside a temple where newborns were allegedly being sold, and was paid Rs 5,000 for his role. Others arrested are Jyoti alias Kamlesh, Shalu, Lalit, Vipin, Omwati, and Sarika.

Police said the gang had a chilling code word for the babies, referring to them as 'files'. All payments were allegedly made in cash.

Police said the newborns were brought in by car from outside the city. Vipin, along with Jyoti or Shalu, would travel to Pali in Rajasthan, hand over the money to Kalia, collect the child, and drive back to Delhi.

A man usually accompanied them so they could pose as a family if questioned and avoid suspicion.

"Once in Delhi, the babies were kept at Hira Hospital. From there, some were delivered directly to the buyers' locations", an officer said.

## • Skywatch



**Forecast: June 26, 2026**  
Partly cloudy sky. Light rain, thunderstorm, lightning.

**MAX: 39-41**

**3.8°C above normal**

**MIN: 26-28**

**0.1°C above normal**

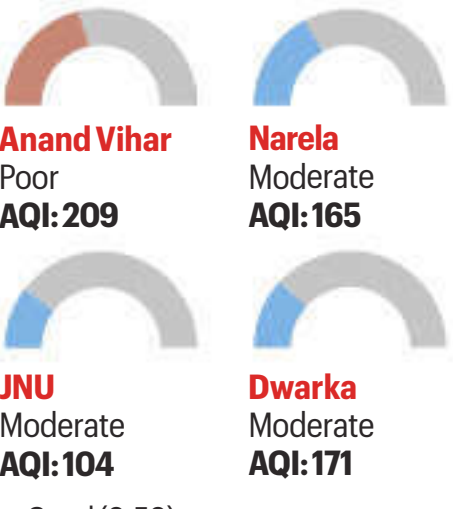
• **Sunrise:** 5:26 AM (June 27)

• **Sunset:** 7:23 PM (June 26)

• **Moonrise:** 4:30 PM (June 26)

• **Moonset:** 2:53 PM (June 27)

## • AQI Tracker



**Sophiya Mathew**  
New Delhi, June 25

EVERY YEAR, as the Capital battles severe air pollution during winters, emergency measures are introduced based on forecasts of how foul the air is likely to get. With an aim to make those forecasts sharper, IIT-Kanpur's Airwat Research Foundation (ARF) has been building a system under a pilot initiative, *The Indian Express* has learnt.

*The Indian Express* had reported last November that the Decision Support System (DSS) — the current model used for identifying sources and air quality forecasts — suffers from several issues, including an ageing emissions database and accuracy that tails off outside the peak winter months. To resolve these issues and modernise the system, IIT-K signed a memorandum of understanding (MoU) with the Delhi Environment department last month.

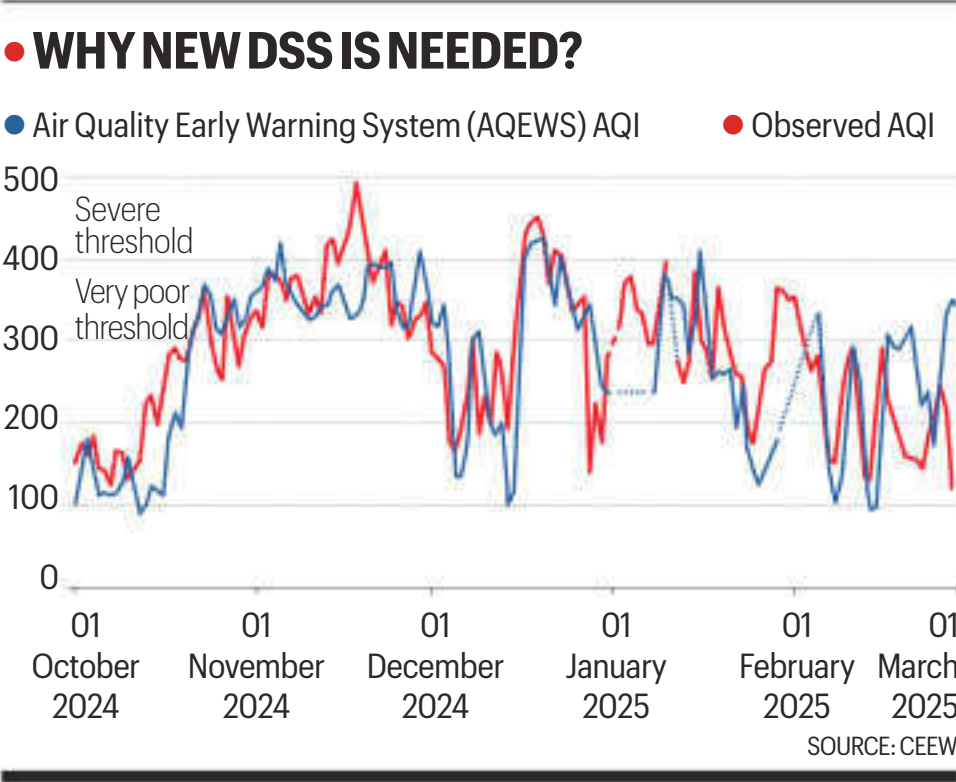
### Improved prediction

Drawing on a constant stream of live pollution data, the new AI-based DSS will use artificial intelligence (AI) to spot the first signs of a worsening episode early, so that action can be taken before conditions worsen, sources said. This marks a shift from the system that the Capital currently relies on, which produces a single forecast each day from a fixed scientific model. The new system, by contrast, continuously learns from patterns — studying the city's AQI data from the past to anticipate how it will behave next, and improving its predictions in the long run, sources added.

A report by the Council on Energy, Environment and Water (CEEW) released last October underlined that even as Delhi's existing forecasting and decision-support setup meets most of the requirements of an ideal system, "Delhi's Air

## EXPRESS exclusive

# Predictive analytics dashboards, hotspot detection: AI-based system set to make AQI forecast sharper



Quality Early Warning System (AQEWS) and DSS satisfy most of the requirements for an ideal Air Quality Decision Support System (AQDSS)" yet its accuracy is uneven. The forecasts are strongest at the dangerous end of the scale, predicting "very poor and above" (AQI > 300) pollution episodes more than -80% of the time" in recent winters, but the system has been formally evaluated only for the post-monsoon and winter months, leaving much of the year less rigorously tested.

The DSS has also historically been run mainly during the winter season rather than throughout the year.

A central weakness flagged by the report is the data underpinning the model. CEEW recommends that the emission inventory (EI) — the database of which sources emit how much, on which the forecasts rest — be refreshed on a regular cycle, suggesting "a framework in place to update the EI every two to three years" and noting that "the immediate focus should be on upgrading the EI for the Delhi NCR region to improve Delhi's forecasts."

Even with better data, the report cautions that "even after revamping the EI, the model output may still have errors. It specifically urged the use of ar-

tificial intelligence to close that gap, recommending that the agencies "use machine learning (ML) models to correct errors in the forecasts."

### Focus of new system

The AI-driven approach now being piloted by IIT-Kanpur's Airwat Research Foundation maps closely onto these prescriptions — modernising the underlying data, adding machine-learning-based correction, and moving towards a year-round, more granular system. The predictive analytics dashboards, hotspot detection systems, hyperlocal source apportionment and forecasting models that form the core of the new platform are designed to give a far more granular picture of the city's air than they have had before.

According to the agreement, the system is being built to generate pollution forecasts and advisories 48 to 72 hours in advance — a window intended to give authorities time to act before an episode peaks. Rather than a single city-wide snapshot, the tools aim to pinpoint where pollution is building up, identify the airsheds and regional movement feeding it, and trace the contribution of individual sources.

Airawat Research Foundation (ARF) is a non-profit set up

under Section 8 at IIT-Kanpur as part of the Centre's initiative for an AI Centre of Excellence for Sustainable Cities. Beyond forecasting, the MoU envisages expanding Delhi's monitoring network through low-cost sensors, mobile laboratories and the integration of satellite data.

The improved forecasts are meant to affect directly the staged curbs Delhi imposes as air quality deteriorates. Under the plan, the partnership will help formulate Standard Operating Procedures, coordination mechanisms and graded response protocols aligned with the Graded Response Action Plan (GRAP) and the National Clean Air Programme (NCAP). Because these measures are triggered by forecasts, the accuracy and timing of predictions directly shape how effective -- and how disruptive -- the response is.

As per the arrangement the Department of Environment will coordinate with other departments and stakeholders, provide access to operational and technical data subject to applicable laws, nominate a nodal officer, and validate the analytical models before they are deployed. ARF, for its part, will develop the AI-driven tools, deploy technical experts and researchers, ensure compliance with data protection and IT laws, and submit periodic progress reports and policy recommendations.

A component of the project is devoted to capacity building for training officials to interpret the analytical systems and plan interventions.

The Secretary, Department of Environment, will act as the supervising authority on behalf of the GNCTD, while the CEO or Project Director of airwat will coordinate implementation from the foundation's side, with regular review meetings to track progress. The agreement is valid for five years and can be extended by mutual consent, the MOU has stated.



Overcast sky in Old Delhi on Thursday. TASHI TOBGYAL

# Onset of monsoon likely in Capital by next week

**New Delhi:** THE IMD on Thursday said conditions are becoming "favourable" for the further advance of the Southwest Monsoon into northwest India in the second week of its extended forecast period: July 2 to 8.

The usual date of monsoon onset in Delhi is around June 30. However, the IMD noted that the current synoptic features, including strengthening low-level Somali Jet, active Bay of Bengal circulation, and supportive Madden-Julian Oscillation

phase, are likely to sustain moisture inflow and convective activity over north and central India.

The IMD added that over northwest India, including Delhi, light to moderate rainfall at scattered to fairly widespread distribution is likely during the period, with isolated heavy rain over parts of Himachal Pradesh and Uttarakhand on some days of the week, supported by western disturbances and lower-tropospheric westerly flow. ENS

## GROUND report

# Gurgaon garbage fee has residents fuming; civic body forced to make a U-turn

Abhimanyu Hazarika  
Gurgaon, June 25

GURGAON RESIDENTS are still being charged garbage collection fees as part of municipal taxes, despite several societies managing sanitation on their own. Residents had first flagged this issue in April. At the time, senior officials in the Municipal Corporation of Gurugram (MCG) had said the garbage levy was an error and would be rectified soon.

Kusum Sharma, chairperson of the Suncity Township Residents' Welfare Association (RWA), questioned why the levy was for registered bulk waste

generators (BWGs) like them that collect, segregate and process wet waste on their own.

"Residents are confused... some are instigating others to not pay the sanitation component of society maintenance fees... there is a lot of confusion. They should rename the charge if they intend to keep it," she said.

However, the bone of contention is the change in stance of the civic body.

In April, an official had told *The Indian Express* on condition of anonymity that they "are likely to defer the levy till a door-to-door garbage collection system is in place".



Garbage piles up at Sector 23A in Gurgaon. EXPRESS

Now, senior officials said the charge is not for collection of garbage but holistic sanitation services.

"The charges are for all sanitation services that MCG pro-

vides, not just garbage collection. It will be renamed; we have raised this several times with the HQ (Department of Urban Local Bodies). It includes road sweeping, legacy waste management, and other sanitation activities that the MCG does and that everyone benefits from, including self-managing BWGs," an official said.

To be sure, the MCG does not have a permanent mechanism in place for door-to-door garbage collection, segregation and processing. A tender issued earlier this month had to be recalled as bidders sought higher-than-quoted tariffs for every tonne of waste processed.

At present, the civic body relies on informal labour-based stopgap measures, outsourced to various contractors. Several sectors manage on their own, with collectors collecting between Rs 50-150 per household.

The MCG's argument is not cutting ice with all.

Bhawani Shankar Tripathy, Sector 23A RWA general secretary, said sanitation is the first and one of the primary municipal services that an urban local body is obliged to provide to citizens.

"Legally, the MCG cannot charge residents for road sweeping. As per the 12th Schedule of the Constitution, functions of

urban local bodies include keeping the city clean, which is an obligatory duty. The MCG cannot charge for an obligatory function... as an agency, it is obliged to fulfil that function," said Tripathy.

As of now, the portal allows residents to pay the property tax component but not clearing the garbage charges means one cannot generate a 'no dues' certificate.

"This is not good governance. No other municipal bodies in Haryana are charging this. How can the MCG charge this in Gurgaon?" Puneet Pahwa, general secretary of the Sector 45 RWA, said.

## SIR PROCESS BEGINS NEXT WEEK

The process will begin in Delhi from June 30, There are 1.48 crore voters in Delhi as of May 12, 2026.

### FILLING THE FORM

- From June 30-July 29, booth level officers (BLOs) will visit homes to distribute enumeration forms.
- Form will already have your name, EPIC number, address, Assembly constituency and photograph.
- Fill in the missing fields: date of birth, parents' names, their EPIC numbers (if available), mobile number, and Aadhaar (optional).

- Any adult member of the household can fill the forms, which can also be submitted online

### CHECKING 2002 ROLLS

- You will be asked to trace your, a parent's, or a relative's name in the rolls of 2002 — the last time SIR was conducted in Delhi.
- If you remember having voted in Delhi before 2002, you should be able to locate your name and details in the voters' list of 2002 on the website of Chief Electoral Officer, Delhi.
- If you moved to Delhi after 2002, go to the website voters.eci.gov.in and find the voters' list of the state where you lived earlier. Look for your name and details.
- If you can't find your own name in any roll, or if you weren't registered as a voter at the time, look for the name of a parent or close



relative. If you can find those details, you can fill them in the form.

### SUBMITTING THE FORM

- Hand it over to your BLO; you will get an acknowledgment.
- If you've submitted the form online on voters.eci.gov.in, take a screenshot or save the receipt.

### WHO HAS TO SUBMIT WHAT

- Born in India before July 1, 1987: document proving date and/or place of birth.
- Born between July 1, 1987, and December 2, 2004: Document for the elector and one parent.
- Born after December 2, 2004: Documents for elector, parents.

### AFTER FINAL ROLLS

- If your name is not there, you can appeal the decision with the DM within 15 days.
- If first appeal fails, you can submit a second appeal with the Chief Electoral Officer in next 15 days.

### MARK YOUR CALENDAR

- House to house visits by BLOs **June 30 to July 29**
- Rationalisation of polling stations by **July 29**
- Publication of draft electoral roll **August 5**
- Period for filing claims &

- objections **August 5 to September 4**
- Notice phase/disposal of claims & objections **August 5 to October 3**
- Publication of final electoral roll **October 7**



PM Modi to be Guest of Honour at Seychelles' 50th National Day

Express News Service  
New Delhi, June 25

PRIME MINISTER Narendra Modi will undertake a state visit to Seychelles from June 27-29 to participate as the Guest of Honour in the Golden Jubilee celebrations of their National Day.

During his three-day visit, he will also hold talks with President Patrick Herminie to review the full spectrum of bilateral cooperation, the MEA said on Thursday. A contingent of the Indian Armed Forces, and two ships of the Indian Navy, will participate in the celebrations, the MEA said.

"The visit will reaffirm the strong and enduring friendship between India and Seychelles and reinforce the shared commitment of both countries to enhance the bilateral relationship across all sectors," it said. Modi will also address the National Assembly of Seychelles and interact with the Indian diaspora.

Passport fee hiked: Normal to cost Rs 2,500, Tatkal Rs 5,000

Express News Service  
New Delhi, June 25

THE MINISTRY of External Affairs has raised the passport fees across different categories. The fee for an ordinary fresh passport containing 36 pages has gone up from Rs 1,500 to Rs 2,500, while for Tatkal, it has been increased from Rs 3,500 to Rs 5,000.

The new rules will come into force from July 1, 2026. The passport fee structure has been revised through an amendment to the Passports Rules, 1980. The fee revision comes a day after the ministry clarified that a passport is not a citizenship proof but a travel document.

According to the fee revision notification dated June 20, published by the MEA on Thursday, the fee for an ordinary 60-page fresh passport or reissue of a passport has been hiked from Rs 2,000 to Rs 3,500, and for Tatkal, it has been increased from Rs 4,000 to Rs 6,000.

The government also issued a Schedule which will substitute the "Schedule IV to the Passports Rules, 1980". The revised schedule mentions two sub-categories — for applicants (18 years and above/minors aged between 15 to 18 years, if applied under this category); and minor applicants (below 18 years of age).

BENGALURU TRIPLE MURDER

Woman had plotted to murder only her mother; father, sister's arrival led to change of plans

Express News Service  
Bengaluru, June 25

SHWETHA AND her partner Kenneth had allegedly conspired to kill only her mother, Muthulakshmi, but it was the unexpected arrival of her father and sister at the murder location before they could dispose off the body that ended up in the triple murder at a Bengaluru flat earlier this week, investigators said.

The bodies of Muthulakshmi, 48, and her younger daughter, Supriya (19), were found with multiple stab injuries inside a flat at Sai Green Apartment in Dhamnika Layout, Seegehalli, KR Pura, on Monday.

Her husband, 52-year-old Somasundar who managed to run out the apartment during the attack, died of his injuries near the complex's main gate a few minutes later. While Shwetha has been arrested and sent to police custody, Kenneth is on the run.

Meanwhile, Shwetha has told police she alone is to be blamed for the deaths of her parents and sibling, adding Kenneth had no role in the murders.

According to police, investigation revealed despite moving into a new flat with 24-year-old Shwetha, Kenneth had retained a one-bedroom apartment in Gururaj Layout near HAL, where he used to reside earlier. Police suspect this could have been done with intention to temporarily keep Muthulakshmi's body before disposing of it.

According to police sources,

His killer should not get remission, will 'embolden' others: Haren Pandya's wife

HC tells govt to consider remission plea of Asgar Ali — given life term for murder

Express New Service  
Ahmedabad, June 25

JAGRUTI PANDYA, the wife of slain former Gujarat minister Haren Pandya, has opposed any move to grant remission to Mohammed Asgar Ali, the hitman convicted of killing her husband on March 26, 2003.

Jagruti spoke to *The Indian Express* after the High Court order directed the state government to decide on a remission application moved by Ali preferably within six months. Ali, who was sentenced to life imprisonment, has sought remission on the grounds that he has spent more than 14 years in jail.

Jagruti said only the family should have the right to decide on the matter, noting that at least three accused in her husband's murder case were still absconding, including "mastermind" Mufti Sufiyan. Releasing Ali would only "embolden them", she said.

"I believe Ali, who was part of the conspiracy and took my husband's life, should not be freed. He is a sharpshooter and can take anyone else's life for money. Releasing him will only embolden him and others to commit more such crimes," Jagruti told *The Indian Express*. "Apart from Mufti Sufiyan, there are Rasool Khan 'Parti' and Sohail Khan who are absconding."

Haren Pandya, a former Minister of State for Revenue in the Narendra Modi-led BJP government in Gujarat, was shot dead while out on a morning walk, sending shock waves through the state.

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Haren Pandya, a former Minister of State for Revenue in the Narendra Modi-led BJP government in Gujarat, was shot dead while out on a morning walk, sending shock waves through the state.



Jagruti Pandya, wife of former Gujarat minister Haren Pandya

Mufti Sufiyan 'Patangiya', a cleric in Ahmedabad, is suspected to have fled the country. He is accused of hatching the plot to kill Pandya, and "preparing" Ali and the others for it.

Ali's lawyer, who didn't want to be named, told *The Indian Express*: "We have sought remission on the ground that he has spent (more than) 14 years in jail and can get benefit of remission. He is entitled to it. The state government can take a

decision as it is empowered... It has the option to either grant the remission or to reject it."

Ali, who was in his 20s when held for the murder, is a native of Telangana.

Justice M R Mengdey of the High Court asked the government to decide on Ali's remission application in an order dated June 17, saying: "From the jail remarks submitted on record, it appears that the process for consideration of the case of the petitioner for grant of remission is underway and the opinion from the Advisory Committee has also been called for, which has been received and the same shall be put up before the concerned authority in the near future. Having regard to these aspects, the concerned authority shall take an appropriate decision, in accordance with law, on the application submitted by the petitioner for grant of remission, as expeditiously as possible, preferably within a period of 6

months from the date of receipt of the order."

In-charge Principal Secretary (Home) Sanjeev Kumar could not be reached for comment. The probe into Pandya's murder was handed over to the CBI after family members raised questions over police investigation. The CBI clubbed the case with an attempted murder, of VHP leader Jagdish Tiwari, just 15 days earlier, in Bapunagar area of Ahmedabad, in which Ali was also an accused.

Both cases were seen as reprisals for the 2002 Gujarat riots.

In 2007, a special CBI court convicted 12 persons in the case, including Ali, who was awarded life imprisonment. In 2011, the High Court acquitted all of them, citing a "botched" investigation.

The CBI and the state government appealed against the order, and the SC overturned the HC order in 2019. It upheld the trial court's judgment convicting the 12.

UDF govt faces hurdles, Cong veteran emerges as its sharpest critic

Shaju Philip  
Thiruvananthapuram, June 25

ONCE KNOWN as a crusader of the Congress in Kerala, senior leader V M Sudheeran is back in action, raising the banner of revolt against the party's one-month-old government.

The former state Congress president was largely inactive when the LDF was in power, but has repeatedly spoken out against the Budget proposals of the V D Satheesan government. He has opposed the proposal to reduce taxes on low-alcohol content beverages and the move to tap critical mineral resources along Kerala's southern coast.

After Satheesan presented the revised Budget in the Assembly last Friday, Sudheeran rushed a letter to the CM, asking him to withdraw both proposals.

During the debate on the Budget in the Assembly on Wednesday, Satheesan, who holds the Finance portfolio, said a decision on the sale of low-alcohol content liquor in Kerala would be taken only after deliberation within the UDF government. He also said there was no proposal to allow the mining of mineral sand by private entities

and dubbed as "baseless" the stories on the matter.

Not satisfied with the answers, Sudheeran upped the ante. Openly questioning the stand of Satheesan that UDF would take a policy decision on selling beverages with low alcohol content, Sudheeran said, "A decision abandoning the tax proposal should have been announced in the Assembly itself. The proposal should have been first debated within the party as well as the UDF. The UDF manifesto has promised steps against drug abuse and liquor. That word to the people should be fulfilled. When the Finance Bill is presented in the Assembly, it would be better to drop that tax proposal from the Bill."

Sudheeran also indicated that he does not agree with Satheesan's reply that private entities would not mine mineral sand, but only engage in value addition. "Pinarayi (government) too had stated in that manner that the mining will not be given to the private sector. The UDF should not go ahead with the anti-people policies of the CPI(M). I have the responsibility to see that the Satheesan government does not lose the support of the people," he said.

A power couple for BJD? Why Naveen inducted Pandian's wife

Sujit Bisoyi  
Bhubaneswar, June 25

FORMER IAS officer Sujata Rout Karthikeyan, the wife of bureaucrat-turned-politician V K Pandian, joined the BJD on Thursday. The development is being seen as BJD president and former CM Naveen Patnaik's broader "succession strategy" as his party grapples with challenges such as the defection of grassroots leaders to the BJP.

Amid reports of dissent brewing among a group of senior leaders over Karthikeyan's entry into the BJD, Patnaik tried to reach out to them with the message that he continues to be the party boss. "I would like to repeat that I will be leading the BJD in the next poll. I want to make that very clear," said Patnaik, adding that Karthikeyan would work as a "simple member" of the party.

Throughout his political life, Patnaik has had a trusted lieutenant help him run the govern-



BJD chief Naveen Patnaik felicitates former IAS officer Sujata Rout Karthikeyan as she joins the party on Thursday. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

ment and the party. While former bureaucrat Pyarimohan Mohapatra had that role until he fell out with the BJD chief in 2012, Pandian, who was Patnaik's private secretary in the CMO, has emerged as his closest aide in recent years.

"With Patnaik's advancing age, it's not possible for him to run the party singlehandedly. Among the current BJD leaders, no one enjoys his trust to be his second in command. To save the party from further damage, Pat-

naik has to shape the succession plan," said a BJD leader. Though Pandian quit politics after the BJD's Assembly polls rout in 2024, he continues to enjoy Patnaik's confidence and played a role in getting his wife inducted into BJD, said the leader.

BJD insiders said the decision to bring in the former IAS officer into the party was taken earlier this month during Patnaik's visit to Delhi. The BJD chief is learnt to have consulted his elder brother Prem Patnaik and others about the party's roadmap.

Mahesh Dixit, a J&K veteran, to be next Director of IB

Deeptiman Tiwary  
New Delhi, June 25



Mahesh Dixit is 1993-batch IPS officer

THE UNION Government on Thursday appointed 1993-batch IPS officer Mahesh Dixit as the new Director of Intelligence Bureau. He will succeed Tapan Deka, who has served as the IB chief for the past four years.

"The Appointments Committee of the Cabinet has approved the appointment of Shri Mahesh Dixit, IPS (AP:93), Special Director, Intelligence Bureau as Director, Intelligence Bureau vice Shri Tapan Kumar Deka, IPS (HP:88), for a tenure of two years from the date of assumption of the charge of the post....," a Department of Personnel and Training orders said.

An officer of the Andhra Pradesh cadre, Dixit has spent more than 26 years in the Intelligence Bureau. A good part of this has been spent in Jammu and Kashmir where he has served in two stints – first between 2009 and 2012, then between 2020 and 2025.

Both these periods tested the security establishment. The 2009-2012 period saw major attacks on security forces and ci-

vilians, as well as violent protests and stone-pelting.

The security picture changed again after the 2019 decisions on Article 370 and the state's constitutional status. The 2020-2025 period saw the emergence of hybrid terrorists who specifically targeted Kashmiri Pandits and migrant workers.

Dixit began his career as the SP of Vizag district in Andhra Pradesh but soon joined the IB. As an IB officer, he worked in Kohima, Patna and Hyderabad before being stationed in the headquarters and then sent to Kashmir.

'SYSTEMIC ASSAULT ON CIVIL SOCIETY' Congress, Left urge Centre to withdraw amended FCRA rules

Express News Service  
New Delhi, June 25

LEADERS OF the Congress and the CPI(M) wrote separately to Prime Minister Narendra Modi and Union Home Minister Amit Shah on Thursday, urging them to withdraw the recently notified Foreign Contribution (Regulation) Amendment Rules, 2026, alleging that the changes would severely restrict the functioning of NGOs, minority institutions and voluntary organisations across the country.

In the letter to the Prime Minister, Congress general secretary and Public Accounts Committee chairperson K C Venugopal described the amendments as a "systemic assault" on India's civil society and accused the government of attempting to tighten control over non-governmental organisations through executive action after facing resistance in Parliament.

"The latest amendments reflect a disturbing intent to micromanage, harass and financially cripple the voluntary sector," Venugopal wrote, arguing that forcing NGOs to choose activities from a government-prescribed list and restricting their operations to pre-approved geographical areas would undermine their ability to respond to emergencies and local needs.

Venugopal also objected to provisions requiring organisations to seek additional approvals and pay separate fees for expanding their operations to other states. According to Venugopal, the amendments impose "extortionate fines" of up to 30% of foreign funds received, or a minimum of Rs 1 lakh for violations such as operating outside approved geographical areas.

The Congress leader further criticised new disclosure requirements mandating NGOs to furnish details of their social media accounts, websites and publications, calling them part of a "mass surveillance" framework. Venugopal also linked the rules to the proposed Foreign Contribution (Regulation) Amendment Bill, 2026, which sought to create a "Designated Authority" to take over assets created from foreign contributions when an organisation's FCRA registration is cancelled, surrendered or expires. The government had deferred discussion on the Bill after Opposition protests in Parliament.

"Now, the government is attempting to implement the same draconian controls through the backdoor via executive rule amendments, completely bypassing the Lok Sabha," he said.

Separately, CPI(M) Rajya Sabha MP John Brittas wrote to Home Minister Amit Shah, raising what he termed "serious constitutional concerns" over the amendments and seeking their immediate withdrawal. Brittas argued that while regulation of foreign contributions is a legitimate sovereign function, it must not become a tool for restricting the functioning of charitable, educational and faith-based organisations.

In his letter, Brittas said the amendments marked a shift from regulating foreign funds to regulating voluntary organisations themselves, citing provisions that prescribe specific categories of activities, geographically restrict operations, expand reporting requirements and widen the definition of "key functionaries".

**NPCL**  
Noida Power Company Limited

**Noida Power Company Limited**  
Electric Sub Station, Knowledge Park-IV, Greater Noida-201310  
(CIN: U31200UP1992PLC014506)

**TENDER NOTICE** Date: 26-06-2026

Sealed tenders under Two-part Bid System (Technical & Commercial) are invited for the following works from interested/prospective bidders

| NIT No.           | Tender Description                                                                                                 | EMD (Rs.) | Start and Due Date & Time of Submission        |
|-------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|------------------------------------------------|
| NPCL/FY 26-27/010 | Hiring of agency for Comprehensive Annual Maintenance Contract of Hyper-Converged Infrastructure Servers for NPCL. | 0.50 Lac  | Start Date: 26-06-2026<br>Due Date: 11-07-2026 |
| NPCL/FY 26-27/011 | Implementation of OT Security Tool for the Security of OT Network of NPCL                                          | 3.00 Lac  | Start Date: 26-06-2026<br>Due Date: 17-07-2026 |

Cost of Individual Tender Document (Incl. GST) Rs 1180/-  
For other tender details and further amendment/corrigendum, please visit our website:  
[www.noidapower.com-->Procurement-->Tenders](http://www.noidapower.com-->Procurement-->Tenders)

DGM (CMM)

**IRCON INTERNATIONAL LIMITED**  
NAV RATNA COMPANY  
(A Govt. of India Undertaking)  
Website : [www.ircon.org](http://www.ircon.org), CIN - L45203DL1976GO008171

**e-Procurement Notice**

e-Tender No.: IRCON/NZ/CVL(eTEN)/12026/A Dated: 22.06.2026  
e-Tenders in single packet system are invited from bidders meeting qualifying requirements for the work of "Repair & Maintenance works of IRCON's flats at Asiad Village, New Delhi".

Estimated Cost of Work ₹ 38.56 lakhs  
Last Date & Time of e-Bid Submission 11.07.2026 at 15:00 hrs.

For further details, visit website <https://www.etenders.gov.in> and <https://www.eprocure.gov.in>. Corrigendum, if any, would be hosted only on the website.  
Chief General Manager/NRO  
C-4, District Centre, Saket, New Delhi-110017, e-mail: [ps.reddy@ircon.org](mailto:ps.reddy@ircon.org); +91-9560595082

**NATIONAL FERTILIZERS LIMITED**  
(A Govt. of India Undertaking)  
A-11, Sector-24, Noida-201301  
Phone No.-0120-2412294, Fax No.-2412397

**Pre-qualification for Supply of Neem Oil**  
National Fertilizers Limited intends to pre-qualify manufacturers for supply of Neem Oil to its Units and Ports.  
For PQ Document containing eligibility criteria & other details please visit our website: [www.nationalfertilizers.com](http://www.nationalfertilizers.com) or [www.eprocure.gov.in](http://www.eprocure.gov.in). Last date for submission of documents is **27.07.2026 up to 02:00 PM**. Corrigendum (if any) will be displayed on our website only.  
DGM-I/c (Materials)

**IRCON INTERNATIONAL LIMITED**  
NAV RATNA COMPANY  
(A Govt. of India Undertaking)  
Website : [www.ircon.org](http://www.ircon.org), CIN - L45203DL1976GO008171

**e-Procurement Notice**

e-Tender No.: IRCON/NZ/CVL(eTEN)/12026/B Dated: 22.06.2026  
e-Tenders in single packet system are invited from bidders meeting qualifying requirements for the work of "Repair & Maintenance works of IRCON's flats at Vasant Kunj and San Martin Marg, Anand Vihar and Northern Region Office, Greater Noida Depot and CIC Noida Depot".

Estimated Cost of Work ₹ 29.12 lakhs  
Last Date & Time of e-Bid Submission 11.07.2026 at 15:00 hrs.

For further details, visit website <https://www.etenders.gov.in> and <https://www.eprocure.gov.in>. Corrigendum, if any, would be hosted only on the website.  
Chief General Manager/NRO  
C-4, District Centre, Saket, New Delhi-110017, e-mail: [ps.reddy@ircon.org](mailto:ps.reddy@ircon.org); +91-9560595082





Field Duty

AMID THE Ram Temple donation controversy, Union Agriculture Minister Shivraj Singh Chouhan visited Ayodhya district on Thursday as part of his ministry's 'Khet Bachao Abhiyan'. He interacted with farmers and participated in paddy plantation activities in their fields. Chouhan, who arrived in Lucknow from Delhi with around a dozen senior ministry officials, met Uttar Pradesh Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath in Lucknow. The minister did not visit Ayodhya town or the Ram Temple as he had to return to Delhi the same evening. He asked some of the officials to proceed to Pantnagar in neighbouring Uttarakhand, where Chouhan is scheduled to address an alumni event on Friday. The officials, it is learnt, undertook a six-hour road journey to reach Pantnagar in the evening.

Striking a Chord

SOME LEADERS in the AICC communications team took note of MP Imran Masood's compassion for students during a press conference in Bhopal as part of the Congress's 'Chhatron Ki Goonj' campaign. Masood, an MP from UP's Saharanpur, had invited a student to the briefing. When the youngster broke down while talking about exams and his hard work, Masood was quick to console him with a hug. The communications team has already started sharing the video. It plans to use it more on social media to "draw attention to the empathy shown" by the Congress MP.

Courting Trouble

OPPOSING THE request of some lawyers convicted in a murder case for more time to surrender so that they can entrust their pending briefs to some other lawyer, the prosecution told the Supreme Court that their Bar Council licence to practise had been suspended in 2017. Justice B V Nagarathna, who presided over the bench, cautioned, "Advocates, what all you do we don't want to express. Even if you are barred, you will be practising... We can say many more things explaining ourselves. So don't tell against another advocate. If you point one finger, three will point at you." The court gave the convicts one more week to surrender.

ROW OVER PUNJAB CM VIDEO

Mann claims face mask used to create fake video; 'whataboutery', says Opp

Kanchan Vasdev  
Chandigarh, June 25

IN A fresh twist in the matter pertaining to his purported "objectionable" video, Punjab Chief Minister Bhagwant Mann Thursday said that the person seen in the clip was not him and was instead a person wearing a mask resembling his face, a claim the Opposition parties termed "whataboutery".

Addressing the media in Mohali, Mann released two videos — one showing a Canada-based person Jagman Samra holding a mask that resembles his (Mann's) face and the other in which the mask line is allegedly visible on the person's profile. He alleged the person used sunglasses to conceal the eyes despite the footage being shot inside a hotel room in Canada. Mann further said that he would send the videos and supporting evidence to the Akal Takht.



Punjab CM Bhagwant Mann in Mohali on Thursday. PTI

Mann had earlier claimed that the video was AI-generated and that 'Singh Sahibhs' could get its forensic examination done from any lab in the country. The Akal Takht has declared the clip "authentic" and declared Mann to be against the Gurus and the Panth. On June 18, Mann claimed that some actor was imitating him and cited reports of two forensic labs showing that the man in the alleged ob-

jectionable video was someone else.

"The individual in the video is two inches taller than me, has a different body structure, walking style and mannerisms," Mann said.

Meanwhile, BJP's Tarun Chugh accused Mann of "whataboutery".

"First, Mann said the video was 'AI-generated', and then he claimed that he was not in the video," Chugh said. "Now, the person is wearing a mask. What's next, Bhagwant Mann? Will you claim tomorrow that the person in the video is your long-lost twin brother?" the Rajya Sabha MP asked. "Your endless whataboutery, excuses and shifting narratives cannot erase what has already been exposed," Chugh added.

Punjab Congress chief Amrinder Singh Raja Warring dismissed Mann's claim as a "weak excuse".

As Akal Takht summons Sikh MLAs, AAP legislators restive

Chandigarh: The Akal Takht summons to all Sikh legislators and Sikh Cabinet Ministers of the Punjab government in connection with the anti-sacrilege law passed by the Assembly has left the ruling AAP MLAs restive with many fearing they could be left to fend for themselves on an issue that has both political and religious implications.

Bagicha Singh, in-charge of the Akal Takht Secretariat, on Thursday said letters were sent to all 78 Sikh MLAs and nine Sikh cabinet ministers, asking them to reach the Secretariat on June 29 to present their views on "The Jagat Jyot Sri Guru Granth Sahib Satkar (Amendment) Act, 2026," which has been notified... without consultation or consent

from Sri Akal Takht Sahib, the SGPC and the Guru Khalsa Panth". A letter was also sent to Speaker Kultar Singh Sandhwan. Letters have also been sent to non-Sikh cabinet ministers, asking them to submit their views before June 29.

Several AAP legislators told *The Indian Express* that while Mann has adopted a confrontational stance towards the Jatendar, they are not prepared to risk being seen as defying the Akal Takht. "In my constituency, defying the Akal Takht will be taken very seriously...What if they declare me *tankhaiya* (guilty of violating the religious code of conduct) for not going?", asked an AAP MLA on condition of anonymity. ENS

Congress begins 40-day nationwide campaign: 'Trust of students shattered'

Express News Service  
New Delhi, June 25

RECURRING EXAMINATION irregularities was evidence of a "massive institutional failure" in the education system, the Congress said on Thursday as it announced a 40-day nationwide outreach as part of its 'Chhatron Ki Goonj' campaign in the wake of controversies surrounding the NEET and other exams.

A total of 28 press conferences were held on the issue across India, with Congress Deputy Leader in the Lok Sabha, Gaurav Gogoi, saying the trust of students had been shattered.

In New Delhi, Gogoi said repeated instances of paper leaks and disruptions in examinations had created a perception among students that the problem was "systemic". "The trust of India's students has been broken. Who will take responsibility for so many broken dreams?"

During the campaign, the party will engage with students and collect feedback on issues, ranging from paper leaks and recruitment delays to broader concerns in the education sector.

In Ranchi, Congress Rajya Sabha member Imran Pratapgarhi sought accountability. "This campaign will be conducted across 28 major cities, engaging students, job aspirants,



Lok Sabha Deputy LoP Gaurav Gogoi in New Delhi, Thursday. ANI

college campuses..."

At press conferences in different cities, a common demand was resignation of Education Minister Dharmendra Pradhan.

In Chandigarh, Congress Working Committee member Rajeev Shukla, Punjab Congress president Amarinder Singh Raja Warring and Chandigarh Congress president Rajwinder Lucky said the campaign would begin on June 30 and continue till August 9. The campaign will conclude with demonstrations at collectorates across 28 cities on August 1 and a "Sansad Gherao" in New Delhi on August 9 to press for action on students' concerns, the Congress leaders said.

Among the cities where press conference were held are Bhubaneswar, Nagpur, Ahmedabad, Pune, Jaipur, Sikar, Kota, and Bhopal.

Bengal govt to bring UCC Bill this session

Ravik Bhattacharya  
Kolkata, June 25

THE NEW BJP government in West Bengal is planning to bring in a Bill on implementing the Uniform Civil Code in the state during the ongoing Assembly session.

During the Assembly elections in the state, the BJP had promised to implement the Uniform Civil Code (UCC) within six months of being voted to power as part of its manifesto.

"It is likely that the UCC Bill will be introduced in the Assembly and it will be a law in this Assembly session itself. It will be a milestone. It is in tune with our party's policy of one nation, one law," said a senior BJP MLA.

According to sources, a business advisory (BA) meeting was held late Thursday evening at the state Assembly, where tabling of the Bills, including UCC, was discussed.

"The Bill may be placed on Monday," said a source.

The Uniform Civil Code is a proposed framework to replace religion-based personal laws with one common set of secular laws governing marriage, divorce, inheritance, and adoption for all citizens. Rooted in Article 44 of the Constitution, it seeks to promote gender justice and national integration.

Historically, personal laws, such as the Hindu Marriage Act or Muslim Personal Law, have governed private affairs.

The BJP has already implemented UCC in Uttarakhand and passed the law in Gujarat.

Assam became the third BJP state to implement UCC and passed a Bill last month after returning to power in the state.

The BJP in West Bengal has also promised strict laws against "love jihad", a term used by the party to refer to the marriage of a Muslim man with a Hindu woman, and "land jihad", stating that its objective is to protect the state's "social and territorial integrity" in its manifesto.

BJP slams Cong, urges citizens to 'remember truth of Emergency'

Express News Service  
New Delhi, June 25

MARKING 50 years of Emergency, the BJP on Thursday took on the Congress stating that those "who talk about saving democracy" had once "carried out attacks on democratic institutions".

BJP president Nitin Nabin described the Emergency as the "darkest chapter in the history of Indian democracy", writing on X that it was not merely a political decision, but a deliberate attack on the Constitution.

Senior BJP leader and former Union Minister Ravi Shankar

Prasad recalled "attacks carried out by the Congress government on democratic institutions, the judiciary, the media, and citizens' rights" as he urged the people to "remember the truth of that era." Prasad said, "Today, many people talk about saving democracy and show the Constitution; therefore, it is also necessary to ... recall what happened 50 years ago."

In the face of censorship, Prasad added, it was institutions like *Panchjanya* (the RSS mouthpiece), *Motherland*, *Organizer*, and *The Indian Express* which "fought a major battle of resistance".

EXPRESS special  
300 exotic items up for grabs as MEA opens up its gift collection to public

Auction kicked off on June 8, will conclude on June 30

Divya A  
New Delhi, June 25

A ROLEX Yacht Master II, a silver dagger from Oman, a silver tea set made in London, even an Apple MacBook Pro — these are some of the items up for grabs with the Ministry of External Affairs opening up its collection of exotic presents and souvenirs from the Toshakhana to the public.

In a first-of-its-kind move, around 300 gifts received by senior ministry officials, including the Foreign Secretary, during their official international trips over the years are up for auction, with prices ranging between Rs 2,385 and Rs 17 lakh, which kicked off on June 8.

Officials tell *The Indian Express* that this is the first ever such e-auction open to the general public, enabled in compliance with revised Toshakhana Rules, 2024. Among the most popular items at the auction is an antique silver box which came to the Toshakhana in the 1980s, originally designed as a high-end cigar or cigarette container.

With a base price of Rs 12,030, the object has received 29 bids so far, with the highest one exceeding Rs 52,000. Two Rolex Yacht Master watches, with a starting price of Rs 16.5 lakh, have garnered more than

• MOST POPULAR ITEMS

**Antique silver box**  
● Bids so far: **29 bids**  
Base price: Highest bid:  
**₹12,030 ₹52,000**



**Two Rolex Yacht Master watches**  
● Bids so far: **over a dozen**  
Base price: Highest bid:  
**₹16.5 lakh ₹16.79 lakh**

**Decorative silver box with 20 gram fine gold biscuit from Switzerland**  
● Bids so far: **eight**  
Starting price: Highest bid:  
**₹3.92 lakh ₹4.06 lakh**

a dozen bids, going up to Rs 16.79 lakh now. On the other hand, a gold jewellery set from Kuwait by the Al Arabsh brand, including a necklace, bracelet, and earrings, with a base price of Rs 9.5 lakh, hasn't received any bids so far.

A decorative silver box, flanked by two gold plated dragons, carrying a 20 gram fine gold biscuit from the renowned Argor Heraeus brand of Switzerland and a starting price of Rs 3.92 lakh, has clocked in eight bids so far — going up to Rs 4.06 lakh.

The auction closes on June 30, after which the products will be shipped free of cost to the successful bidders, according to officials. The Establishment Division (Toshakhana Section) of MEA is conducting the auction, they said, adding that the evaluation price of the items is decided by a committee.

For the auction, the base price of the items has been calculated as its evaluation price plus the cost of packing and delivery, officials added.

This is the first time that To-

shakhana items can be acquired by the general public. Interestingly, the last auction, which was held in 1983, was open only to the government employees at the MEA headquarters.

The proceeds of the auction will go to the Consolidated Fund of India (CFI). While no item received by any political functionary has been selected this time, the Ministry is now planning the next round of this auction, wherein presents received by consecutive External Affairs Ministers will also be added. "In the present round, items received by the government officers (Foreign Secretary and below) have been published," said officials.

Toshakhana is the repository of gift items/articles received in India or abroad by the government functionaries from foreign sources and dignitaries.

The items offered for auction are primarily heritage, souvenir, decorative, collectible, or ceremonial items and may not necessarily be intended for functional, commercial, or operational use.

Kharge & kin grabbed public land, gave it to shady private trust: BJP

Express News Service  
New Delhi, June 25

THE BJP on Wednesday leveled allegations of misuse of public land and corruption in Karnataka against the Siddharth Vihara Trust linked to Congress President Mallikarjun Kharge and his family.

BJP National Spokesperson Pradeep Bhandari claimed that several acres of valuable government and industrial land in Bengaluru, Gulbarga and Banashankari were allotted to the trust in the name of aerospace, defence, Pali research, while the trust had no actual work in these fields.

Bhandari alleged that Mallikarjun Kharge and Priyank Kharge used their political influence to transfer land belonging to the poor, farmers and the public in favour of their private trust. There was alleged land-grabbing connected to the Siddharth Vihara Trust in 2024, Bhandari claimed, when the KIADB (Karnataka Industrial Area Development Board) allotted five acres of land to it.

"At that time, Congress was in power in Karnataka, Mallikarjun Kharge was Congress President (and still is), and Priyank Kharge was a minister... Siddharth Vihara Trust had neither done any work in aerospace nor



If there was wrongdoing, why am I not in jail: Priyank Kharge

carried out any research in aerospace or defence," he alleged.

Bhandari questioned how the government could allot five acres of industrial land to a trust in which Mallikarjun Kharge himself is a member, when this land should have been given to an institution connected with industry or aerospace.

Reacting to Bhandari's allegations, Karnataka Home Minister Priyank Kharge said that his papers were publicly available. "People are asking for the accounts of the Ram Mandir in Ayodhya, but the BJP is working overtime to demand the accountability of Lord Buddha in Kalaburagi," said Kharge.

"Modi Sarkar has been in power for 12 years. If there was wrongdoing, why am I still roaming free and not in jail?" asked the Congress leader.

NOW INTO HIS FOURTH EXTENSION, THE 61-YR-OLD HAS BEEN GOVT'S MAIN LINE OF DEFENCE IN COURT ON CONSEQUENTIAL ISSUES — FROM KASHMIR TO RAM TEMPLE

Being Tushar Mehta: The 'fierce fighter' for Modi govt has redefined SG role

Vineet Bhalla  
New Delhi, June 25

A FOURTH extension on June 20 reaffirms the role of Tushar Mehta, already the second-longest serving Solicitor General of India, as the Union government's principal courtroom strategist.

Since he was appointed first as Additional SG in 2014, and promoted in 2018 to SG, Mehta, 61, has been the Narendra Modi government's main line of defence in court on many consequential political decisions — from Kashmir to Ram temple, citizenship issues to electoral funding. Under him, the post of the SG — officially the second-highest law officer in the country, aiding and assisting the Attorney General of India — has emerged as the government's primary voice in courts.

Mehta, who earlier worked under Modi as the Additional Advocate General of Gujarat, has been consistent in his arguments: that courts should give

precedence to decisions taken by elected governments, particularly where questions of governance, security or public policy are involved.

Peers and opposing counsel alike speak of Mehta's "relentlessness". Senior Advocate Sanjay Hegde, who has appeared on the opposite side of Mehta in several Constitutional matters, told *The Indian Express* that the SG is a "fierce fighter" for the government. He also notes that Mehta is not averse to course-correcting when necessary. "Where mistakes have been made, he uses his good offices to rectify them before any adverse orders get passed."

Mehta's firefighting ability is also acknowledged by Senior Advocate Atmaram N S Nadkarni, who worked alongside Mehta when both were Additional Solicitors General. Calling him a "formidable counsel", Nadkarni highlights Mehta's ubiquitous presence across courtrooms. "He appears even in the Delhi High Court and

other courts; it is marvellous how he manages to be at so many places," Nadkarni says.

The only other person to have a longer tenure than Mehta in the post was C K Daphtary, who served as SG in the first government after Independence, led by Jawaharlal Nehru, from 1950 to 1963.

Set to remain as SG till 2029, Mehta will be appearing for the government in several critical cases in the next few years, including challenges to the Waqf (Amendment) Act, anti-conversion laws, and the Places of Worship (Special Provisions) Act.

His court wins

**RAFALE DEAL:** One of the earliest high-profile matters to come to Mehta's table was the challenge to the Rafale fighter aircraft deal, alleging irregularities in the procurement process and seeking an investigation into the purchase. Mehta said that courts should not enter questions of defence procurement and military preparedness



Mehta is India's second-longest serving Solicitor General

unless there was clear evidence of illegality. The Supreme Court ultimately declined to interfere with the deal, in an order in December 2018.

**RAM TEMPLE:** Another defining case where Mehta appeared was the Ram Janmabhoomi dispute. In November 2019, the Supreme Court ruled that the 2.77-acre disputed land be handed over to a government-run trust for a Ram Mandir, while mandating a 5-acre alternative plot in

Ayodhya for a mosque — bringing to an end a dispute that had long been part of the BJP's core agenda.

**ARTICLE 370:** The abrogation of the legislation by the Modi government on August 5, 2019, was the fulfilment of another ideological agenda of the BJP, removing Jammu and Kashmir's special status. Appearing before a five-judge Constitution Bench, Mehta argued that Article 370 had been a temporary provision, and that Parliament could validly exercise legislative powers during President's Rule, which J&K was under in 2019.

In December 2023, the Supreme Court unanimously upheld the government's decision.

**CITIZENSHIP ISSUES:** During litigation relating to challenges to Section 6A of the Citizenship Act, Mehta defended the government's efforts to address illegal migration.

The government's approach to citizenship also came under scrutiny after Parliament enacted the Citizenship

(Amendment) Act. While the law remains under challenge before the Supreme Court, Mehta has consistently argued that Parliament is entitled to create special citizenship pathways for persecuted minorities from neighbouring countries.

**COVID:** As thousands of migrant workers attempted to return home during the nationwide pandemic lockdown, petitions reached the Supreme Court seeking immediate relief for them. Mehta defended the administration's response.

Similar arguments were advanced in litigation concerning the PM CARES Fund. The petitions demanding that PM CARES be brought under RTI were ultimately dismissed by the apex court in August 2020.

**PMLA:** In 2022, the Supreme Court heard challenges to key provisions of the Prevention of Money Laundering Act, which gives extensive investigative powers to the Enforcement Directorate and restricts bail to those accused under the Act,

against claims of due process and personal liberty. Mehta argued that money laundering is a serious economic crime with international dimensions, requiring specialised powers to investigate effectively. The SC largely upheld the law, reinforcing the ED's powers, in July 2022.

**EWs:** Mehta also prevailed in the challenge to the 10% reservation for economically weaker sections. In November 2022, a Constitution Bench of the Supreme Court upheld the amendment creating the quota, accepting the government's argument that economic disadvantage could be an independent basis for affirmative action.

**UAPA:** In prosecutions and bail applications under the Unlawful Activities (Prevention) Act, the principal anti-terror law, the SG has argued that judges should take into account the gravity of allegations and wider security implications when considering bail.

**SEDITION:** During the Constitutional challenge to the law of

sedition under the erstwhile IPC, the Centre adopted a different strategy. Rather than defending the law in its existing form, Mehta informed the Court that the government was reconsidering the provision. The proceedings led to a pause on new sedition prosecutions.

His court setbacks

The Supreme Court did not accept the government's argument of institutional deference during the Pegasus spyware litigation. Faced with allegations that government agencies had used surveillance software against journalists, activists and politicians, Mehta argued that questions involving national security could not always be answered in open court. In October 2021, the Supreme Court appointed an expert committee to examine the allegations, declining to accept the government's position at face value.

The electoral bonds case was another major defeat for the government.



# Nari Shakti

## Shaping a Stronger India

### 12 Years of PM-Led Transformation in Women's Empowerment

From Safety to Self-Reliance | From Welfare to Leadership



The last 12 years under the visionary leadership of Prime Minister Narendra Modi have redefined women-led development as the cornerstone of New India. Guided by the belief that the progress of a nation is impossible without the empowerment of its women, path-breaking initiatives have strengthened security, dignity, health, education, entrepreneurship and financial independence. In Uttar Pradesh, Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath has translated this national vision into large-scale action. Over the last nine years, women's empowerment has moved beyond slogans to measurable outcomes, creating a safer, stronger, and more self-reliant Uttar Pradesh where women are emerging as the driving force behind the vision of Viksit Uttar Pradesh 2047.

#### EDUCATION, NUTRITION & A BRIGHT FUTURE

##### Mukhyamantri Kanya Sumangala Yojana

Financial assistance from birth to graduation, **27 Lakh+** girls benefitted

Assistance increased from **₹15,000** to **₹25,000**

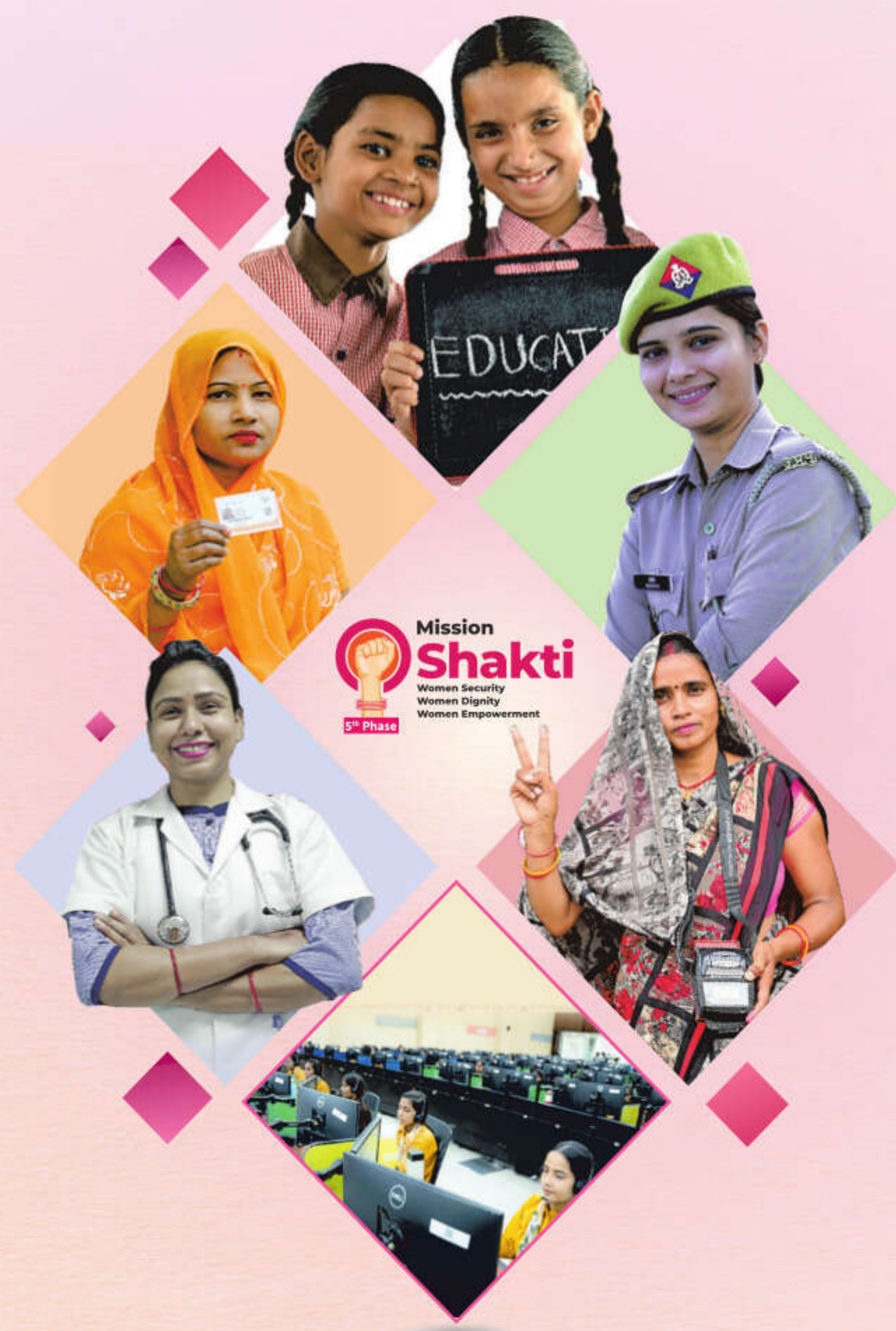
##### Beti Bachao, Beti Padhao

**3.47 lakh** awareness activities

More than **2.85 crore** women and girls reached

##### Rani Lakshmibai Scooty Yojana

Proposal to provide scooters to meritorious Class XII girls



#### DIGNITY WITH SOCIAL SECURITY

##### Support for Every Stage of Life

##### Destitute Women's Pension Scheme

**40.34 lakh** women are receiving regular pension  
Pension enhanced from **₹1,000** to **₹1,500** per month

##### Mukhyamantri Samuhik Vivah Yojana

**5.50 lakh** daughters married with dignity

Supporting poor families, widows & abandoned women

##### Public Facilities for Women's Dignity

Under the Swachh Bharat Mission (Urban), Pink Toilets & Community Toilets built across 189 urban bodies

#### FINANCIAL INCLUSION AT THE GRASSROOTS

##### BC Sakhi Initiative

**39,885** BC Sakhis active

Facilitated financial transactions worth **₹42,711 crore+**

##### Vidyut Sakhi Model

**15,409** women collected electricity bills worth **₹3,207 crore**

Earned **₹41.3 crore** in commissions

##### Surya Sakhi Initiative

Women trained in renewable energy, solar product sales, and maintenance.

#### SAFE, SECURE & CONFIDENT



##### A Security Ecosystem Built Around Women

- 112** Police Escort Service ensures safe travel for women between 10 PM and 6 AM
- 2.39 lakh** women benefitted through One Stop Centres
- Special operations including Operation Garud, Shield, Destroy, Bachpan, Khoj, Dial and Raksha

##### Women-Centric Policing

- 44,000+** women recruited into the police force
- 19,839** women police personnel appointed under focused initiatives
- 9,172** Women beats allocated across the state
- New battalions** expanding to Balrampur, Jalaun, Mirzapur, Shamli, and Bijnor

#### HEALTHY WOMEN, HEALTHY NATION



##### Pradhan Mantri Matru Vandana Yojana

- ₹5,000** assistance for the first child
- ₹6,000** support for second girl child

##### Mission Niramaya

- 7,000** additional nursing seats
- 2,000** additional paramedical seats

##### Saksham Anganwadi & Poshan 2.0

- Uttar Pradesh became the first state to implement this model on a large scale

##### Insurance and Healthcare Security

- 1.89 lakh** Anganwadi workers and helpers covered under PM Jeevan Jyoti Bima Yojana, ensuring financial security for their families.
- 2.77 lakh** beneficiaries under PM Suraksha Bima Yojana
- Ayushman Bharat provides **₹5 lakh** annual health insurance cover

#### WOMEN LEADING THE ECONOMY



##### Startup Revolution

- 10,800+** startups under women's leadership
- Women-led startups** increased from 174 in 2017 to 2,525 in 2025
- Strong support through the Seed Fund, Credit Guarantee, and Fund of Funds

##### Workforce Participation

- Female Workforce Participation Rate increased from **13% to 36%**

##### Women's Economic Empowerment Index

- First-of-its-kind state index covering all **75 districts**
- Measures entrepreneurship, employment, education, mobility, and safety

##### Fair Price Shops and Retail Opportunities

- 23%** of 78,510 ration shops allocated to women
- Shopping complexes planned at the Nyaya Panchayat level

#### RURAL WOMEN POWERING A NEW ECONOMY



##### Lakhpati Didi Mission

- 18.55 lakh** women have become Lakhpati Didis

##### Self-Help Groups Changing Rural India

- 60,000** women directly employed

##### Drone Didi Revolution

- 131** drones deployed for fertilizer spraying
- 530** new Drone Didis under selection
- 114** SHGs provided free drones
- 457** women trained

##### Women in Agriculture

- 1.48 lakh** women sugarcane farmers issued cane slips

##### UP-AGREES Project

- Empowering **10 lakh farmers**, enriching **1 lakh+** fisherfolk families
- 30%** participation by women farmers

##### Farmer Training

- 15.20 lakh** farmers trained through Kisan Pathshalas
- Women farmers equipped with modern agricultural techniques

#### HELPLINES FOR WOMEN IN DISTRESS

**1076**

CM  
HELPLINE

**1090**

WOMEN  
POWERLINE

**181**

WOMEN  
HELPLINE

**108**

AMBULANCE  
SERVICES

**1098**

CHILD  
LINE

**1930**

CYBER  
HELPLINE

**112**

NIGHT ASSISTANCE  
& POLICE EMERGENCY

**102**

AMBULANCE SERVICES FOR  
PREGNANT WOMEN & NEWBORNS







## LOHAGAD FORT KILLING

## Accused Siya, Chetan trying to pin blame on each other: Police

## Form SIT to probe Ketan's death: Assembly to govt

Sushant Kulkarni  
Pune, June 25

Accused Siya Goyal and her lover Chetan Chaudhary

INVESTIGATING THE murder of Ketan Agarwal (25), the Pune Rural Police said that his fiancée Siya Goyal (20) and her lover Chetan Chaudhary (22) — accused of killing him by pushing him off a cliff from Lohagad fort — have attempted to put the onus of the conspiracy on each other during their interrogation.

While Chetan claimed he wanted to elope and the plan to murder was Siya's, she maintained that it was Chetan's plan and he even cried after they could not eliminate Ketan during their earlier visit to the fort on June 14. The probe by Pune rural police unearthed a murder conspiracy, allegedly plotted by Siya and Chetan, who had been in a relationship since October 2025.

The Maharashtra Assembly on Thursday directed the government to form an SIT to probe the case. The move came after NCP MLA Sunil Shelke raised a point of information in the Assembly about the case, and MLAs from both the ruling party and the Opposition demanded formation of the SIT.

Ketan and Siya were engaged on February 19, and were slated to get married later this year in a destination wedding in Rajasthan. Siya, however, did not want to marry Ketan, police said.

Siya and Chetan were arrested on June 23 as police unravelled the conspiracy. The two have been remanded to police custody until June 29. Their separate interrogations by a team from Pune rural police is under-

way. Probe revealed that Siya had earlier sabotaged their plan for a pre-wedding shoot in Bali by allegedly stealing Ketan's passport and had taken him to Lohagad fort on two occasions — on May 31 and June 14 — before she and Chetan murdered him on June 18 by pushing him off the Western cliff of the fort.

Police said Siya had been insisting Ketan to go to Lohagad on June 4 too, but Ketan's mother did not allow it. "Investigation teams are interrogating Siya and Chetan separately. They are trying to put the onus of the conspiracy on each other, which clearly seems to be their defence strategy. We have chain of evidence that suggests that they were both in on the conspiracy to eliminate Ketan. Chetan has claimed that he wanted to elope and that it was Siya who wanted to kill Ketan. Siya on the other hand has claimed it was Chetan who wanted to kill Ketan. Siya has said that Chetan cried in front of her after the plane could not be executed on June 14," said a police officer.

"Our probe suggests that Siya and Chetan have been in a relationship since October 2025 after they connected during a Diwali celebration. Chetan used multiple phone numbers. Analysis of call detail records between Siya and Chetan shows they exchanged over 4,400 calls in the past one year," another officer said.

## Warehouse collapse: Toll now 11; CM blames ex-mayor for 'faulty design'

## Hakim's former OSD among 6 held; SIT constituted

Atri Mitra & Sweetey Kumari  
Kolkata, June 25

The owner and officials of the Taratala warehouse being produced in a court in Kolkata on Thursday. PTI

AS THE death toll in the Taratala warehouse collapse rose to 11, the Kolkata police said on Thursday they have arrested six people, including a structural engineer and a site supervisor. Kalicharan Banerjee, the OSD to former Kolkata Mayor Firhad Hakim, has also been arrested.

Meanwhile, the case has been transferred to the Detective Department, and an SIT has been constituted to probe the alleged construction flaws.

Chief Minister Suvendu Adhikari targeted the previous TMC government over allegedly approving faulty and unsafe construction plans, while assuring that "nobody will be spared".

Waving a piece of paper while addressing the Assembly, the Chief Minister alleged the building plan for the under-construction warehouse was approved despite a faulty design, and that the paper allegedly bore the signatures of former Kolkata mayor and TMC MLA Hakim.

"A faulty building plan was approved by the KMC (Kolkata Municipal Corporation). Nobody will be spared. These are all

sins during your [the TMC's] regime," Adhikari told the House, while claiming, "Trinamool made Kolkata a City of Death".

Meanwhile, Hakim has refuted all allegations, asserting that a mayor has no authority in sanctioning building plans. Responding to the allegations, Hakim told PTI he was unaware of the specific plan in question and maintained that building plans are scrutinised

and approved by the municipal Building department.

"I have no knowledge about this matter. Plans are approved by the building department. Unfortunately, I have not studied engineering, and such plans are not supposed to come to me for scrutiny. I have no idea about this particular plan. Files used to come to me only for final approval," he said.

The CM said that rescue operations were still on, adding that five people were arrested in connection with the incident. The state government has also announced an ex gratia of Rs 10 lakh to the kin of each deceased, and Rs 1 lakh each for the injured. Separately, the Prime Minister's Office has announced an assistance of Rs 2 lakh for the families of each of the deceased.

Meanwhile, Adhikari also announced that all construction activities in Kolkata and its surrounding areas would be stalled until cleared by a state-appointed audit committee.

## BRIEFLY



LoP in J&amp;K Assembly Sunil Sharma, along with security personnel and workers, in Kishtwar's Chishoti on Thursday. ANI

## JAMMU AND KASHMIR

## With 140-ft new bailey bridge, BRO restores key road link in Kishtwar

THE BORDER Roads Organisation (BRO) Thursday inaugurated a 140-foot bailey bridge in Chishoti, restoring road connectivity between Gulabgarh and Machail in J&K's Kishtwar. The triple-double reinforced bailey bridge replaces the earlier structure, which was washed away in a cloudburst on August 14, 2025, severing the only road link to the remote Machail region. Inaugurated by Lt General P K Mishra, GOC White Knight Corps, in the presence of LoP in J&K Assembly Sunil Sharma, the bridge was constructed within 12 days by the 118 Road Construction Company of 35 Border Roads Task Force, under the Sampark Project. ENS

## Woman finds groom drunk, calls off wedding

A 22-YEAR-OLD woman refused to marry after finding the groom heavily inebriated during the wedding ceremony, leading to a scuffle at the venue in Chhattisgarh's Janjgir-Champa district. The woman, Muskan Pradhan, was felicitated by Janjgir-Champa SP Vijay Kumar Pandey at his office in Janjgir on Thursday for taking a stand against liquor addiction, officers said. Pradhan, a resident of Kos-manda, was scheduled to marry Sant Ram (24) from Khokhra on June 23. PTI

## 4 killed, 2 injured in car-truck collision in MP

FOUR PERSONS were killed and two others injured after the car they were travelling in rammed into a truck from behind in Madhya Pradesh's Mandsaur district on Thursday, police said. It took place on Delhi-Mumbai Expressway at around 11 am. "The speeding car hit the truck from behind near Sitamau town. While two persons died on the spot, as many succumbed to their injuries during treatment," Sitamau police station in charge Kamlesh Prajapati said. The car was registered in Maharashtra, he said. PTI

## EXPRESS special

## 'One meal, beaten with sticks, no phones': 12 men rescued from UP factory recall horror

Manish Sahu  
Lucknow, June 25

The rescued bonded labourers in UP's Muzaffarnagar, Thursday. PTI

FOR THREE months, Meharbaan Shah (68) lived in uncertainty. He didn't know if his son, Dilshad Mohammad, his youngest, was alive. The 24-year-old had left home in Uttar Pradesh's Amroha district five months ago, hoping to find work and support his family. For the first few weeks, Dilshad regularly called his wife, Gulista Begum. Then, one day, the calls stopped.

"We looked for him everywhere, only to hit a dead end..." said Meharbaan. "After exhausting every possibility, I left it to God. Gulista, too, lost hope... she believed something terrible must have happened to Dilshad... she returned to her parents' home with their young son." On Tuesday, Meharbaan's phone rang — it was Dilshad. He and 11 other men were rescued Monday by the Muzaffarnagar police from a factory manufacturing disposable leaf plates in Titawi, where they were allegedly held as bonded labourers.

Police said the workers were confined for months, forced to work for up to 20 hours a day, subjected to repeated physical abuse. "When I heard my son's voice, I was so overwhelmed that I couldn't speak for a few moments," said Meharbaan. "The first thing I asked was where he was. He said Muzaffarnagar. I just asked him to come home."

For Dilshad, the three months at the factory were like living in hell. "We were never allowed to leave the premises," he told *The Indian Express* over the phone. "If anyone asked to go home, questioned the conditions, or even slept for over 3-4 hours, they were beaten and tortured. They also took away my cellphone, so I had no way of telling my family or anyone outside what we were enduring."

On Monday, a joint team of the police, district administration and labour department raided the manufacturing unit in Mandi village after receiving information from a man who had reportedly escaped from the factory. The men, aged between 16 and 44, from Bihar, UP, Uttarakhand, Chhattisgarh, Haryana and Rajasthan, were rescued. Police have arrested two persons — Pradeep Balyan (49), father of factory owner Ankit Balyan, and Ankit's associate, Shiva Tyagi (26). Ankit is on the run; police said they are trying to arrest him.

The accused were booked under relevant sections of the Child and Adolescent Labour (Prohibition and Regulation) Act, 1986; the Juvenile Justice (Care and Protection of Children) Act, 2015; and the Bonded Labour System (Abolition) Act, 1976.

Police said the workers alleged they had been lured from railway stations and other public places by Ankit and others with promises of steady jobs, decent wages, free accommodation and meals, only to find themselves trapped inside the factory. Inside, the accused allegedly kept the men under control through violence, intimidation and verbal abuse, subjecting them to inhumane living and working conditions while preventing them

from leaving the premises. Muzaffarnagar SP Sanjai Kumar said an SIT, headed by SP Mahadik Akshay Sanjay, was formed to conduct a comprehensive probe into the allegations.

Recounting the abuse, Sonu Chauhan from Agra said he had been working at the factory for the past two months. "I was brought here from Ambala after being promised a salary of Rs 14,000 a month for an eight-hour workday, with free food and accommodation," said the 42-year-old. "As soon as I arrived, they took away my cellphone. The harassment began immediately. We were given only one meal a day, usually dry rotis. Whenever we asked for our wages or asked to leave, we were beaten with sticks and abused. We were forced to work like bonded labourers... The accused had several implements, including iron rods and heavy sticks, which they used to assault us."

Police have also registered a case of murder against Ankit and Shiva after workers, in their statements, claimed a fellow labourer, identified as Topi alias Arjun, died after being assaulted at the factory. Also, all 12 workers bore visible injury marks on their bodies and were medically examined, police said.

FULL REPORT ON  
WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

## Court convicts 65-yr-old for rape-murder of 3-yr-old in Pune

Express News Service  
Pune, June 25

A SPECIAL court in Pune Thursday convicted a 65-year-old man on charges of raping and murdering a three-year-old girl in May this year. The sentence will be pronounced on June 29, officials said.

The accused was physically produced before the court at around 11.10 am on Thursday. Special Judge S R Salunkhe told him that he was held guilty for the rape, murder of a minor girl. The victim's father urged the Special Judge to set an example by sentencing the accused to death. Citing 12 Supreme Court judgments, Special Public Prosecutor (SPP) Ajay Misar also sought capital punishment for the accused, saying he had committed a heinous crime.

CCTV footage showing the accused with the victim, DNA reports, and the statement of the witness who last saw the victim with the man have provided crucial evidence against the accused. During the probe, police procured proof from the analysis of six CCTV videos to establish the sequence of events before and during the commission of offence.

Police said a CCTV footage revealed the accused bought *gathi shev* at a local shop. Police also procured CCTV clips showing the accused walking with the girl, holding her hand, towards the crime scene at around 3.12 pm on May 1. Later, in footage taken by the same CCTV at the same spot, the accused is seen returning alone around 3.51 pm.

"The CCTV videos confirm that the accused raped, murdered the victim girl brutally during this period of 39 minutes. Postmortem report revealed 18 injuries on the victim's body, showing the grievous nature of the crime," Misar told the court.

The court has convicted the accused, holding him guilty of all charges levelled against him.

## Chhattisgarh conversion row: 26 families boycotted, given 30-day ultimatum

Jayprakash S Naidu  
Raipur, June 25

Security personnel deployed after the standoff in Bharanda village of Narayanpur. EXPRESS

TENSIONS OVER conversion are escalating in a village in Chhattisgarh's Narayanpur district, where the social boycott of 26 families has led to a police deployment, with the families claiming they have received a 30-day ultimatum to "return to the tribal culture".

According to locals, communal tensions have been simmering in Bharanda village since last December, when objections to Christian prayers allegedly led to a mob assault on a local resident. They said that the tensions followed a dispute over burial rights in Badetevda village in neighbouring Kanker district that triggered communal clashes from December 16-18. The violence fuelled tensions in parts of Kanker and Bharanda in neighbouring Narayanpur.

On Tuesday, a conversion-related dispute triggered a standoff in the village, leading to the deployment of 100 cops. It was followed by 12 hours of

negotiations between the villagers. While district authorities said they managed to broker peace, several village leaders claimed the converted families were given "a month's time to return to the tribal culture".

Officials said that it took 13 rounds of talks to broker peace. "We had a peace meeting and now the situation is under control. We are keeping a watch on the village," said Narayanpur SP Robinson Guria. The development came amid a rise in such standoffs in Chhattisgarh, with similar incidents reported over several years from Bastar, Narayanpur, Kanker and Kondagaon.

## 'Grave mistake': Kuki-Zo Council on killing of six Naga hostages in Manipur

Express News Service  
Guwahati, June 25

THE KUKI-ZO Council (KZC) in Manipur on Thursday called the killing of six Naga hostages a "grave mistake", but alleged that there were "selective security actions" taken by authorities following a recent escalation of tensions in the state.

Tensions between Manipur's Naga and Kuki-Zo communities have been on the boil since May 13, when three Kuki-Zo church leaders were killed in an ambush, which was followed by a mass taking of hostages on both sides. This culminated in six of the Naga hostages being found killed earlier this month.

Addressing a press conference in Churachandpur, KZC chairman Henlianthang Thanglet said, "I agree that the Kuki-Zo have made a grave mistake" by killing six Naga civilians who were among those taken hostage following the escalation of tensions in May. "I really criticise it," he said.

A statement from the Kuki-Zo Council said it unequivocally condemns the killing of

**I agree that the Kuki-Zo have made a grave mistake. I really criticise it."**

HENLIANTHANG THANGLET,  
CHAIRMAN, KUKI-ZO COUNCIL

the six Naga hostages.

"The incident was tragic, unacceptable, and was neither authorised nor approved by any Kuki-Zo political or community leadership. Those responsible must be identified and brought to justice through a fair, transparent, and impartial investigation," read the statement.

However, it went on to allege selective security operations and presented a set of demands, including an end to "selective security operations" and ensuring that "law enforcement actions are carried out fairly, professionally, and without bias against any community". The council has also demanded that "firm and decisive action" be taken against "militant groups responsible for attacks" on Kuki-Zo civilians.

AN EMPLOYEE AT HEAD HOPPERS, 28-YEAR-OLD JAYANT GUPTA SAID HE AND OTHERS SAW A SMALL VENT IN PRODUCTION ROOM AND HE DECIDED TO TAKE A CHANCE BY JUMPING THROUGH IT — 'THERE WAS NO OTHER WAY'

## 'Lucky I survived': He jumped to escape Lucknow blaze, fall left him paralysed

Maulshree Seth  
Lucknow, June 25

AS HORRIFYING visuals of the fire in Lucknow's Aliganj flashed on TV screens and social media on Monday, a man was seen jumping from the second floor of the building to escape the flames. Jayant Gupta, 28, survived the blaze, but has suffered serious back injuries that have left him paralysed waist down.

The spine may have taken a hit, but the spirit has not. Currently under treatment at the ICU of Lucknow's King George's Medical University (KGMU), Jayant said with a smile, "I feel that I am lucky to have survived that horror." He said that he would have to recover to look after his family.

A doctor treating him said it is difficult to predict when he

would recover from his current condition, and to what degree. Dr Zia Arshad, attending to Jayant at the trauma centre of KGMU, told *The Indian Express*, "Because of the injuries and a fracture in his lower spine, his lower body is paralysed. He has 10% burn injuries, which will heal. He is unable to hold his bladder, stool. We are not making surgical interventions now."

The building where the fire broke out housed an art production company and other business units. All 15 victims died of suffocation. The probe revealed that the lack of an emergency exit and other safety steps had turned the building into a death trap. Jayant had been working at the art production company, Head Hoppers, as a junior character artist for the past four

years. His family members said he had received many offers from outside Lucknow, including one from Dubai, but stayed back for his parents and aunt.

Speaking to *The Indian Express*, Jayant recounted the horrors of that day and what pushed him to jump from the second floor. He said that soon after lunch, there was a commotion about a fire in the building, but no one took it seriously. "We initially took it casually, trying to save our stuff. But in no time, the lights started flickering, and we realised we needed to escape," Jayant said. He recalled that there were about 15 people in the production room. "We tried to rush out, but the biometric gate was locked. Smoke was filling the room. We started throwing whatever we could towards the glass gate — bottles,



Jayant Gupta is undergoing treatment at Lucknow's King George's Medical University. EXPRESS

chairs — and it broke."

The young man said that as the fire and the smoke spread, he and his colleagues struggled to breathe. "When we tried to escape, we realised that the only staircase down was not just filled with smoke, but the flames made it impossible to

cross. So we rushed upstairs to go to the roof, but the door was locked," he said.

Jayant said that by this time, many of his colleagues had started collapsing. "When we found the door to the roof locked, the only option was to go back to the room and find some

way out... Some of our colleagues, who were in the canteen area, had escaped by climbing down the wire, but it was no longer possible by the time we tried exiting through the main gate or the roof," he said.

"There was smoke, heat and darkness everywhere. I could

feel the flames; we were struggling to breathe." Jayant said they saw a small vent in the production room that was used for light during power cuts, and he decided to take a chance by jumping through it. "There was no other way."

The fall left him with serious injuries. Jayant is paralysed from the waist down, and his hands and legs have burn injuries. But confident of a recovery, he says he is a single child and must take care of his parents and a dependent aunt.

"Whenever we came across news reports of a fire caused by an air-conditioner, we would joke about how we would react in such a situation, especially with all the inflammable stuff (in the studio). We would tease each other. Little did we know it would come true," Jayant

said, smiling despite the pain.

His cousin Mayank, a designer and the first person Jayant called after his miraculous escape, said, "I had told him about an opportunity in Dubai, but probably the thought of his parents kept him here. You can gauge his courage by the fact that even after suffering such injuries, he managed to tell someone my number and spoke to me before becoming unconscious," Mayank said.

He said Jayant's father had retired from the Uttar Pradesh Public Works Department, and the family lives in Lucknow's Aishbagh. K K Singh, spokesperson of the KGMU, said specialists from several departments are monitoring Jayant as he is the only survivor of the June 22 fire tragedy under treatment at the hospital.







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BECAUSE THE TRUTH INVOLVES US ALL

## Silicon Valley to Seoul, watch AI exuberance

THE LAST few days have seen stock markets across the world wobble as concerns over the AI cycle weigh heavy on investors. On Tuesday, Asian markets fell sharply, led by South Korea's Kospi, which plunged by nearly 10 per cent. Japan's Nikkei 225 was down 3.5 per cent and Nasdaq, too, witnessed weakness, falling by almost 4 per cent since last week. Questions are increasingly being raised over monetisation of capital spending by tech firms and the high valuations they command. As per Goldman Sachs, the AI hyperscalers are expected to spend more than \$5 trillion on technology and data centres by 2030. Parallels are now being drawn with the dotcom bubble. Then, as now, investor exuberance had dramatically driven up share prices of tech firms. And when the bubble burst, it took Nasdaq years to fully recover.

Despite these concerns, capital has been flowing to companies linked to the AI cycle in all parts of the world. In Korea, for instance, SK Hynix and Samsung have seen euphoric investor interest. As per reports, the two now account for a sizeable share of the South Korean market. In Japan, companies like Advantest, Tokyo Electron and Kioxia have all seen their shares surge. In the US, AI behemoths — Anthropic and OpenAI — have begun the process to launch their initial public offerings. These will follow SpaceX's recent mega IPO, pulling in even more capital. Investor exuberance is, however, likely to run up against a macro reality. In the past, asset bubbles have tended to be pricked by central banks raising interest rates. And with inflation edging upwards in the US — CPI rose to 4.2 per cent in May — it raises the possibility of the Federal Reserve tightening policy in the months ahead.

Indian markets have not been part of this AI play. Foreign capital has, in fact, been exiting the country. In 2025, foreign portfolio investors took out \$18.9 billion from the stock markets, and so far this year, outflows have been just shy of \$30 billion. Alongside, net FDI flows dwindled to \$1 billion in 2024-25 and \$7.7 billion in 2025-26. Along with high crude prices, this put pressure on the rupee. In recent weeks, however, oil prices have softened considerably, and measures have been taken to boost capital flows and help stabilise the currency. But more needs to be done. Steps should be taken to improve the country's attractiveness as an investment destination, for both domestic and foreign investors.

## In West Bengal, keep egg on the menu

THE FIRST budget of the Suvendu Adhikari government in West Bengal has drawn attention for two contrasting decisions on school nutrition. On the one hand, it has substantially increased the per-child allocation for mid-day meals, raising the material cost from Rs 6.78 to Rs 10, signalling a welcome recognition that better nutrition requires greater public investment. Yet the decision to hand the running of mid-day meals in the Kolkata Municipal Corporation area to the religious organisation ISKCON effectively excludes one of the staples from the menu — eggs. The defence by CM Adhikari — “You will get good food to eat. You will get pure food, nothing to worry about” — and by state education minister Dipak Burman — “There is no logic behind the idea that children must consume eggs, especially to fulfil their nutritional needs” — only exacerbates concerns. By imposing a vegetarian ideal in a culturally varied state, the move depletes the menu of one of the country's most important welfare programmes.

The nutritional case for retaining eggs is compelling. The National Family Health Survey-6, released last month, shows that although stunting among children under five years has declined, nearly three out of every 10 children continue to be affected. West Bengal has long grappled with significant levels of child undernutrition and anaemia among both children and women. Eggs remain one of the most effective, economical and familiar sources of protein. The proposed substitutes — paneer, soyabean, rajma and pulses — undoubtedly have nutritional value, but ensuring their availability and acceptance at scale is far more complex.

Food in India has long been bound up in questions of caste, religion, and social power. In the weeks before the watershed assembly elections in April, the BJP went to great lengths to reassure voters that Bengal's culinary traditions would remain untouched under its stewardship. The removal of eggs from mid-day meals in schools — a template followed in several BJP-ruled states — sits uneasily alongside those assurances, particularly in a state where 98 per cent of people consume non-vegetarian food. The Adhikari government must reconsider its decision.

## Meetings about meetings, and managers

IT IS difficult, even for the most seasoned managers — whether in government or the private sector — to come up with ways to inspire their subordinates through the drudgery that marks most careers. Take the following sentence: “A career is a bridge, and sometimes it needs a civil engineer.” Does it carry hidden wisdom or is it trite? Clearly, the problem of being inspirational is exercising a figure no less exalted than India's top bureaucrat. In a two-page note accompanied by 10 pages of guidelines on how to conduct meetings sent to all secretaries to the Government of India, Cabinet Secretary T V Somanathan has asked stalwarts of India's steel frame a vexing question: Are they gaining “30 years' experience or one year's experience repeated 30 times”?

Much of Somanathan's advice resonates beyond the government, to anyone who has ever attended an unending series of meetings in a day. This broad swathe of white-collar workers can attest to the fact that, more often than not, the preparation for the meeting to discuss progress on the work promised at the last meeting ends up becoming the work itself. And the ability to make a presentation with a plethora of graphs is more significant for career advancement than the quality of the work the PPT purports to showcase.

The cabinet secretary's caution against meetings that “tend to start late, be overstretched and directionless, and often lead to no tangible 'takeaways'” is well taken. But perhaps, it misses a deeper point. The meeting is for the manager. The purpose of the meeting, more often than not, is to justify that role. In such a context, what's the difference between “30 years of experience” and “a year's experience repeated 30 times”?

# My absence is not silence. I will return through the strength of the people

JUNE 23 is deeply intertwined with the Bengali nation's long struggle for its rights. On this day in 1949, the Bangladesh Awami League (AL) was founded through a struggle against exploitation and deprivation to advance the people's demands, uphold human dignity, and secure democratic rights. This week marked 77 years of that journey.

AL's sacrifices, leadership, and struggle are woven into every milestone of our nation: The 1952 Language Movement, the 1954 United Front elections, the Six-point Movement of 1966, the 1969 Mass Uprising, the 1970 elections, the historic March 7 speech of the Father of the Nation, Bangabandhu Sheikh Mujibur Rahman, the Great War of Liberation, and the establishment of an independent, sovereign Bangladesh. Bangabandhu dreamt of independence for the Bengali nation. He organised the people for that dream, and under his leadership, Bangladesh achieved freedom. He even gave the country its name, “Bangladesh”. Thus, the history of Bangladesh is the history of the Awami League.

After independence, Bangabandhu dedicated himself to rebuilding a war-torn country. He envisioned a hunger-free, poverty-free, secular, democratic, and dignified “Sonar Bangla” (Golden Bengal). However, the assassination of the Father of the Nation and his family on August 15, 1975 was an assault on the spirit of Bangladesh's independence, democracy, the constitution, and the very identity of the Bengalis. For a long time thereafter, attempts were made to drag Bangladesh backwards — through military rule, conspiracies, coups, the distortion of history and the rehabilitation of fundamentalist forces. Yet, the AL never stopped. Imprisonment, disappearances, killings, tor-

ture, fabricated cases, and bans could not steer it away from the people.

During the League's tenure in office, Bangladesh became self-sufficient in food, poverty decreased, we moved toward 100 per cent electrification, and new horizons of infrastructure development were opened. Bangladesh became a safe haven for its people, freed from the grasp of terrorism and militancy. However, today, Bangladesh is in deep crisis once again. The path of hatred, division, vengeance, mob violence, the use of the judiciary as a political weapon, fabricated cases, and state repression initiated by the unelected and unconstitutional interim government led by Muhammad Yunus continues under the current BNP government. It was formed through the farce of an election held on February 12, which kept the country's largest political party and the organisation that led the struggle for independence away from the ballot. The polls did not reflect the people's mandate.

Today, the illegal ban on the activities of the Awami League remains in place. Leaders and activists are being charged with false cases. Through house raids, arrests, torture, harassment of families, seizure of property, and intimidation, attempts are being made to silence the AL. Even peaceful tributes on our founding anniversary, the hoisting of flags, or the expression of political views are being treated as crimes. It must be stated clearly: Paying respect to Bangabandhu is not a crime. Saying “Joy Bangla” is not a crime. Loving the Awami League is not a crime. Speaking of voting rights and democracy is not a crime.

Law enforcement agencies, administration, and responsible offi-



SHEIKH HASINA WAZED

In its 77-year journey, the Awami League has been attacked many times, has shed blood many times, and has faced conspiracies many times. But every time, it has stood up with the strength of the people. It will do so again, Inshallah

## A Nalanda model for the 21st century



SYED ATA HASNAIN

THE GREAT contests of the 21st century are unlikely to be decided solely on battlefields, in factories or through financial markets. Nations today are competing for intellectual advantage — the ability to generate ideas, attract talent, shape narratives and influence the ethical direction of technology and governance. Knowledge is becoming national power.

History shows that every era has had a defining source of strategic advantage. Territorial conquest shaped the age of empire. The Industrial Revolution transformed Britain, Germany and later the US. The Information Revolution rewarded societies that mastered computing, telecommunications and digital systems. The world is now entering the age of cognitive power.

This extends far beyond AI. Cognitive power includes scientific research, climate knowledge, disaster management, biotechnology, cyber capability, strategic communication, conflict studies, diplomacy and the ability to shape international norms. The present era is distinguished by the unprecedented strategic value attached to knowledge, research and intellectual capital.

The US understood this transformation earlier than most. Its advantage lay not merely in great universities but in linking academia, industry, government funding, military research and immigration into a single innovation ecosystem. Institutions like MIT, Stanford and Harvard became strategic assets connected directly to aerospace, semiconductors, biotechnology and digital innovation.

Equally important was academic freedom. Universities retained sufficient autonomy to encourage experimentation and dissent, allowing talent from around the world to become strategic capital. Innovation rarely flourishes in climates of intimidation. This lesson has universal relevance.

India adapted impressively during the Information Revolution. Yet its role remained concentrated more in software services than in foundational research. The next leap, therefore, cannot merely be technological. India must move from being a digital economy to becoming a knowledge civilisation.

Nations that invest solely in coding and

automation without nurturing ethics, humanities, law and strategic thought may achieve efficiency without intellectual depth. History reminds us that technological breakthroughs acquire real significance only when accompanied by the ideas and doctrines that give them purpose.

Knowledge power is increasingly central to national resilience and security. Nations that anticipate crises, shape narratives and build resilience will enjoy geopolitical advantage. India's CDRI is a welcome step. Future conflicts will require strategic thinkers and diplomats as much as technologists.

Encouragingly, India is beginning to recognise the relationship between knowledge ecosystems and long-term strategic development. Economic modernisation can no longer rely only on infrastructure and industrial expansion. Future competitiveness will depend equally upon research, innovation and higher education.

In this context, Nalanda in Bihar acquires renewed relevance. More than a millennium ago, it functioned as a transnational intellectual network attracting scholars from across Asia. It represented pluralism, interdisciplinary learning and openness to ideas — qualities increasingly important in a world seeking to balance technological advancement with ethical reflection. Properly nurtured, modern Nalanda could emerge as a centre for Asian cooperation in culture, sustainability, strategic studies and global governance.

The strategic reality of the 21st century is becoming increasingly clear. Military strength will continue to matter, but military capability itself will increasingly depend upon research ecosystems, innovation cultures and intellectual capital.

Nations unable to generate original knowledge will become dependent on others not only for technology, but also for strategic narratives and policy frameworks. The emerging age of cognitive power offers India an opportunity to become once again a civilisation that produces ideas, institutions and knowledge systems sought by the world.

The writer is Governor, Bihar and former commander of the Indian Army's Srinagar-based Chinार Corps

## Global South is becoming another India-China arena



ANUSHKA SAXENA

ON JUNE 22, NSA Ajit Doval met Chinese Foreign Minister Wang Yi on the sidelines of the 16th BRICS NSA meeting in New Delhi. The divergences in worldviews were hard to miss. Delhi spoke of “stable, predictable and constructive bilateral relations” and “gradual normalisation” since Galwan. Beijing, by contrast, scaled the same meeting up to a “Global South” moment: Wang declared that “the Global South, including China and India, is collectively rising”, and that the two countries must “accelerate the modernisation process of the Global South” together. Five days earlier, that exact vocabulary had been packaged into China's new White Paper on global governance.

The White Paper articulates three approaches to the Global South. First is its revitalisation of an idea that a Global South that excludes China is a pseudo-proposition. Second is its emphasis on China's “win-win” and “harmonious” approach to the perceived grouping. Third is its usurpation of Delhi's preferred metaphor on acting as a bridge between the “Global North” and the “Global South”. Only, the White Paper frames it as China seeking to “synergise” North-South cooperation.

China has viewed India and the West as promoters of exclusive blocs that undermine its Global South identity. The White Paper's most prominent thesis formalises that proposition — “China will always be a member of the Global South.” It contends that the monopolisation of international affairs by “a small number of countries” is no longer acceptable to Beijing, and so it will emerge as the force promoting inclusion and accessibility for the economies of this perceived grouping. India's decision to conduct three “Voice of Global South Summits” without China's participation has irked Beijing the most. It was right before the second summit that *Global Times* popularised the idea that such a summit without China was a pseudo-proposition.

Through the White Paper, Beijing attempts to set itself apart in its approach to the Global South by calling for “win-win cooperation”, pitting it against the West's, or even India's, “opportunism”. The example Chinese analysts like retired PLA officer Zhou Bo have cited is Delhi wrangling with Colombo to halt the docking of Chinese vessels at Sri Lanka's ports. Zhou argued in 2024 that while India “forced [Sri Lanka's] government to ban Chinese ships”, China welcomed it into BRICS and the SCO. In his conception, that India is an equal in BRICS, or that it acted in its national interest when dealing with Colombo, are unacceptable realities. Zhou also advanced the framing that India and China should function as “Global South anchors”, not power competitors. That has now travelled from a retired PLA officer's op-ed to Wang Yi's talking points. The precedent, however, as evident from Sri Lanka's debt restructuring around Hambantota or the suspension of the BRI-financed CPEC's signature projects under fiscal stress in Pakistan, does not reflect the conduct of the magnanimous actor that China presents itself as. Delhi's goal should hence be not to compete with Beijing's rhetoric word-for-word, but to showcase its empirical record in Global South fora.

The writer is staff research analyst, geostrategy programme, Takshashila Institution

## 40 YEARS AGO

June 26, 1986



### Laldenga to head coalition

MIZO NATIONAL FRONT (MNF) chief Laldenga will head an “interim administrative arrangement” in Mizoram in coalition with the Congress-I, according to an understanding reached between the two parties. Laldenga told ENS that the 30-member assembly will not be dissolved and the present CM, Lal-thanhwala, will become deputy C.M. The MNF chief would not give more details.

### India asks Sri Lanka for restraint

INDIA HAS expressed concern over the recent incidents of violence and terrorism in

Sri Lanka and urged all sides to exercise maximum restraint. An External Affairs Ministry spokesman said that the Government of India had noted with deep concern and deplored the recent incidents of violence and terrorism which had resulted in the deaths of several innocent citizens — men, women and children. “We condemn such acts of violence and terrorism against civilians,” the spokesman said, reading out a statement.

### All Karnataka ministers resign

AS EXPECTED, all the ministers handed in their resignations to Chief Minister Ramakrishna Hegde at an emergency meeting of

the Council of Ministers. The move is aimed at giving Hegde a free hand to reconstitute the ministry the way he chooses. The informal meeting of the cabinet met shortly after it took a decision to print and publish the controversial report of the Second Backward Classes Commission headed by K Venkataswamy and publicise it widely in order to ascertain public opinion.

### Acting Babbar Khalsa chief held

ONE PERSON was killed, three people injured and more than 60 people, including acting Babbar Khalsa chief, Avtar Singh, arrested during the past 24 hours in Punjab.





DIS/AGREE

THE BEST OF BOTH SIDES

A weekly column, which offers not this-versus-that, but the best of both sides, to inform the debate

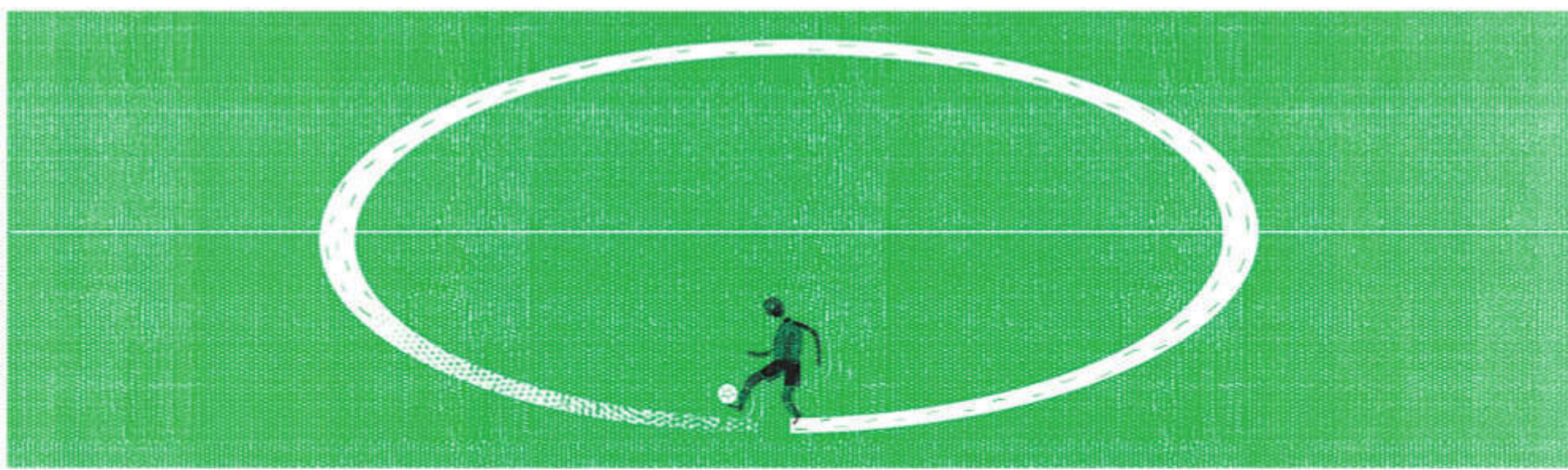


ILLUSTRATION: C.R SASIKUMAR

Smaller nations are scripting upsets at World Cup. Why can't India make it to football's biggest stage?

## Football dream requires a kick



SANJOY SEN

**A**S I watched Uzbekistan competing against Portugal at the 2026 FIFA World Cup, my memory drifted back to those chilly days in Tashkent. It was 2008. I was working with the Indian U-16 team as one of the coaches. We had qualified for the AFC U-16 Championship after beating Saudi Arabia and drawing against Iraq in the qualifiers. Today, two of the nations we faced in that tournament are at the World Cup. India is not.

Our opponents were South Korea, Syria and Indonesia. We lost the first two games but went on to defeat Indonesia. Had we come up against the hosts, Uzbekistan, we would have fancied our chances. Only five years earlier, the senior team had beaten them 2-0. There was no overwhelming gulf between them and us. As I reminisce about that tournament today, it feels like folklore. One that is difficult to believe.

I am often asked: Why can a nation of 1.4 billion not qualify for the World Cup? Why can we not produce an Abdu-kodir Khusanov? For me, the answer begins at our grassroots. Our most glaring drawback is our faulty foundation. We have been taught to think of football as a skyscraper — you cannot reach the higher floors, like the World Cup, if you do not have a strong base. Which we certainly do not.

In Tashkent, we saw how a footballing structure was thriving in schools. Schools played an integral role in talent development and young players had a clear pathway. Nearly two decades later, that system has only become stronger. Meanwhile, we are still debating structures that should have been established years ago.

Those in charge must be held responsible for the lack of long-term vision. Take the 2017 U-17 World Cup. Many players from that tournament are at the World Cup now. Japan's Keito Nakamura and Takefusa Kubo, among the best players at this World Cup, were in the same tournament as us. Many of our boys from that batch have either faded away or failed to develop their skills.

I have seen the Japanese model from close quarters. I went to Japan for one of the modules of my AFC Pro Licence course and had the opportunity to visit academies of J-League clubs. What struck me most was not their facilities, impressive as they were. It was their unwavering commitment to school football. Every nation that is progressing in Asia

has recognised the same truth: Youth development cannot begin at 15. It begins at five. We use the phrase constantly, but what are we actually doing to ensure the betterment of our kids? At the school level, how many institutions genuinely encourage children to pursue football?

We also have a habit of announcing ambitious targets without creating a roadmap to achieve them. Japan offers a fascinating contrast. During my visit, coaches spoke about Mission 2050 — being a World Cup title contender by 2050. They are working towards it. Five-year-olds are being nurtured and monitored with that target in mind.

Many of us hoped things would change with the arrival of the Indian Super League in 2014. Among its founding principles were clear objectives: Clubs should develop their own infrastructure and maintain dedicated developmental squads. How many teams have been able to build their own grounds? Even Mohun Bagan, my former club, and East Bengal, the two pillars of Indian football, train on borrowed land from the Army, after more than a century of existence.

Our players must also be held accountable. Having worked with many of the current Indian players, I can tell you, without naming anyone, that we lack hunger. There is a sense of contentment and no urge to test limits in overseas leagues because it will not be as lucrative as the ISL. Ask yourself a simple question: If Khusanov had never left Uzbekistan for France, would he have become the player he is today?

We also hear frequent complaints about infrastructure and facilities. Some of those criticisms are valid. But can they fully explain our performances? Does DR Congo possess world-class infrastructure? Does Cape Verde? What they possess are players willing to test themselves in demanding environments abroad. Their development has been accelerated by exposure to higher standards. Our players are reluctant to leave their comfort zones.

There is one question that always follows: Will we ever get there? I choose to remain optimistic. The number of participating nations has been increased to 48, and further expansion seems inevitable. If we put a long-term plan in place and are diligent in following it, can a country of our size not find 11 players good enough to be at the World Cup?

But we have to be patient. Japan, despite all its progress, does not expect to become a World Cup contender until 2050. That is realism. So if anyone tells you we will be at the World Cup in 2034, he is either selling you a dream or living in a fool's paradise.

*The writer coached Mohun Bagan to the 2014-15 I-League title and was part of the India U-16 coaching staff at the 2008 AFC U-16 Championship in Tashkent*

## Search for shortcuts is an own goal



MIHIR VASAVDA

**T**HE WORLD has descended on the United States, Mexico and Canada. Underdogs are writing improbable stories. New football nations are daring to dream. And old guards are guarding their territory. Back home, however, Indian football spent last week talking about something else entirely.

The All India Football Federation proposed changing its name to the Football Federation of Bharat. It also approved the playing of the national anthem and 'Vande Mataram' before official matches. The timing was impossible to ignore. These decisions arrived with AIFF elections looming and the political currents around Indian football growing stronger.

There is nothing inherently wrong with symbolism. Nations have always wrapped sport in identity. The problem is that symbolism has become the loudest conversation in Indian football at a moment when the sport desperately needs discussion about performance. While administrators debate names and songs, the national team has quietly slipped into irrelevance.

This World Cup has once again shown that football's traditional hierarchy is not fixed. Countries with smaller populations, smaller economies and fewer resources have found ways to compete. Some are built on smart scouting. Others on long-term youth development. Others, on clear footballing philosophies that survive changes in coaches and administrators. The common thread is that they all built something.

India, by contrast, often appears to be rebuilding from scratch every few years. The most worrying aspect is that the conversation around Indian football has become increasingly detached from what happens on the pitch. There should be outrage about the national team's decline. There should be debates about why India continues to struggle against opponents it once expected to beat. There should be scrutiny of talent development pathways.

Instead, Indian football has spent much of the past year dealing with administrative uncertainty. The Indian Super League, supposedly the flagship project that would transform the sport, has lurched from one crisis to another. Investors have walked away. Hundreds of players are facing an uncertain future. The credibility of the entire ecosystem has been damaged.

India has spent a decade celebrating frivolous things. Hosting the U-17 World Cup, for instance. Eighteen players from that edition are now leading their national teams at the ongoing World Cup, from Eng-

land's Marc Guehi to Japan's Takefusa Kubo and Spain's Ferran Torres. India's best-trained batch, however, has slipped into oblivion. It begs a question: Is the country's system good enough to produce elite footballers? The answer is perhaps most visible in the national team's search for solutions.

Over the past year, much of the discussion has revolved around Overseas Citizens of India and players of Indian origin abroad. The logic is understandable. If the domestic pipeline is not producing enough quality, perhaps help can come from elsewhere. Yet even supporters of the OCI route admit that it is, at best, a short-term patch. India's citizenship rules currently prevent OCI holders from representing the national team unless they acquire Indian citizenship. All of a sudden, the pretence of developing players has fallen, and the AIFF seems to have put all its eggs in the OCI basket.

The larger question is more uncomfortable. Why is a country of 1.4 billion people looking overseas for answers?

The obsession with OCI players risks becoming a distraction from a more fundamental problem. Scouting and talent identification within India remain woefully inadequate. Every major football nation has networks stretching into villages, schools and local leagues. India still relies heavily on a narrow professional ecosystem concentrated in a handful of states and academies.

Those who should be deciding policies are consumed by governance battles. Meanwhile, the rest of the world moves on. Countries once considered minnows now produce players in Europe's top leagues. Smaller football federations have embraced data, analytics and sophisticated scouting. Others have built coherent identities that survive election cycles and administrative changes.

India still searches for shortcuts. Perhaps that is why the scenes from this World Cup feel so distant. The tournament is filled with nations that spent years making sensible decisions before enjoying their moment on the global stage.

India wants the moment without completing the journey. And if you are expecting a happy ending here, you will not find one. Not yet. Not while symbolism substitutes for substance, or while the national conversation is about names rather than footballers.

The World Cup dream is not impossible. But it is becoming increasingly unrealistic.

Unless Indian football takes drastic steps to fix its structures, strengthen its leagues, widen its scouting network and prioritise development over optics, qualification will remain what it has always been: A dream discussed every four years and forgotten for the next four.

*The writer is deputy associate editor, The Indian Express*  
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## PM Modi needs a Kamaraj Plan. Will he bite the bullet?



A SURYA PRAKASH

**A**S NARENDRA MODI marches on in his third term in office, attains the distinction of becoming the longest continuously serving elected prime minister of the country and is showered with well-deserved encomiums for the phenomenal achievements on various fronts, he is also confronted with questions about the quality of the men and women in his Council of Ministers and the sense of fatigue that has set in, both in the government and in the Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP).

Be it the social sector, infrastructure, economy, defence, transport, foreign policy, or digitisation, PM Modi's record over the last 12 years is outstanding, but the credit, barring exceptions, has gone entirely to him. How competent or otherwise are the 71 members of PM Modi's Council of Ministers? It appears as if the burden of delivering on promises is entirely on his shoulders. Similarly, while the BJP claims to be the biggest political party in the democratic world (140 million registered primary members), has anyone heard of its general secretaries or other office-bearers travelling across the country and galvanising party cadres?

The party apparatus is a pale shadow of what it was two or three decades ago, when it had active general secretaries like Arun Jaitley, Pramod Mahajan, and Modi himself, who kept tabs on the goings-on in the states and were dispatched on trouble-shooting expeditions. For example, what has become of the party in Karnataka, or what is the rating of the chief ministers of Madhya Pradesh, Rajasthan, or of the BJP in these states? How well is the party organised to face the political battle in Uttar Pradesh, Uttarakhand, Punjab, Gujarat, Himachal Pradesh, Goa, and Manipur, which go to the polls next year?

This brings us to the issue at hand — fatigue — both in the government and the party. Whenever there is a charismatic head of government like Indira Gandhi or Modi, many in the council of ministers begin to believe that they just need to implement orders from the PMO and "be seen" by the leader. Several of them are leaders in their own right and have long political and administrative experience, but over time, they get used to the perks that go with their offices and just go with the flow. Many of them need to be shaken out of their slumber and given new tasks to galvanise the party, where the KPs are clearly laid out. But will PM Modi do it?

Few within the Union government indeed have energy levels that can match Modi, and this is true of the party apparatus as well. So, what should be done? The Prime Minister must undertake a major operation to bring fresh blood into the government and move heavyweights from the government to the party apparatus. Thus strengthening both the government and the party. In other words, Modi must execute a BJP version of the Kamaraj Plan.

What was the Kamaraj Plan? K Kamaraj, chief minister of the then Madras State, suggested in mid-1963, when the fortunes of the Congress party were sagging, that top

leaders of the party must exit the government and work for the party. He presented his plan to the Congress Working Committee (CWC) and said leading Congressmen who were in government "should voluntarily relinquish their ministerial posts and offer themselves for full-time organisational work". The working committee adopted his proposal, and it was passed by the AICC on August 10.

Kamaraj set the ball rolling by offering his resignation as chief minister. Soon, other chief ministers and Union ministers offered their resignations. The prime minister had the unenviable task of deciding whom to let go and whom to retain, which he eventually did. Jawaharlal Nehru took a fortnight to decide and informed the CWC that he had accepted the resignations of six Union ministers — Morarji Desai (Finance), Jagjivan Ram (Transport and Communications), Lal Bahadur Shastri (Home), S K Patil (Food and Agriculture), B Gopal Reddy (Information & Broadcasting) and K L Shrimali (Education) — and six chief ministers: K Kamaraj (Madras), Biju Patnaik (Orissa), Ghulam Mohammad Bakshi (recognised as "prime minister" at the time) (Jammu and Kashmir), Binodanand Jha (Bihar), Chandra Bhanu Gupta (Uttar Pradesh) and B A Mandloi (Madhya Pradesh). Several of them were assigned party work, and Kamaraj was appointed president of the Indian National Congress. S Gopal, Nehru's biographer, described the exercise as "an effective way of political spring-cleaning".

While accepting the AICC diktat on the Kamaraj Plan, Nehru said that the AICC resolution was a correct one even though it was unusual and rather unique. The decision was based principally on making it clear that Congress does not approve of people being attracted by the office and the power that it brings. "While all of us in the Congress should be devoted to the service of our people, the desire for office or power vitiates the desire for service."

Since the BJP has been in power continuously at the Centre and in most states over the last 12 years, one can substitute Congress with the BJP in the above paragraph to effect a major overhaul and come face to face with reality. This observation of Nehru is worth considering because many within the BJP believe that a certain level of arrogance has crept in among ministers and chief ministers, who are now caricatures of the humble *karyakartas* they were when they were out of office.

Another observation of Nehru is significant in the context of the current debate within the government and the BJP at the Centre. Nehru said, "The action should be big enough to be important and striking. That means top personalities who are now in high offices must retire and devote themselves to organisational and/or other forms of service to the people".

This is a key requirement for prominent party leaders because long years in office make many of them averse to the dust and grime that goes with building the party at the grassroots.

Despite his stern exterior, Modi does not let go of those he has worked with for long years. He keeps them engaged. As a result, most ministers have had a long innings in government, and the party is bereft of heavyweights. Given this temperament, the million-rupee question is, will PM Modi bite the bullet?

*The writer is member, Prime Ministers' Museum and Library Society*

## LETTERS TO THE EDITOR

### Hormuz chokehold

THE STRAIT of Hormuz situation deserves more serious domestic attention than it is currently receiving ('No going back to the pre-war Strait', *IE*, June 25). India's dependence on energy imports, including crude, LNG and LPG, through a single volatile corridor is a structural vulnerability, not a temporary inconvenience. Diversifying supply routes, accelerating renewable energy adoption, and building strategic petroleum reserves are no longer optional long-term goals. They are immediate policy necessities. The Narendra Modi government must treat energy security as an infrastructure priority because price shocks resulting from disrupted Gulf supplies will hurt the most vulnerable citizens.

*A Mylsami, Coimbatore*

IT GOES without saying that turning the clock back to the pre-war era of the Strait of Hormuz could be a Herculean task, if not impossible ('No going back to the pre-war Strait', *IE*, June 25). The regime led by the Islamic Revolutionary Guard Corps would never part with its "money-milking cow" after having "tasted blood" by charging tolls on vessels transiting the Strait of Hormuz, which remains

under its control. Since one-fifth of the world's energy supply passes through it, the editorial's analysis that the world will shift to more viable energy sources simply cannot be overstated. Moreover, its prescription of certain dos and don'ts for India, also merits due consideration.

*SK Gupta, via email*

### The point of politics

SHASHI THAROR's diagnosis about defecting politicians is accurate ('Ideology, defection, and the death of purpose in politics', *IE*, June 25). When defection carries no reputational cost and party membership becomes purely transactional, voters lose meaningful choice. The anti-defection law needs sharper teeth, with faster adjudication and real consequences. More importantly, political parties must start rebuilding internal democracy so that ideological identity means something beyond electoral arithmetic. Politics without conviction eventually produces governance without direction. The people of India deserve representatives in Parliament who actually stand for something, not simply whoever offered the most convenient arrangement.

*Swathi Senthilkumar, Coimbatore*



RANJIT LAL

BIRDERS IN Mumbai are puzzled over why thousands of migratory waders that flock to the city's coastline have not yet left for their vast breeding grounds that stretch from the Himalayas through Tibet, China, Mongolia and beyond, including up to the Arctic Circle. The journey is perilous and often takes weeks, and the birds are known to set off by March. By now, they ought to have courted and been in the thick of bringing up families, not hanging around all dressed to kill in the Mumbai wetlands.

What might be the reason, then, for the delay? Is it the prolonged summer? Is it something to do with wind patterns? Is it climate change? Or, are we simply reading and

## The birds are winging it

thinking too much into and about the issue? Now that the rains have broken, we have to wait and see what happens. Normally, day length (photoperiodism) and the availability of food provide the triggers for departures. But if they leave too late, it'll give their chicks less time to be ready for the great winter migration, from their icy homelands bereft of insects to the warm climes down south. Unless, of course, the onset of late winters in the northern latitudes due to global warming and climate change allows them to stay on longer than they normally would.

The bottom line seems to be that we really don't know. We are told we don't have enough data, that there haven't been enough long-term studies to arrive at any conclusion. Besides, who really knows what goes on in those little bird brains?

Here in Delhi, birders have been going round the bend trying to figure out why an

oriental pied hornbill has shanghaied the babies of two grey hornbill families and is feeding the chicks — and aggressively driving away the legit biological parents — from the hollows. She is not a bona fide bird-citizen of the capital (and you wouldn't need an avian SIR to tell you that), so what is she doing here in the first place?

There is, in fact, so much we don't know about the way nature works, a trillion puzzles and unanswered questions, in spite of the enormous body of work and inquiry done towards solving some of these mysteries. We still don't know exactly how migratory birds find their way to and fro from their breeding grounds to their winter homestays and back. We don't know how a mango tree produces its luscious fruit. We may have figured out the ingredients — what the flesh and juice are made of — even synthesised the recipe in our labs, but how

the heck does a mere tree, standing in the mud, do this? How does it know how to package it all in a safe, sustainable container? Can we acquire all the ingredients from the mud, and with the help of air, sunlight and water only, replicate the recipe?

Sadly, there is only one thing we are excellent at: Destroying as much of nature as we can by gouging the earth, poisoning the air, fouling the water, damming rivers, mining in the mountains and felling the forests (in spite of knowing how valuable they are).

It will be interesting to see when the Millennium City's waders will be up and off and when they return this winter. Perhaps they are just taking a gap year, which again will leave us scratching our heads. Well, everyone does, so why not them?

*Lal is an author, environmentalist and birdwatcher*





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If there are questions of current or contemporary relevance that you would like explained, please write to explained@indianexpress.com

• LEGAL

## ‘100%’ tag on label, disclaimers on the back: Why CCPA fined 2 companies

**Vineet Bhalla**  
New Delhi, June 25

FROM JUICES to breads, the “100%” label is a near-ubiquitous marketing tool meant to assure consumers of a product’s unadulterated quality.

In two orders this month, however, the Central Consumer Protection Authority (CCPA) imposed a penalty of Rs 1 lakh each on two major food and beverage companies — Mrs. Bectors Food Specialities Ltd and Stora Foods and Beverages Pvt Ltd — for running misleading advertisements and engaging in unfair trade practices by prominently using “100%” claims on their packaging and promotional materials.

The CCPA invoked Section 2(28) of the Consumer Protection Act, 2019, which defines a “misleading advertisement” as one that falsely describes a product, gives a false guarantee or deliberately conceals important information. It also relied on Section 2(47), which defines an “unfair trade practice” as making false representations about the standard, quality or composition of goods. The regulatory backdrop for these orders was set by the Food Safety and Standards Authority of India (FSSAI). In an advisory in May last year, the food regulator noted a trend of brands using the “100%” term. The FSSAI had said the term is not defined in its advertising regulations and that its use “is likely to convey a false sense of absolute purity or superiority...”.

### ‘100% Atta Bread’

This false sense of purity was the focal point in the case against Mrs. Bectors, the makers of English Oven bread. The CCPA took suo motu cognisance of advertisements for the company’s “100% Atta Bread” and “100% Whole Wheat Bread”. The company admitted that the actual wheat flour (atta) content was only 87%. But it said the “100%” was meant to convey that wheat flour was the “sole grain source” used, without any refined flour (maida). The company also relied on FSSAI labelling regulations, which state that for a bread to be classified as “Whole Wheat Bread”, it must contain a minimum of 75% whole wheat flour. The CCPA, however, said that the FSSAI regulations cannot be “elevated into a justification for making an unqualified and absolute claim such as ‘100% Atta Bread’.” It observed that a consumer would reasonably construe the label to mean the product is entirely composed of atta.

### ‘100% Tender Coconut Water’

The CCPA applied similar reasoning was applied in the case against Stora. In this, the CCPA investigated the company’s “100% Tender Coconut Water” and various “100% Juice” variants. The consumer watchdog found that Stora’s coconut water was reconstituted from a 9.6% coconut water concentrate. Likewise, its “100% Juice” variants consisted predominantly of water, with fruit pulp or concentrate ranging between 4% and 16%.

Stora contended that the FSSAI permits the reconstitution of juices from concentrates. The company said that because its manufacturing process was legally compliant and because it had included a disclaimer on the back of the pack stating the product was “reconstituted”, the front-of-pack “100%” claim was valid.

The CCPA, however, drew a distinction between a permitted manufacturing process and deceptive marketing. It ruled that while FSSAI allows reconstitution, it does not grant a manufacturer the right to present a diluted, reconstituted product as undiluted natural produce. The watchdog said fine-print disclaimers on the back of the pack don’t make up for misleading claims on the front.

• POLICY

## If passport is not proof of citizenship, what is



DEEPTIMAN TIWARY

THE MINISTRY of External Affairs (MEA) Wednesday clarified that a passport is primarily a travel document and not a standalone proof of citizenship. The statement, made on Passport Seva Divas, triggered confusion. For most Indians, the passport is the most authoritative document issued by the state — carrying the Republic’s name, accepted across the world and issued only after verification by government authorities.

The MEA’s clarification, however, reflects a longstanding position: a passport is issued because the government is satisfied a person is an Indian citizen, but it does not create citizenship, nor is it conclusive proof of citizenship if challenged in law.

### Citizenship a legal status

Articles 5 to 11 of the Constitution and the Citizenship Act, 1955 define who is an Indian citizen. Significantly, neither identifies any single document as proof of citizenship.

Instead, citizenship is treated as a legal status arising from facts such as birth, parentage, domicile, or naturalisation. Documents serve as evidence of those facts. For a person born in India, citizenship depends on when they were born and, in certain cases, the citizenship status of their parents. For someone naturalised, it depends on compliance with statutory conditions.

This distinction is reflected in an answer given by the Ministry of Home Affairs in Parliament in February 2020. Asked whether Aadhaar, passport, voter ID, PAN card or birth certificate constitute valid proof of citizenship, the government said: “Acquisition of Indian Citizenship is governed by The Citizenship Act, 1955 and rules made thereunder. Citizenship of India can be acquired by birth or descent or registration or naturalisation or incorporation of territory. The eligibility criteria for acquisition and determination of citizenship is as per the provisions of the Citizenship Act, 1955.”

Notably, it did not identify any of the documents as citizenship documents. Yet, under the Citizenship Rules, 2003, those seeking Indian citizenship under certain provisions produce a copy of their parents’

### • WHO IS AN INDIAN CITIZEN?

Under the Citizenship Act of 1955, there are four ways to obtain citizenship:

- 1. Citizenship by birth:** For birthright citizenship, those born in India between 1950 and 1987 are citizens.
- For those born between 1987 and 2003, citizenship is accorded only if either parent is a citizen of India at the time of their birth.
- For those born after 2003, citizenship is accorded if only if either parent is a citizen at the time of their birth and the other is not an illegal immigrant.

**2. Citizenship by descent:** A person born outside India and who has at least one Indian parent will be granted citizenship, provided that the birth is registered within one year with the Indian consulate in the jurisdiction.

**3. Citizenship by registration:** This is for persons related to an Indian citizen through marriage or ancestry.



- Citizenship is treated as a legal status arising from facts such as birth, parentage, domicile or naturalisation.
- Documents serve as evidence of those facts. A **passport** is issued because the government is satisfied a person is a citizen. It does not create citizenship.

**4. Citizenship by naturalisation:** Naturalisation certificate can be granted to a person who isn’t an illegal immigrant and has lived in India for 12 months continuously before applying.

- In the 14 years before the 12-month period, the person must have lived in India for at least 11 years. This is relaxed for some categories.

**Waiver clause:** If the Centre believes the applicant has rendered distinguished service to science, philosophy, art, literature, world peace or human progress, it may waive all or any of the conditions in the Act. This is how the Dalai Lama or Adnan Sami, the Pakistani singer, got Indian citizenship.

- BY APURVA VISHWANATH

passports to prove they are Indian citizens.

### Eligibility for passport

Section 20 of the Act empowers the Centre to issue a passport or travel document even to non-Indian citizen if it considers such issuance necessary in public interest.

MEA sources said the provision is used in special cases. “Largely, cases where say an Indian origin person becomes stateless due to geo-political developments, or someone stateless is in India and must travel abroad,” an official said. Historically, Tibetan refugees and Sri Lankan Tamils in India have been issued special travel documents when visiting other countries, sources said. In 2023, the Madras High Court asked the Centre to grant a passport to a Sri Lankan Tamil Refugee under Section 20 of the Passport Act.

### What courts have held

During hearings on the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls in Bihar last year, a Supreme Court bench of Justice Surya Kant and Justice Joymalaya Bagchi observed: “We would like you to clarify...we have repeatedly passed order that the list illustratively indicates 11 documents...if you see those 11, apart from passport and birth certificates, none are conclusive proof of citizenship.”

The observation appeared to place pas-

### Common principle

In the UK and US, too, passports are issued because the state has determined that a person is a citizen; they do not themselves create citizenship.

- The difference is that both countries have more robust civil registration systems and, for naturalised citizens, formal citizenship certificates.

• TECH

## In Kunal Shah appointment, a signal of WhatsApp’s India ambitions

**Pratyush Deep & Soumyarendra Barik**  
New Delhi, June 25

META’S APPOINTMENT of CRED founder Kunal Shah as WhatsApp global CEO and its \$900-million (around Rs 8,500 crore) investment in the fintech app offer clues about its long-term ambitions in its largest market — India.

The choice of an Indian entrepreneur to lead WhatsApp is significant, and in some ways logical. India accounts for 500 million, or a sixth, of WhatsApp’s three billion monthly global active users. This is WhatsApp’s largest user base in any country.

Shah’s appointment comes at a time when WhatsApp is struggling to convert this massive user base into a sustainable revenue engine. Unlike Meta’s other flagship platforms, Instagram and Facebook, WhatsApp remains relatively undermonetised. Efforts to unlock new revenue streams have delivered limited results. WhatsApp Pay, for instance, has struggled to gain traction despite India witnessing explosive growth in digital payments over the past few years.

Shah, whose entrepreneurial journey is rooted in fintech, is seen by industry players as likely playing a key role in addressing this challenge. His understanding of consumer behaviour, payments and data-driven business models could help Meta identify ways to monetise WhatsApp’s user base in India.

### A shift to a ‘superapp’?

Shah’s appointment has also fuelled speculation that WhatsApp could increasingly move towards a premiumisation strategy — an area that has become central to Shah’s thinking in recent years.

His own entrepreneurial journey, from FreeCharge to CRED, illustrates a clear evolution in his strategy.

While FreeCharge was aimed at achieving scale through mass-market penetration, CRED focuses on affluent and credit-worthy consumers. The transition highlights Shah’s shift towards building products for the premium segment.

A senior Meta group employee in the US indicated that Shah also “shares Meta CEO Mark Zuckerberg’s vision around building

### A founder-led approach

- Shah’s appointment reflects a recent pattern of Meta appointing founders in key leadership positions.
- Last year, Meta appointed Alexandr Wang, founder CEO at Scale AI, as its chief AI officer while investing \$14.3 billion in Scale AI.
- Meta acquired a 49% stake in NFDG, the \$1.1 billion AI venture fund run by Nat Friedman and Daniel Gross, last year and hired both to join its leadership team.

a superapp”. It is learned that Meta wanted him to do it earlier as head of WhatsApp in India, but it finally led to a global role. This may be why Shah emphasised “global” in his LinkedIn post announcing his WhatsApp appointment, the employee pointed out.

Superapps are all-encompassing digital platforms that combine a wide variety of services — messaging, payments, ride-hailing, shopping and food delivery — and thus eliminate the need to download multiple standalone apps.

In India, the leading contenders in the superapp race are Tata Group’s Tata Neu, Reliance’s Jio Platforms, Paytm, PhonePe and AdaniOne, among others.

While the superapp model has achieved significant success in China and some South East Asian countries, it has struggled to gain similar traction in India. A key reason is the maturity and saturation of India’s digital ecosystem, where consumers already have access to a wide range of specialised apps for shopping, travel, payments, food delivery, and other services.

However, WhatsApp may be better posi-

tioned than its rivals to make the superapp model work in India. With its huge user base in India and deep integration into daily life, the platform enjoys a level of reach and familiarity unmatched by most competitors. Meta has already rolled out elements of the superapp concept in several markets and has long viewed India — its largest user base globally — as a key market for expanding the platform’s capabilities beyond messaging. The company is aiming to replicate, at least in part, the success of China’s WeChat, which has evolved into an all-in-one platform for communication, payments, commerce and a range of everyday services.

There are notable similarities between CRED and WhatsApp. Both offer services that are largely free to users, while deriving value from the data, engagement and ecosystems built around those users.

While Shah has maintained that Meta will not gain access to CRED user data as part of the investment, the partnership is nevertheless likely to deepen Meta’s understanding of India’s digitally active and financially attractive consumer segments.

• GLOBAL

## Behind Venezuela’s quake devastation: Rare ‘seismic doublet’, vulnerable location

**Anagha Jayakumar**  
New Delhi, June 25

THE TWIN earthquakes near Venezuela capital Caracas are feared to have killed tens of thousands. The first quake, with a magnitude of 7.2, hit about 160 km west of Caracas late on Wednesday night. Just 39 seconds later, it was followed by a magnitude 7.5 quake. The US Geological Survey (USGS) described the disaster as a “seismic doublet”. The second quake was the largest to strike Venezuela or just off its coast since 1900, according to the USGS.

The agency’s preliminary death toll estimate ranges from 10,000 to 100,000. Officials warned this could become one of the country’s deadliest natural disasters.

**What do we know about the quakes?**

The first earthquake struck about 24 km from San Felipe in Yaracuy state. The second hit near Morón in neighbouring Carabobo state, about 168 km west of Caracas, according to the USGS.

The shocks from the disaster were felt as far away as neighbouring Colombia, with residents in the capital, Bogotá, reporting

feeling the tremors. *Associated Press* also reported that buildings were evacuated in Manaus, Belem and Macapa in Brazil’s Amazon region. Venezuela President Delcy Rodríguez said the worst-affected areas included Caracas and the north-central states of Miranda, La Guaira, Aragua, Carabobo and Falcón. Despite the widespread damage, Venezuela’s oil infrastructure did not appear to be affected, according to *Reuters*.

### Why was it called a doublet?

Given that both earthquakes occurred within a short time and distance from each other, the USGS classified the event as a doublet. In a typical sequence, the larger quake is followed by a series of smaller aftershocks. Doublets, however, are generally defined as earthquakes of similar magnitude that originate from distinct but closely related ruptures and occur in quick succession.

### What caused the earthquakes?

Venezuela sits in one of the most seismically active regions in northern South America, along the boundary between the Caribbean and South American tectonic

### • What is a fault?

A fault is a fracture or zone of fractures between two blocks of rock. When these blocks move rapidly, they cause quakes.

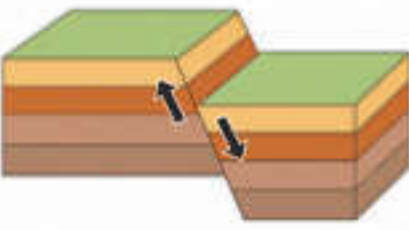
#### WHAT HAPPENED IN VENEZUELA?



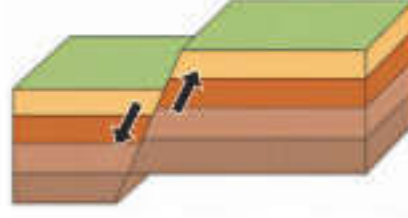
**STRIKE-SLIP FAULT:**  
Two blocks slide past one another

#### Some other types of faults

**Normal fault:**  
The block above the fault moves downward relative to the block below.



**Reverse fault:**  
Upper block, above the fault plane, moves up and over the lower block



plates. These two plates can slide horizontally past each other along faults, in a phenomenon called a strike-slip fault, causing earthquakes.

The country has witnessed about a thousand earthquakes of magnitude 4.0 and higher over the past decade.

According to the USGS, Wednesday night’s second, stronger earthquake re-

sulted from shallow strike-slip faulting near the boundary between the two plates.

The USGS classified the magnitude 7.2 earthquake as a foreshock, or a smaller earthquake that occurs before a larger one, and the magnitude 7.5 event as the mainshock, the largest earthquake in a sequence. The agency said the sequence “likely indicates a complex rupture interaction pro-

cess” that formed a seismic doublet. The USGS said quakes of this size should not be viewed as a single point on a map but as the rupture of a much larger section of fault.

### Why were they so destructive?

The mainshock occurred at a relatively shallow depth of about 10 km. This meant that the shockwaves reached the surface with high intensity. Worsening the situation was the fact that this was a doublet, distinct from routine aftershocks.

“Aftershocks are largely a result of disturbances or ruptures caused by the main earthquake. Some stress is already present, and it is then amplified by the main earthquake, resulting in another quake. Aftershocks are usually one or more magnitude smaller than the main earthquake, although these are not very tight definitions, and have to be assessed on a case-by-case basis,” Vineet Gehlot, director of Dehradun-based Wadia Institute of Himalayan Geology, told *The Indian Express*.

“Doublets are two independent events happening within a very short span of time, a few seconds or a few minutes, or maybe a couple of hours. They are roughly of the

same magnitude and happen in close proximity to each other,” he said.

Doublets can also be especially destructive because they prolong the strong ground shaking. A 2016 study in *Nature Geoscience* analysing Pakistan’s 1997 Hamai earthquake found that a second major shock, which struck 19 seconds after the first, doubled both the duration of ground shaking and the area affected by the strongest shaking. Thus, buildings weakened by the first quake remain exposed to another major shock almost immediately, increasing the risk of collapse and complicating rescue efforts.

### Have doublets occurred in the past?

- **IN 2023**, a doublet quake struck Turkey and Syria, measuring at magnitudes of 7.8 and 7.7. These happened just 95 km and nine hours apart, affecting 14 million people and causing widespread damage.
- **IN 2021**, a major doublet-like event occurred when quakes of magnitudes 8.6 and 8.2 struck the Indian Ocean, near Malaysia.
- **IN 1988**, a “triple” — a series of three earthquakes just half an hour apart from each other — occurred in Australia.

- WITH INPUTS FROM AMITABH SINHA

epaper.indianexpress.com

New Delhi



FPI INVESTMENT IN FULLY ACCESSIBLE ROUTE BONDS HAS BEEN \$2.2 BILLION IN JUNE

## Govt, RBI’s bond measures pull 8 months of FPI money in 2 weeks

Siddharth Upasani  
New Delhi, June 25

THE MEASURES announced by the government and the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) on June 5 to attract foreign capital into Indian sovereign bonds have started to work as hoped — debt falling under the Fully Accessible Route (FAR) category has seen inflows to the tune of \$2 billion in the subsequent two weeks, almost equal to the money that had come in the previous eight months combined.

Data from the National Securities Depository Ltd (NSDL) showed that Foreign Portfolio Investors (FPIs) have net bought FAR bonds on all but one day since capital gain taxes on government bonds were done away with and the pool of securities in this category expanded. This has led to net inflows in these bonds in June rising to \$2.2 billion — the highest in 15 months.

In March 2025, FPIs had invested \$3.34 billion in FAR bonds — a category of government bonds that foreigners can invest in without any curbs.

According to Radhika Rao, Senior Economist at DBS Bank, foreign investors have “turned constructive” on rupee debt. “Sentiment has been supported

in part by expectations that Indian government bonds could be considered for inclusion in Bloomberg’s global bond indices,” Rao said Wednesday.

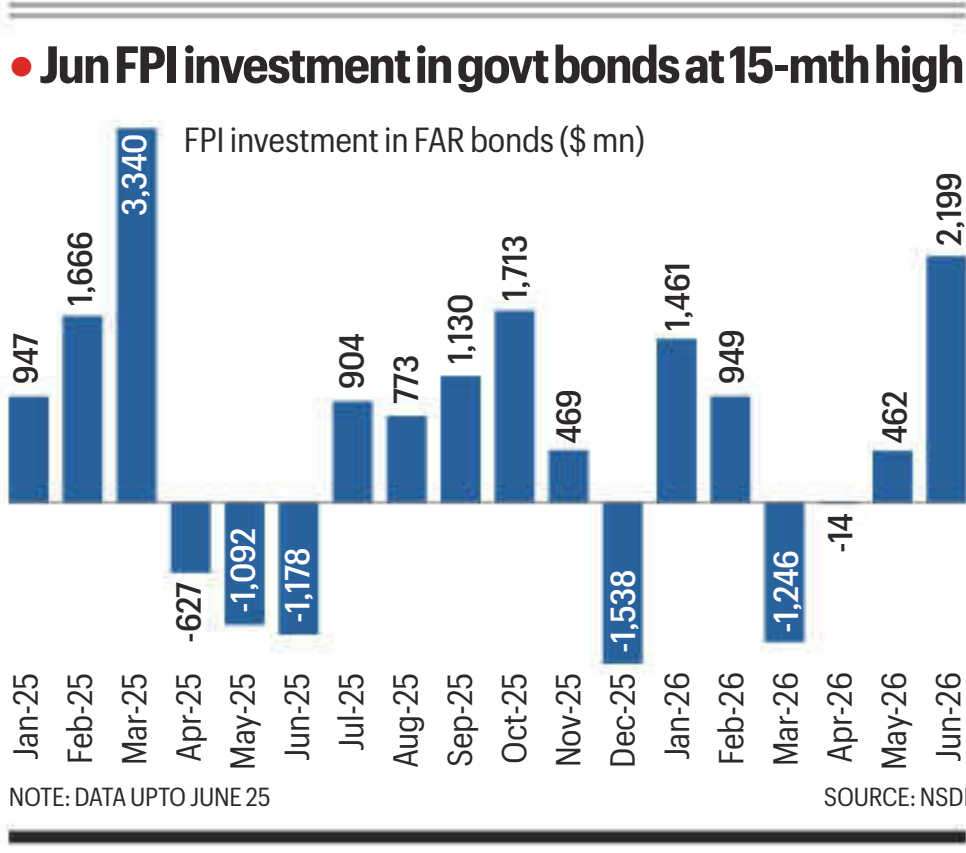
### Cooling bond yields, triggers ahead

The removal of long- and short-term capital gains as well as the withholding tax on investment by foreign investors in government bonds was aimed at spurring their inclusion in the Bloomberg Global Aggregate Bond Index, which economists predict could pull in anywhere between \$20 billion to \$30 billion of passive foreign funds over a period of 10 months post inclusion.

Several global funds track the weight a certain country has in these bond indices and invest accordingly.

In January, Bloomberg Index Services Ltd (BISL) had deferred the inclusion of Indian government bonds into its flagship global index, saying it will provide another update by mid-2026. Over the last couple of years, Indian government debt has been added to bond indices of JPMorgan, Bloomberg’s Emerging Market Local Currency Index and that of FTSE Russell.

On Thursday, yield on the benchmark 10-year Indian gov-



ernment bond was 6.77% in secondary market, 22 basis points (bps) lower than on June 4.

One basis point is one-hundredth of a percentage point. Bond yields move opposite to their prices. So, a fall in yields means prices have risen, which is profitable for bond holders.

The decline in bond yields has also been aided by comments by RBI Governor Sanjay Malhotra, who in an interview this week argued against expectations of interest rate hikes.

While foreign investors are now putting more money into

government bonds, they continue to dump stock, with net share sales increasing to \$5.55 billion so far this month from \$3.45 billion in May.

Consequently, net FPI investment in Indian shares and debt across all categories has still seen an outflow of \$562 million so far in June, as per NSDL data. As a result, the Indian rupee is trading not too far from its June 5 level of 94.94 per dollar, having closed at 94.40 on Thursday.

FULL REPORT ON  
[WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM](http://WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM)

### RBI’s G-sec holding rises to 13-year high

Christina Titus & Kishor Kadam  
Mumbai, June 25

THE RBI’s holdings of Indian government securities rose to a multi-year high after aggressive bond purchases. As per the data it released this week, RBI’s bond holdings rose to 17.6% of outstanding issuance at the end of March from 14.5% as of December-end.

“The RBI had to undertake large-scale G-Sec purchases through OMO operations to inject durable liquidity into the banking system, which resulted in RBI holdings reaching multi-year highs,” said Mataprasad Pandey, VP, Arete Capital. It had bought bonds worth Rs 3.5 lakh crore via open market operations and Rs 90,000 crore through secondary market purchases in March quarter. In FY26, they purchased a record Rs 8.56 lakh crore, accounting for over 80% of net borrowing. As of March-end, outstanding bond issuance was at Rs 125.67 lakh crore. FE

### ● HORMUZ REOPENING EASES TAIL RISK, BUT COSTS STAY ELEVATED

The reopening of Strait of Hormuz lowers immediate tail risk for Asia-Pacific, but supply normalisation will be slower, costlier & more fragmented, S&P Global Ratings said in a report.

#### South Asia faces second-order risks

- India is the world’s largest urea importer and relies heavily on Gulf suppliers
- Bangladesh and others depend on imported fertilisers and gas-linked nitrogen production
- Alternative supply from North Africa, Russia, China or Europe could help, but would be slower and costlier

#### Fragility remains despite easing prices

- Brent crude retreated to below \$80, LNG Japan Korea Marker is near \$15 per mmbtu after Iran-US MoU
- S&P said lower prices do not mean physical markets have healed
- Shipping, insurance, port and operational constraints could delay a return to pre-conflict flows



“A Hormuz reopening reduces immediate tail risk, but Asia-Pacific still faces slower, costlier, and more fragmented operating conditions.”

EUNICE TAN, HEAD OF ASIA-PACIFIC CREDIT RESEARCH, S&P GLOBAL RATINGS

SOURCE: S&P GLOBAL RATINGS REPORT ‘HORMUZ REOPENS, FRAGILITY REMAINS’/PTI

## Govt raises LPG supplies to industry on better availability

**New Delhi:** India has increased supplies of liquefied petroleum gas (LPG) to non-household users and removed caps on supplies to various commercial sectors after increased availability, the government said in a statement issued Thursday.

“The restoration follows the recent improvement in the LPG supply situation,” the government said. India has decided to

restore 50% LPG supplies to commercial and industrial customers whose allocation had been suspended. The country has also decided to increase the supply of propane, butane, and other molecules for petrochemical production, the government said.

Before the conflict, India was buying 90% of its LPG imports from Middle Eastern producers. REUTERS

RBI’S NEW FRAUD COMPENSATION MECHANISM

## Relief to digital fraud victims: How losses up to Rs 50K can be recovered

Akash Mandal  
Mumbai, June 25

VICTIMS OF digital transaction fraud can breathe easy. Under the Reserve Bank of India’s (RBI) revised compensation mechanism, victims of digital payment fraud involving amounts up to Rs 50,000 can recover a major portion of the money lost to fraud. Notified by the central bank on Wednesday, and effective January 1, 2027, the new system is another measure to limit customer liability and safeguard customers in such situations.

The new framework, under which the RBI has offered to compensate a substantial portion, comes at a time when bank frauds, especially digital transaction frauds, have become a growing concern for it. In FY26, while the reported fraud cases more than halved to 10,114, the amount involved rose 46% to Rs 48,021 crore.

#### What has changed?

The central bank has attempted to make the new compensation guidelines strongly pro-consumer. The RBI will contribute the major part of the compensation under the new framework.

Under the new mechanism, victims are eligible for compensation of up to 85% of their losses, up to Rs 25,000, thereby reducing the hit they take from such frauds. A bona fide victim who lodged a complaint involving gross loss of an amount up to Rs 50,000 on account of a fraudulent electronic banking transaction (EBT) will be compensated 85% of the net loss amount or Rs 25,000, whichever is less, once during the lifetime, the RBI’s new framework reads. For a complaint involving a loss of less than Rs 29,412 via fraudulent EBT, the customer will re-



New framework comes as digital transaction frauds have become a key concern for RBI. REUTERS

ceive 85% of the amount as compensation. Victims are eligible for such compensation only if they lodge a complaint regarding the fraud within five calendar days. The loss must also be established in accordance with the internal processes set out in the victim’s bank’s policy.

#### Who pays the compensation?

The RBI states that victim’s bank must compensate them entirely for any fraud arising from the bank’s negligence. Negligence in this case includes failing to ensure proper safety and security mechanisms for EBTs,

leading to send mandatory alerts for EBTs above Rs 500, failing to provide 24x7 channels for customer complaints, system malfunctions, security breaches, and failing to act diligently on customer complaints. The framework specifies that banks must resolve customer complaints regarding fraudulent EBTs within 45 calendar days for domestic fraudulent EBTs, and within 60 days for cross-border fraudulent EBTs. In the case of a fraud of less than Rs 29,412, where the customer is to be paid 85% of the amount lost in compensation, 65% of the cost

DAY AFTER NEGOTIATIONS ENDED IN DELHI

## For a trade deal, US has to ensure competitive edge for India: Goyal

### ‘US has to find appropriate tools, legal backing for it’

Ravi Dutta Mishra  
New Delhi, June 25

A DAY after a visiting US delegation, led by United States Trade Representative (USTR) Jamieson Greer, concluded negotiations on a bilateral trade deal with India, Union Commerce and Industry Minister Piyush Goyal said Thursday that the agreement will be signed the day the US ensures a competitive edge for India over countries such as Vietnam, Thailand, the Philippines, Indonesia, Malaysia and China.

Responding to a question on the status of the deal at the India Global Forum in London, Goyal said, “The India-US deal was done on February 6th. It was confirmed by both the US and India. There were International Emergency Economic Powers Act (IEEPA) tariffs when we finalised the trade deal. We had negotiated the deal based on bringing down the 50% (tariff) to 18%. The whole deal was centred around that competitive advantage that we got with 18% over our neighbours and competing countries... lower than ASEAN countries other than Singapore.”

“With the US Supreme Court striking down the IEEPA tariffs,



Union Commerce and Industry Minister Piyush Goyal during the India Global Forum (IGF) UK-India Week, in London, on Thursday. PTI

and now with the 10%, which expires on July 24, we have to have some reason to be able to enter into force that agreement which we have agreed upon,” he said.

“And until the framework of getting into the competitive advantage can be finalised, we cannot enter into a US deal. That is broadly the discussion on how the US will find the appropriate tools and legal backing to give us the competitive advantage over our competition. The day this happens, the deal is on,” Goyal said.

Meanwhile, the EU Thursday became one of the largest trading partners to enforce the US deal after the US Supreme Court in February this year ruled tariffs under the IEEPA illegal. Several US deals automatically became unenforceable by partner countries as reciprocal tariffs were no longer in effect.

The US is working on a new tariff structure under Section 301 of the US Trade Act of 1974.

Under the US-EU deal, the EU is expected to eliminate tariffs on all US industrial goods and to provide preferential market access for a wide range of American seafood and agricultural goods including tree nuts, dairy products, fresh and processed fruits and vegetables, processed foods, planting seeds, soybean oil, and pork and bison meat.

The US, in turn, committed to apply the higher of either the US Most Favoured Nation (MFN) tariff rate or a tariff rate of 15%, comprising the MFN tariff and a reciprocal tariff, on originating goods of the EU.

But on June 18, the US opened a fresh Section 301 investigation on Germany, the EU’s largest economy.

● ACCORDING TO COMPANY LEADERS AND ANALYSTS, RESTORING BUSINESS CONFIDENCE IN DUBAI WILL TAKE TIME AND MAY REQUIRE MORE INCENTIVES

## Dubai moves to contain economic fallout from Iran strikes

Reuters  
Dubai, June 25

DAYS AFTER Iran began striking targets at the United Arab Emirates (UAE) in March, Dubai’s top officials gathered hundreds of business leaders to discuss how the Gulf tourism and financial hub could limit the economic damage. The meeting, unusual for its size and timing and reported here for the first time, helped spur measures including a central bank liquidity package, said five people present, who declined to be named because it was private.

Attendees were asked three questions: What should we do to get tourists back? What should we do to get investors back? And how can we support your business? Two of the people said, adding that the crown prince of Dubai had circulated between tables asking business leaders for their input.

Dubai has since pledged 2.5 billion dirhams (\$681 million) in support, focused mainly on sectors such as tourism and retail, which have been hit hardest by the conflict.

#### Peace agreement

While a preliminary US-Iran peace deal is easing the immediate strains, restoring business confidence in Dubai will take time and may require more incentives, six company leaders and analysts told Reuters.

“Investors want signals on how authorities will respond if tensions return, not just how they managed the last shock,” said Neil Quilliam, associate fellow at UK-based think tank Chatham House, almost four months after the war began.

As shelter alerts locked down the UAE, the March 10 meeting was an early signal of authorities’ determination to prevent capital flight or an exodus of



Dubai has pledged 2.5 billion dirhams (\$681 million) to support sectors such as tourism and retail. REUTERS

businesses and investors.

Hosted by Helal Saeed Al Marri, director general of Dubai’s Department of Economy and Tourism, the meeting was also attended by Dubai Crown Prince Sheikh Hamdan bin Mohammed bin Rashid Al-Maktoum.

Those present at the newly renovated Meydan hotel included real-estate magnate Hussein Sajwani, Emirates airline president Tim Clark and representatives of Rothschild and UBS. The UAE’s military and big family-owned companies were also represented.

Government officials told business leaders there would be fiscal and financial support and that teams were working tirelessly on supply chains, the sources said. Several investor calls arranged through banks including JPMorgan and Citi have followed, another three people said. Rothschild, JPMorgan, Citi and UBS declined to comment. DAMAC and Emirates did not respond to requests for comment.

#### ‘Dubai-it’

Big billboards appeared along the city’s roads last week with just the words: “Dubai-it”, a new term coined by the government in what it says is a nod to Dubai’s history of getting big things done fast and a sign of what is to come. With oil generating less than 2% of its GDP, Dubai sought international companies, Wall Street and Chinese banks, hedge funds

and the wealthy. Its convenient time zone, proximity to the Gulf’s sovereign wealth funds and favourable tax regime have drawn capital and jobs.

For Iran, that made it a target that could unsettle international finance, adding to pressure on Washington.

HSBC analysts have cut their 2026 Gulf growth forecast by 5 percentage points since the conflict began and now expect the region to contract for the first time since the covid-19 pandemic. Non-oil growth in Dubai and Abu Dhabi could fall 8 percentage points or more year-on-year, they said.

● BRIEFLY

May telecom subscriber base grows to 134 cr

**New Delhi:** Telecom subscriber base grew to 134.3 crore in May, led by net additions on the Bharti Airtel and Reliance Jio networks, said the Trai data released on Thursday. Airtel led the growth in subscriber base with net addition of 29.8 lakh subscribers over the month of April. PTI

‘Key infra projects log Rs 5.4 lakh cr cost overrun’

**New Delhi:** Infrastructure projects worth above Rs 150 crore logged a cumulative cost overrun of about Rs 5.4 lakh crore, said Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation’s report for May. The cumulative expenditure incurred on projects was at Rs 21.82 lakh crore, accounting for approximately 51.34% of revised project cost. PTI

|                                                  |                                                |                               |                               |
|--------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|
| <p>Sensex<br/>77,100.47<br/>109.25<br/>0.14%</p> | <p>NIFTY<br/>24,056.00<br/>34.35<br/>0.14%</p> | <p>Gold ▼<br/>₹1,39,873</p>   | <p>US Dollar ▼<br/>₹94.40</p> |
|                                                  |                                                | <p>Silver ▼<br/>₹2,16,541</p> | <p>Oil ▼<br/>\$70.71</p>      |

NOTE: GOLD, SILVER RATES: AS PER INDIA BULLION AND JEWELLERS ASSOCIATION DATA  
GOLD PER 10G, SILVER PER 1 KG; CRUDE OIL (INDIAN BASKET) AS OF JUNE 24, 2026



**FIRST QUAKE** of magnitude 7.2 hit west of Moron on Caribbean coast; a minute later, a second 7.5 magnitude earthquake struck.

**DISTRAUGHT RESIDENTS** search for their loved ones in the rubble; shocked survivors taken away on stretchers.

**VENEZUELA HAS** been facing economic disarray and this disaster poses a huge challenge for President Delcy Rodríguez.

# ‘Like a horror movie scene’

## Collapsed homes & lives: Quakes in Venezuela one of worst in its history

Associated Press & Reuters  
Caracas, June 25

VENEZUELAN SEARCHED for survivors beneath collapsed buildings on Thursday and rescue teams raced to the areas hardest hit by a pair of powerful earthquakes that rocked northern Venezuela, killing at least 164 people. The 7.2- and 7.5-magnitude earthquakes that struck Wednesday evening were among the strongest in Venezuela in more than a century and could be felt throughout region.

Buildings were evacuated as far away as Brazil’s Amazon, about 1,700 km from Caracas, where the country’s main airport was closed after sustaining damages. Panicked residents of poured into the streets, where many people walked among the debris searching for the missing. Television broadcasts showed rescue workers using power tools to get through piles of rubble where buildings stood.

In La Guaira, Cristian Carreño stared stunned at his charred apartment building tilting precariously to one side. “I lost everything. Everything,” he said. “There are people still inside, I imagine, that couldn’t get out. It’s incredibly devastating.”

The natural disaster poses a major challenge for acting President Delcy Rodríguez, the former vice president who took office in January after the capture of Maduro. Venezuela has been facing economic disarray for more than a decade, and many people reject the legitimacy of the political movement she represents. Footage on state TV showed three children, covered in dust but alive, pulled from the rubble in La Guaira state, which Rodríguez described as a “disaster zone.”

“When we went downstairs, the scene was like a horror

“It was awful. We cried, we screamed. Thankfully, we’re alive.”

MARÍA CRISTINA DÍAZ, A JANITOR

movie,” Maria Alejandra, a resident, told Reuters.

Rodríguez appealed to businesses to make heavy construction equipment available for rescue operations, adding search and rescue teams certified by the UN were on their way to help.

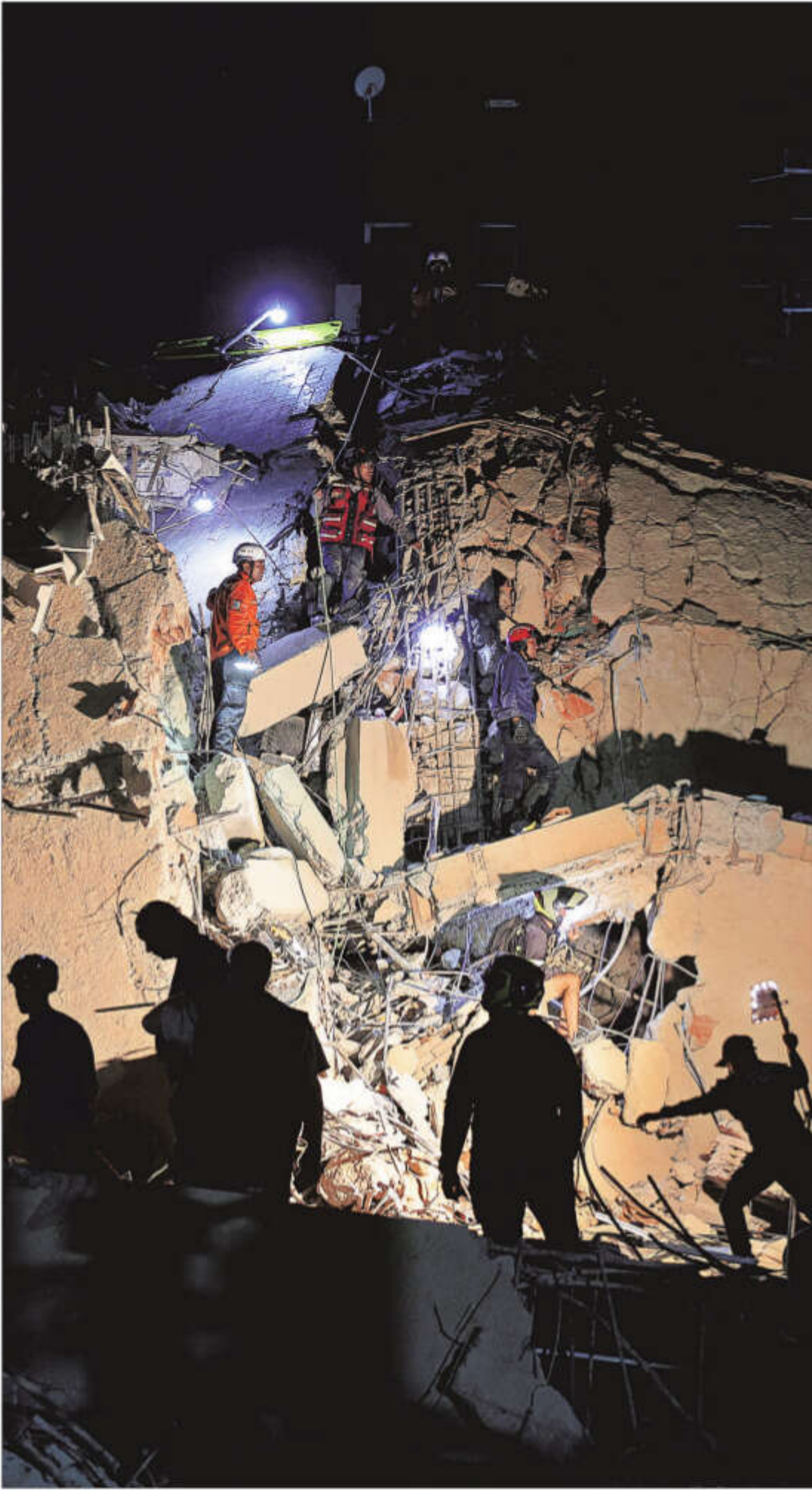
The US Geological Survey said the first earthquake, with a magnitude of 7.2, hit west of Moron on the Caribbean coast, about 170 km west of Caracas. It had a depth of 22 km. Just a minute later, USGS reported a second 7.5 magnitude quake, with a depth of 10 km and an epicenter 16 km southwest of Moron.

During the quakes, people ran from swaying buildings, and many were shocked when they turned back to see destroyed walls that left furniture visible from the street.

Dayana Delgado, mother of three children, said she was desperate because her 8-year-old was missing. “I want to know where my child is, if he’s trapped or in a shelter,” she said.

In downtown Caracas, hundreds of people spent the night huddled around parks, parking lots and open spaces. “We were afraid the buildings would collapse on us,” said María Cristina Díaz, a 41-year-old janitor. “My mother, my daughter and I were cold. We didn’t sleep a wink; but I didn’t want to spend the night alone at home after that terrible earthquake.”

“It was awful. We cried, we screamed. Thankfully, we’re alive,” she added.



Rescue workers search through the rubble after an earthquake in Caracas, Venezuela, on Thursday. AP

## Trump says earthquakes caused a ‘devastating number of deaths’

Reuters

Washington, June 25

US PRESIDENT Donald Trump on Wednesday said the two earthquakes that hit Venezuela earlier in the day had “left a devastating number of deaths,” without citing any official casualty figures.

“The two major earthquakes that just hit the great people of Venezuela are both massive in scale and have left a devastating number of deaths,” Trump said in a post on Truth Social. “The USA stands ready, willing, and able to help! I have instructed all agencies of our government to get ready to move quickly. We will be there for our new and great friends. Early reports are not good.”

The US said late on Wednesday it was in touch with Venezuelan authorities and was mobilizing assistance for the South American nation. “We’re in touch with the authorities and mobilizing assistance,” Deputy Secretary of State Christopher Landau said on X. He said the earthquakes were “devastating.”

US State Department official Jeremy Lewin said on X the department mobilized a disaster

### • WORLD OFFERS HELP

“We pray for the speedy recovery of those injured and stand in solidarity with all those affected during this difficult time. India stands ready to extend all possible assistance.”

NARENDRA MODI, PRIME MINISTER OF INDIA



“The USA stands ready, willing and able to help! I have instructed all agencies of our government to get ready to move quickly. We will be there for our new and great friends.”

DONALD TRUMP, PRESIDENT OF UNITED STATES

“France stands ready... to provide assistance to the affected Venezuelan population... A team of 85 French rescue workers specializing in search and rescue operations is being deployed immediately.”

EMMANUEL MACRON, PRESIDENT OF FRANCE



assistance team and task force to deliver and coordinate critical assistance to Venezuelans.

“Working with our partners in the interim Venezuelan government, the US will be sending search and rescue teams, medi-

cal and humanitarian supplies and other resources in the crucial first days after this tragic natural disaster,” he added.

The US Embassy in Caracas reported that all American personnel were accounted for.



Residents console a man outside his home after successive earthquakes, in Caracas, on Thursday. AP

## As Hormuz oil flow rebounds, US tries to reassure Gulf allies that deal is sound

### Trump clashes with Republican senator over Iran agreement

Reuters

Dubai, Washington, June 25

OIL PRICES fell to pre-war levels on Thursday as the United States said flows through the Strait of Hormuz were nearing normal and its top diplomat wrapped up a Gulf tour aimed at winning support for a preliminary Iran deal.

US Energy Secretary Chris Wright said shipments through the strait were approaching levels seen before the US and Israel launched strikes on Iran on February 28, with at least 20 mil-

### Cargo ship ‘attacked’ while crossing Strait of Hormuz

London, Athens: A cargo ship reported a suspected attack as it attempted to pass through the Strait of Hormuz close to the coast of Oman on Thursday, British navy agency UKMTO said.

The UN’s International Maritime Organization is currently assisting ships escape the Gulf, hundreds of which have been stranded there since the Iran war

began at the end of February.

The ship reported being struck on its starboard side by a projectile 7.5 nautical miles southeast of Oman’s port of Dahit, the UKMTO said.

Another maritime security source said the vessel was likely targeted by a drone, although it was not clear yet who carried out the strike.

REUTERS

lion barrels exiting the strait in the previous 24 hours.

Despite the recovery in traffic, Iran signaled it would continue to assert control. Its Revolutionary Guards on Thursday

warned vessels to stick to routes through the strait designated by Tehran, rejecting newly announced shipping routes not coordinated with Iran as unacceptable and dangerous.

The warning came after Oman announced temporary shipping lanes through the strait in coordination with the United Nations’ shipping agency.

Data from the UN’s International Maritime Organization showed that 57 ships carrying about 1,100 seafarers have transited the strait since June 23 under the evacuation plan.

US Secretary of State Marco Rubio sought to reassure Gulf allies wary of Washington’s preliminary accord with Tehran.

After meeting with Gulf Arab foreign ministers in Bahrain, home to the US Navy’s Fifth Fleet, he told reporters that Gulf allies shared some serious concerns and that they wanted to be informed of every step of the peace accord, which includes provisions on Strait of Hormuz.

## Top court sides with Trump in asylum-processing case

Reuters

Washington, June 25

THE US Supreme Court handed President Donald Trump a victory on Thursday by backing the federal government’s authority to turn away asylum seekers when officials deem US-Mexico border crossings too overburdened to handle additional claims.

The court, in a 6-3 ruling powered by its conservative justices, overturned a lower court’s finding that the policy violated federal law. The Republican president’s administration has said it may seek to revive the policy, known as “metering,” after it was dropped by Trump’s Democratic predecessor Joe Biden.

The metering policy allowed US immigration officials to stop asylum seekers at the border and

indefinitely decline to process their claims. It is separate from a sweeping policy to deny entry to asylum seekers at the border that Trump announced after returning to the presidency last year. That policy also faces an ongoing legal challenge.

Under US law, a migrant who “arrives in the US” may apply for asylum and must be inspected by a federal immigration official.

Conservative Justice Samuel Alito, who authored Thursday’s ruling, wrote the answer is “no.”

“In ordinary speech, no one would say that a person ‘arrives in’ a place — for example, a house, a city or a country — before the person enters that place,” Alito wrote. “The context in which the phrase ‘arrives in the US’ is used in the immigration statutes at issue here supports an ordinary-meaning reading.”

### • BRIEFLY

UNITED STATES

#### US Army Europe commander to step down soon

THE COMMANDER of the US Army in Europe and Africa, General Christopher Donahue, will relinquish his post on July 2, the US Army said in a statement on Thursday. With his special operations background and doubling as commander of NATO’s land forces in Europe, Donahue is well respected among military and political leaders in Europe and has played a key role in alliance coordination. Insiders had seen Donahue at risk of a dismissal for some time after differences with US Secretary of Defense Pete Hegseth. REUTERS

POLAND

#### 2 injured after two passenger trains collide

TWO PASSENGER trains collided near the village of Bialoslwie in west-central Poland, a fire brigade spokesperson said on Thursday. The website of TVP Poznan reported that two people were injured in the incident. “There was an accident involving a train travelling from Kolobrzeg to Warsaw East station, and one from Pila to Bydgoszcz,” fire brigade spokesperson Pawel Rykowski said. “The incident occurred around 6:04 PM. I know there were about 200 people on the trains,” he added. Reuters

• PLASTIC SURGERY CLINICS, UPSCALE RESTAURANTS AND BOUTIQUE FITNESS STUDIOS HAVE SPRUNG UP TO SERVE TECH WORKERS FLUSH WITH A.I. RICHES

## From rice fields to silicon riches: How Hsinchu became heart of Taiwan’s chip boom

Amy Chang Chien & Meaghan Tobin

Hsinchu (Taiwan), June 25

LO REMEMBERS when the most coveted real estate in Taiwan was farmland.

When she moved to the area 16 years ago, there were no department stores, office parks or fine-dining restaurants. “It was very desolate,” she said.

Today, nothing could be further from the truth. The rice fields have given way to Hsinchu, home to Taiwan Semiconductor Manufacturing Co. and ground zero for an industry

driving the global economy: the production of the advanced computer chips powering the artificial intelligence boom.

As Taiwan’s semiconductor industry took off, TSMC made chips that drive virtually every kind of electronic device. That includes the sought-after AI accelerators designed by Nvidia, the world’s most valuable company. Farmers were gradually priced out of the area by factories, offices and luxury high-rises. The high-speed rail linking Taiwan’s largest cities now carries 80 million people a year through Lo’s backyard.

In northern Hsinchu, an area known as Zhubei, real estate prices have skyrocketed as buyers compete for spots on yearlong waiting lists for new apartments near Hsinchu Science Park, where TSMC has headquarters. Plastic surgery clinics, upscale restaurants and boutique fitness studios have sprung up to serve tech workers flush with AI riches.

Over the past six years, households near Hsinchu Science Park have reported some of the highest incomes in Taiwan. In one neighbourhood, average household incomes ex-



The Big City mall is a temple catering to Hsinchu’s nouveau riche, with a Tesla showroom on the first floor. NYT

ceeded \$146,000 in 2023, about five times Taiwan’s average.

The prosperity has given rise to the so-called Zhuke Mama: a woman whose husband works in the lucrative semiconductor industry, allowing her time for pursuits like going to Pilates classes, shopping for vacation homes in Thailand and managing their children’s academic advancement.

While the rest of Taiwan and much of East Asia are grappling with a sharp population decline, so many children have been born in Hsinchu in recent years that the schools cannot

keep up. Public high schools in the area now admit only students with sufficiently high test scores, a practice that Lo and a group of mothers have protested. Those who do not make the cut must commute to another school district.

“The population exploded,” Lo said. “It became very competitive.”

Today, Hsinchu is home to more than 1 million people, and those without ties to the technology industry have largely been priced out. The wealth generated by semiconductors has not translated to wage gains

in other industries.

The local shopping mall, Big City, now ranks among Taiwan’s top-performing retail centers.

During its big sale in December, it generated more than \$100 million in just 12 days, a 6% increase from the year before, according to Alex Ro, a general manager.

The mall is a temple catering to Hsinchu’s nouveau riche, with a Tesla showroom on the first floor, feet away from an Apple Store. At Brooks Brothers, some suits cost nearly \$1,500 — more than the monthly salary of most retail workers. NYT





**MAHARASHTRA METRO RAIL CORPORATION LTD.**  
(A joint venture of Govt. of India & Govt. of Maharashtra)  
**PUNE METRO RAIL PROJECT- PHASE 2**  
Metro Bhavan, Above District Court Metro Station, Nyayamurti  
Ranade Path, Shivaji Nagar, Pune-411005. Tel. : 020-26051074  
E-mail: tenders.pnmp@mahametro.org | www.punemetrorail.org

**Tender Notice No: P2-C03/2026 (ICB)**

**Date: 26/06/26**

**Name of Work:** Design & Construction of Elevated Metro Viaduct with structural work of Elevated Stations a) from Dandekar Pul (excluding) to Khadakwasla: Eight Elevated Stations plus Viaduct Length 9.675 Km as part of Line-4 and b) SNDT College to Manik Baug: Six Elevated Stations plus Viaduct Length 7.247 Km of Line 4A of Pune Metro Rail Project (Phase-2).

Sale of the document, e-Payment procedure, submission, and other details are available on the e-tender portal of Govt. of Maharashtra i.e. <https://mahatenders.gov.in> from 16.00 hrs. On 10/07/2026 to 11.00 Hrs. on 24/08/2026.

**Tender Notice No: P1-O&M-22/2026**

**Date: 26/06/26**

**Name of Work:** Annual Civil Maintenance of 28 Nos of Elevated & Underground Stations, 28.079 Kms of elevated Viaduct including steel bridges, 12.15 kms of Tunnel and 2 Depots of Pune Metro Project for a period of One Year.

Sale of the document, e-Payment procedure, submission, and other details are available on the e-tender portal of Govt. of Maharashtra i.e. <https://mahatenders.gov.in> from 16.00 hrs. On 26/06/2026 to 16.00 Hrs. on 06/07/2026.

To view above tender notice (NIT), interested bidder may visit the Maha-Metro website [www.punemetrorail.org](http://www.punemetrorail.org) or <https://procure.gov.in>

Additional GM / Procurement & Contracts,  
Maha-Metro, PMRP

**Pune Metro : City's Transport Solution**



**OFFICE OF THE PURCHASE COMMITTEE/RCC FOR GOVERNMENT DENTAL COLLEGE & HOSPITAL**  
Shireen Bagh, Srinagar, Kashmir.  
Phone No.:0194-2504705 | Website: [www.gdc.srinagar.org](http://www.gdc.srinagar.org)  
e-mail: [gdc.srinagar@jk.gov.in](mailto:gdc.srinagar@jk.gov.in)

e-NIT NO. 01 OF 2026-27

DATED:- 09.06.2026

TENDER OFFER NOTICE

Subject: Notice inviting online tenders for supply of Print version of Dental Journals/Periodicals (Both National and International) for the calendar year 2026.

For and on behalf of the competent authority of the Union Territory of Jammu and Kashmir, the Chairman, Purchase Committee, Govt. Dental College & Hospital, Srinagar invites online tenders (in two cover system: Technical Bid and Financial Bid) from Registered Distributors/Suppliers/Firms at National Level for supply of Print version of Dental Science Journals/Periodicals (Both National and International) for the calendar year 2026 as per following details and as per the Annexures enclosed/attached with this Tender Notice break-up of which is given herunder:

|              |                                                                                                                                                                           |
|--------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Annexure "A" | General Terms and Conditions for supply of Print version of Dental Science Journals/Periodicals (Both National and International) for the calendar year 2026 (Two Leaves) |
| Annexure "B" | Consolidated list of all seventy-nine (79) Dental Science Journals/Periodicals (Both National and International) to be procured for the calendar year 2026 (Three Leaves) |
| Annexure "C" | Special Terms and Conditions for supply of Print version of Dental Science Journals/Periodicals (Both National and International) for the calendar year 2026 (One Leaf)   |
| Annexure "D" | FORMAT OF BID SECURITY DECLARATION FROM BIDDERS IN LIEU OF EARNEST MONEY DEPOSIT (One Leaf)                                                                               |
| Annexure "E" | Format of Bid Submission Letter (Declaration Form) (One Leaf)                                                                                                             |

| Event                                                                                                                         | Date                    |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------|
| Date of publishing/uploading of Tender Notice on the e-tendering website                                                      | 10.06.2026 (1000 hours) |
| Start date of Downloading of tender documents from the e-tendering website                                                    | 10.06.2026 (1200 hours) |
| Start date for uploading of online tenders (both Technical and Financial Bids) in the electronic format on e-tendering portal | 15.06.2026 (1000 hours) |
| Last date for uploading of online tenders (both Technical and Financial Bids) in the electronic format on e-tendering portal  | 30.06.2026 (1600 hours) |

Last date for submission of hard copies of all pre-requisite documents (including Demand Draft and Bid Security/Declaration Form in original) in sealed envelope: 06.07.2026 (1100 hours) or any other date convenient to the bid opening authority in Conference Hall, Govt. Dental College & Hospital, Srinagar.

Tentative date of opening of uploaded bids (technical bids only): 06.07.2026 (1100 hours) or any other date convenient to the bid opening authority in Conference Hall, Govt. Dental College & Hospital, Srinagar.

e-Tendering website: <https://www.jktenders.gov.in>  
Any clarification/representation will be entertained from 10.06.2026 (from 02.00 P.M. onwards) to 13.06.2026 on all working days during office hours as well as via e-mail @ [gdc.srinagar@jk.gov.in](mailto:gdc.srinagar@jk.gov.in).  
(No representation will be entertained beyond the stipulated period.

| S. No. | Item                                 | Particulars                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
|--------|--------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 01.    | Tender Reference                     | e-NIT No.01 of 2026-27 Dated: 09.06.2026.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |
| 02.    | Tender Fee (Non-Refundable)          | 1,000/-<br>(In shape of Demand Draft)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
| 03.    | Bid Security/ Earnest Money Deposit: | Bid Security/Earnest Money Deposit (EMD), in shape of CDR/FDR/DR for 1,00,000/- (Rupees One Lac only) pledged to Accounts Officer, Govt. Dental College & Hospital, Srinagar. However, MSME bidders having registration certificates or are registered with Central Purchase Organisation or concerned Ministry or the Departments, are exempted from submission of Bid Security but they shall have to submit Bid Security Declaration Form (as per Para 79 of GFR 2017) enclosed in Annexure "D" on the company letter head duly sealed and signed by the participating Bidder/Tender. |

I. Cover I"-Technical Cover:  
No tender/bid will be entertained/accepted without fulfilling (uploading on the website <https://www.jktenders.gov.in>) the below mentioned requisite formalities (documents) which will be scrutinized by the financial/technical expert as well as concerned from Library Committee:

- Self attested with seal copy of original instrument with regard to Tender Fee for 1,000/- in shape of Demand Draft favoring Accounts Officer, Govt. Dental College & Hospital, Srinagar.
- Bid Security/Earnest Money Deposit in shape of CDR/FDR/DR for 21,00,000/- (Rupees One Lac only) pledged to Accounts Officer, Govt. Dental College & Hospital, Srinagar or Bid Security Declaration Form on the company letter head as per Annexure "D", duly sealed and signed (as the case may be).
- Undertaking (affidavit) duly attested by the Judicial/Eclectic Magistrate to the effect that:
  - The distributor/supplier/firm has not been blacklisted or barred from participating in the tendering process by any Government/ Semi Government Department or any private concern's and there is no vigilance/any other investigating agency, court proceeding/s pending against it.
  - The distributor/supplier/firm has not quoted the rates higher than that quoted to other Government/Semi Government Department or any private concern, for same nature/kind of products/supplies.
  - The documents etc. enclosed with the tender are original and genuine and have not been tampered with or fabricated.
- Declaration Form (Bid Submission Letter) as per Annexure "E", on the company letter head duly sealed and signed.
- Self attested with seal copy of GSTIN Registration Certificate.
- Self attested with seal copy with stamp of latest GST Return issued by the concerned authority.
- Self attested with seal copy of Income Tax Return for the latest assessment year (2026-27) issued by the Income Tax Department.
- Self attested with seal copy of the PAN Card issued in the name of the firm/supplier or its proprietor duly linked with Aadhar Card.
- Self attested with seal copy of latest CA certification (financial year 2025-26) of the firm.
- Self attested with seal copy of Importer-Exporter Code (IEC) certificate issued in the name of the bidder/firm/supplier by the Directorate General of Foreign Trade (under Ministry of Commerce and Industry, Govt. of India).
- Prospective bidders have to mandatorily quote rates for all seventy-nine (79) tendered journal titles as specified in the tender document (BOQ) and certificate in lieu to be submitted (recorded) by the bidder/firm on this company letter head (Point No. 3 of Annexure "E"). Any deviation in this regard may result in rejection of the bid and the bidder shall be solely responsible for the same.
- The bidder/firm shall submit the complete documentary proof of having successfully supplied the quoted/alotted items to at least five (05) Government Medical/Dental Colleges within the Country, that shall include at least one (01) Government Medical Dental College in the UT of Jammu of Kashmir. The bidder/firm shall also provide supply completion certificate/ satisfactory report/ no objection certificate issued by the same Institutions, theory with its complete official contact details. The submission, Purchase Orders and supporting certificates must be authentic, verifiable and pertaining to the same or similar items).

**Important Note:**  
➤ Every prospective/participating bidder is required to upload the scanned copy of all requisite documents as mentioned above under serial No. (i) to (xii), on the official website-procurement portal ([www.jktenders.gov.in](http://www.jktenders.gov.in)) within given time period. Non-availability/ shortage of any requisite document on the official website-procurement portal will lead to rejection of the bid and the bidder shall be solely responsible for the same.  
➤ Additionally, the prospective/participating bidders are mandatorily required to submit the self attested hard copy of requisite documents as mentioned under serial No. (v) to (xii) along with original copy of the following documents in the office of undersigned under proper checklist/covering letter and in sealed envelope by or before 02.07.2026 till 1200 hours.  
The Purchase Committee/RCC shall not be held responsible for any delay in this regard due to any reason whatsoever:

- Demand Draft for Rs. 1,000/- [as mentioned at serial No.(i)]
- CDR/FDR/DR for 1,00,000/- or Bid Declaration Form [as mentioned at serial No.(ii)]
- Undertaking (affidavit) duly attested by Judicial/Eclectic Magistrate [as mentioned at serial No.(iii)]
- Declaration Form (Bid Submission Letter) [as mentioned at serial No.(iv)]

- Things to remember:**
- Bidders/tenders/suppliers are advised to go through the terms & conditions of the e-NIT thoroughly and upload/submit only relevant documents as required (asked for) under Cover-I" Technical Cover. No irrelevant or irrelevant document shall be uploaded/submitted as the same may create confusion.
  - Each page of e-Bid and relevant documents should be properly page marked and indexed. Page Number should be reflected at the bottom of each page.
  - Bidders/Firms/Suppliers which are registered as (Micro, Small and Medium Enterprises) MSME units, as defined in MSME Procurement Policy issued by Department of Micro, Small and Medium Enterprises (MSME) shall be considered for Exemption of bid security/EMD as per provisions of MSME Policy. The Bidders/Firms/Suppliers seeking bid security/EMD exemption must upload/submitt the valid supporting document for the relevant category.
  - Except Bid Security/Earnest Money Deposit (in shape of CDR) and Tender Fee (in shape of Demand Draft), all documents/communications shall be addressed to Principal/Dens (Chairman Purchase Committee/RCC), Government Dental College & Hospital, Srinagar.

- 2. Cover 2nd-Financial Cover:**
- Tendering/bidding process will be completely online (no price bid shall be submitted in physical form). Rates submitted in physical form will not be entertained/considered at any cost.
  - Financial bids (in electronic format only) will be opened only after evaluation of technical bids. Rates quoted (offered) by the bidder in Indian Rupees (INR ₹) should be F.O.R. to Govt. Dental College Srinagar and should include GST/Taxes, Freight Charges (Loading/Unloading and Stacking), whatsoever applicable.
  - Tender shall be submitted by the bidders strictly in and as per BOQ.
  - Bidders/tenders are required not to create additional BOQ of their own.

**Notes:-**  
➤ This tender offer notice is also available on the departmental/college website <https://www.gdc.srinagar.org> Sd/-

Asstt. Accounts Officer, (Member Secretary,  
Purchase Committee/RCC),  
Govt. Dental College & Hospital, Srinagar.

No: GDCAH/SR/PC/RCC/MS/4576-84  
Dated: 09.06.2026

DIP No: DIPK-2523/26 Dated: 25.06.2026



**BENGALURU NORTH CITY CORPORATION**  
Office of the Executive Engineer, Yelahanka division,  
Bangalore - 560064.

No: BNCC/EE/YNK.D/KPPP/07/2026-27

Dated: 25.06.2026

INVITATION FOR TENDERS (IFT)

(Two Cover system) (Short term- Tender Notification)

(Through GOK KPP Portal <https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in> only)

The Executive Engineer Yelahanka Division BNCC invites tenders from eligible Tenderers for the works detailed in the table below.

| Sl. No. | Name of Work                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
|---------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1.      | Improvements to Roads, drains and Footpaths in various Layouts falling under ward No-01,02 & 03 of Yelahanka Division. (PACKAGE NO-01). <b>Tender Put Amount: Rs. 1078.60 Lakhs, EMD Amount: Rs. 10,78,600.00</b>                                                                              |
| 2.      | Improvements and Asphalling to roads at Judicial layout, Chikkabommasandra, GKVK layout and other surrounding areas in Nyayang Badavane Ward No-04 of Yelahanka Division. (PACKAGE NO -02). <b>Tender Put Amount: Rs. 1078.60 Lakhs, EMD Amount: Rs. 10,78,600.00</b>                          |
| 3.      | Improvements and Asphalling to roads at Sharada nagara, Mathru layout, 208 & 707 SFS, Yelahanka A & B Sector in Yelahanka satellite town ward No-05 of Yelahanka Division. (PACKAGE NO-03). <b>Tender Put Amount: Rs. 796.15 Lakhs, EMD Amount: Rs. 11,94,225.00</b>                           |
| 4.      | Improvements and Asphalling to roads at DEO Marvel, Prakruthi layout, Nisarga layout, Chitra layout, Muneshwara layout and surrounding areas of Doddabettahalli ward no-06 of Yelahanka Division. (PACKAGE NO-04). <b>Tender Put Amount: Rs. 957.50 Lakhs, EMD Amount: Rs. 14,36,250.00</b>    |
| 5.      | Improvements and Asphalling to roads at Ryalis layout, CQAL Layout, Swagath layout, ENRICH Mid city, Hayyaka badavane, BHEL layout and surrounding areas of Altur ward No-07 of Yelahanka Division. (PACKAGE NO -05). <b>Tender Put Amount: Rs. 796.15 Lakhs, EMD Amount: Rs. 11,94,225.00</b> |

Calendar of Events : (1) Date of Pre-bid Meeting : 01.07.2026 at 15.00 hrs (2) Last Date & Time for receipt of tenders : 08.07.2026 at 16.00 hrs (3) Date & Time of Opening of Technical bid : 09.07.2026 after 16:00 hrs.

Sd/- Executive Engineer, Yelahanka Division, BNCC

E-auction Date: 28.08.2026  
FORM NO. 22 [See regulation 36(1)]  
REGD. A/D, DASTI AFFIXATION, BEAT OF DRUM  
SALE PROCLAMATION  
OFFICE OF THE RECOVERY OFFICER  
IN THE DEBTS RECOVERY TRIBUNAL- DEHRADUN AT 2ND FLOOR, PARAS TOWER, MAZRA, SAHARANPUR ROAD, DEHRADUN, UK. 248171  
R.C. No. 90/2017 Dated: 02.06.2026

PROCLAMATION OF SALE NOTICE UNDER THE RECOVERY OF DEBTS AND BANKRUPTCY ACT, 1993  
Canara Bank Vs M/s Raj Packers & Ors.

To,  
**CD.1:** M/s Raj Packers, a Partnership Concern, at Nand Colony, Poetal Nagari, Moradabad, U.P. through its Partners.  
**CD.2:** Bhog Raj Singh S/o Sh. Ram Swaroop, Partner M/s Raj Packers, R/o Bhoodey Ka Chauraha, Balmiki Basti, Moradabad, U.P., 244001.  
**CD.3:** Smt. Babita Devi W/o Sh. Desh Raj Singh, Partner M/s Raj Packers, R/o Ward No. 44, Chau Ki Basti, Line Paar, Moradabad, U.P., 244001.  
**CD.4:** Desh Raj Singh S/o Sh. Bahori Singh, R/o Ward No. 44, Chau Ki Basti, Line Paar, Moradabad, U.P., 244001.

Whereas a sum of Rs 31,13,292.30/- (Rupees Thirty One Lakhs Thirteen Thousand Two Hundred Ninety Two and Paise Thirty Only) along with pendent-lite and future interest @ 12.00% per annum simple rate on reducing balance w.e.f 27.07.2017 till realization with costs of Rs 77,000/- in respect of Recovery Certificate in O.A. Case No. 135 of 2017 issued by the Presiding Officer, Debts Recovery Tribunal, Dehradun in present matter is awarded against CDs.

Whereas the outstanding dues as on 24.04.2026 in the present RC stands Rs. 64,01,162.85/-

And whereas the undersigned has ordered the sale of property mentioned in the Schedule below in satisfaction of the said certificate.

Notice is hereby given that in absence of any order of postponement, the said property shall be sold on 28.08.2026 between 11:00 A.M to 12:00 P.M (with extension of 5 minutes duration after 12:00 Noon, if required) by e-auction and bidding shall take place through "Online Electronic Bidding" through the website <https://dr.t.auctiontiger.net> of M/s E-procurement technologies ltd.

For further detail contact: Office of the Recovery Officer, Debts Recovery Tribunal, Dehradun Contact No: 0135-2974077 and for property inspection Contact Mr Durgesh Dwivedi, Senior Manager, Canara Bank (Mob No. - 7972690456).

The sale will be of the property of the defendant above named as mentioned in the schedule below and the liabilities and claims attaching to the said property, so far as they have been ascertained, are those specified in the schedule against each lot.

The particulars specified in the annexed schedule have been stated to the best of the information of the undersigned, but the undersigned shall not be answerable for any error, mis-statement or omission in this proclamation.

- The reserve price below which the property shall not be sold is Rs. 30,00,000/-.
- The amount by which the biddings are to be increased shall be Rs. 1,00,000/- In the event of any dispute arising as to the amount of bid, or as to the bidder, the lot shall at once be again put up to auction.
- The highest bidder shall be declared to be the purchaser of any lot provided that further that the amount bid by him is not less than the reserve price. It shall be in the discretion of the undersigned to decline/acceptance of the highest bid when the price offered appears so clearly inadequate as to make it inadvisable to do so.
- EMD of Rs. 3,00,000 shall be deposited positively by 24.08.2026 by way of DD in favour of Recovery Officer, DRT Dehradun to be deposited with Recovery Officer, DRT Dehradun and details of the property along with copy of PAN card, Address proof and identity proof, E-mail ID, Mobile No. and in case of the company or any other document confirming representation/attorney of the company and the receipt/counter file of such deposit in physical mode shall be submitted before the undersigned. EMD and Requisite documents as mentioned deposited after last date of EMD shall not be considered for participation in the e-auction.
- The successful bidder shall have to pay 25% of the sale proceeds after adjustment of EMD on being knocked down by next date i.e 29.08.2026 by 3:00 P.M. In the said Account No: 7360878086, Account Name: Recovery Officer, Debts Recovery Tribunal Dehradun having IFSC Code No. IDIB000D557 or by way of Demand Draft in favour of Recovery Officer, DRT Dehradun to be deposited with Recovery Officer, DRT Dehradun. If the next day is Holiday or Sunday, then on next first office day.
- The purchaser shall deposit the balance 75% of the sale proceeds on or before 15th day from the date of sale of the property, exclusive of such day, or if the 15th day be Sunday or other Holiday, then on the first office day after the 15th day by prescribed mode through RTGS/NEFT/ directly in to the Account No: 7360878086, Account Name: Recovery Officer, Debts Recovery Tribunal Dehradun having IFSC Code No. IDIB000D557 or by way of Demand Draft in favour of Recovery Officer, DRT Dehradun to be deposited with Recovery Officer, DRT Dehradun. In addition to the above the purchaser shall also deposit Poundage fee with Recovery Officer, DRT Dehradun @ 2% upto Rs.1,000/- and @1% of the excess of the said amount of Rs.1,000/- through DD in favour of Registrar, DRT Dehradun.

In case of default of payment within the prescribed period, the deposit, after defraying the expenses of the sale, may, if the undersigned thinks fit, shall be forfeited to the Government and the defaulting purchaser shall forfeit all claims to the property or to any part of the sum for which it may subsequently be sold. The property shall be resold, after the issue of fresh proclamation of sale.

The property is being sold on "AS IS WHERE IS BASIS".  
The sale attracts Stamp Duty, Registration Charges, etc as per relevant laws. All expenses and incidental charges thereto shall be borne by the auction purchaser. The undersigned reserves the right to accept or reject any or all bids if found unreasonable or postpone the auction at any time without assigning any reason.

| Lot No.                                          | Description of property to be sold with the names of the other co-owner where the property belongs to the defaulter and any other person as co-owner.                                                                                                                                                                                                               | Revenue assessed upon the property or any part thereof | Details of any other encumbrance to which property is liable | Claims, if any, which have been put forward to the property, and any other known particulars bearing on its nature and value. |
|--------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1                                                | 3 storied residential building measuring 140.52 sq.mtr. constructed on land of Kh. no. 522, 523, 524, 527, 528, 529, 530 & 531 Ka Min-Jura Mauja- Manpur Narayanpur, Linepar, Thana-Majhola, Pargana & Distt.-Moradabad.<br>Boundaries:- East: Plot of Shri Gajraj Singh Saini, West: 10' wide road, North: Plot of Smt. Ram Ruti, South: Plot of Smt. Nirmala Devi | Not Known                                              | Not Known                                                    | Not Known                                                                                                                     |
| Given under my hand and seal on this 02.06.2026. |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |                                                        |                                                              | Recovery Officer<br>DRT, Dehradun                                                                                             |



**JAIPUR VIDYUT VITRAN NIGAM LIMITED**  
OFFICE OF THE SUPERINTENDING ENGINEER (MM-I)  
MM Building, Old Power House Premises, Near Ram Mandir, Banipark, Jaipur-302006  
Tel. 0141-220898, E-Mail id:- semn@jvnl.org Website: [www.energyrajasthan.gov.in/jvnl](http://www.energyrajasthan.gov.in/jvnl)

NOTICE INVITING BID

E-tender is invited for purchase of Rewinding Machine a) Supply and commissioning of Light Duty Rewinding Machine b) Supply and commissioning of Extra Heavy Duty Rewinding Machine with caterpillar arrangement (TN-5086) (UBN-VVN2627GLOB0206). All the details regarding tenders are available at web site <http://energy.rajasthan.gov.in/jvnl> and [www.eproc.rajasthan.gov.in](http://www.eproc.rajasthan.gov.in).

Raj,Samwad/C/26/5680 JPR-3179 (2026) SUPERINTENDING ENGINEER (MM-I)  
For Electricity Complaints Toll Free No. 1800 180 6507

**NORTHERN RAILWAY**  
E-TENDER NOTICE

Sr. Divisional Electrical Engineer/Traction Distribution, DRM's Office, State Entry Road, New Delhi for & on behalf of President of India, invites open e-tender for the undernoted work:-

|   |                                                                            |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
|---|----------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1 | Name of Work with its location                                             | Part-B: Replacement of existing 105 sq. mm. G-Jumper by 160 sq. mm. Jumper in DUK section in connection with Augmentation of TRD assets by replacing overaged section insulators, low-rating insulators, and rusty cantilevers, alongwith upgradation jumper. |
| 2 | Approx. Cost of work                                                       | Rs. 2,65,90,268.20/-                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
| 3 | Earnest Money Deposit                                                      | Rs. 5,31,800/-                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |
| 4 | E-Tender Bid Online Submission Period                                      | 11.07.2026 (00:00 Hrs.) to 25.07.2026 (13:00 Hrs.)                                                                                                                                                                                                            |
| 5 | E-Tender Bid Submission End Date & E-Tender Open Date & Time               | 25.07.2026 (13:00 hrs.)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
| 6 | Fund Allocation                                                            | RRSK (PH-36)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
| 7 | Website particulars where complete details of tender documents can be seen | <a href="http://www.irops.gov.in">www.irops.gov.in</a>                                                                                                                                                                                                        |

E-Tender No.: 15-TRD-NDLS-2026-27 Dated: 25.06.2026 2207/2026

**SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE**

**NORTHERN RAILWAY**  
E-TENDER NOTICE

Sr. Divisional Electrical Engineer/Traction Distribution, DRM's Office, State Entry Road, New Delhi for & on behalf of President of India, invites open e-tender for the undernoted work:-

|   |                                                                            |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
|---|----------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1 | Name of Work with its location                                             | Part-B: Provision of separate circuit breakers for sidings and branch lines in DUK section in connection with improvement of sectioning and feeding arrangement by shifting of insulated overlaps, Provision of separate CB and re-profiling of masts at curve loc. |
| 2 | Approx. Cost of work                                                       | Rs. 5,16,48,422.76/-                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |
| 3 | Earnest Money Deposit                                                      | Rs. 10,33,000/-                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
| 4 | E-Tender Bid Online Submission Period                                      | 06.07.2026 (00:00 Hrs.) to 20.07.2026 (15:00 Hrs.)                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
| 5 | E-Tender Bid Submission End Date & E-Tender Open Date & Time               | 20.07.2026 (15:00 hrs.)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |
| 6 | Fund Allocation                                                            | RRSK (PH-36)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
| 7 | Website particulars where complete details of tender documents can be seen | <a href="http://www.irops.gov.in">www.irops.gov.in</a>                                                                                                                                                                                                              |

E-Tender No.: 12-TRD-NDLS-2026-27 Dated: 25.06.2026 2199/2026

**SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE**

**राजस्थान घरेलू प्राधिकरण**  
भुल्ल पर्यटन सभाग, सहायक (विद्युतवितरण) कार्यालय (सहायक), जयपुर-302001  
Tel:-0141-2615648/40 Email: [rhppa.jaipur@gmail.com](mailto:rhppa.jaipur@gmail.com)

ई-निविदा सूचना संख्या 19/2026-27

निम्नलिखित कार्यो के लिए केन्द्र / राज्य सरकार के अभियांत्रिकी विभागों द्वारा पंजीकृत एवं अनुमोदी संवेदको से निर्धारित प्रपत्र में ई-टेंडरिंग प्रक्रिया हेतु ऑनलाइन निविदाएं आमंत्रित की जा रही है।

| क्र. सं. | कार्य का विवरण                                                                                            | अनुमानित लागत (₹.) | कार्य पूर्ण करने की अवधि |
|----------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------|--------------------------|
| 1        | Construction of Pithiviraj Chauhan Panorama, Ajmer (Raj.) UBN is: HPP2627WSOB00035                        | 366.97 Lakh        | 15 Months                |
| 2        | Renovation and Development work at Ajaypal Mandir Bhairav Ghati Ajmer (Raj.) UBN is: HPP2627WSOB00036     | 344.49 Lakh        | 12 Months                |
| 3        | Construction of Bagdawat Swaibhoj Panorama Asind, Bhiwara (Raj.) UBN is: HPP2627WSOB00037                 | 302.27 Lakh        | 15 Months                |
| 4        | Construction of Jashnathji Panorama at Katriyasar Dist. Bikaner (Raj.) UBN is: HPP2627WSOB00038           | 290.88 Lakh        | 15 Months                |
| 5        | Construction of Raja Khemkaran Panorama Dist. Bharatpur (Raj.) UBN is: HPP2627WSOB00039                   | 285.47 Lakh        | 15 Months                |
| 6        | Construction of Tejaji Maharaj Panorama, Sursara Dist. Ajmer (Raj.) UBN is: HPP2627WSOB00040              | 282.63 Lakh        | 15 Months                |
| 7        | Construction of Veer Shiromani Kallaji Rathore Panorama Dist. Salumber (Raj.) UBN is: HPP2627WSOB00041    | 280.20 Lakh        | 15 Months                |
| 8        | Construction of Raiwasa Dham Dist. Sikar (Raj.) UBN is: HPP2627WSOB00042                                  | 279.13 Lakh        | 15 Months                |
| 9        | Development Work of Gathering Area for Statue at Baneshwar Dham, Dist. Dungarpur UBN is: HPP2627WSOB00043 | 143.18 Lakh        | 9 Months                 |

निविदा से संबंधित समस्त विवरण वेबसाइट <http://eproc.rajasthan.gov.in> एवं <http://sppp.raj.nic.in> पर देखा जा सकता है। इच्छुक निविदादाताओं को अपने डिजिटल हस्ताक्षर के माध्यम से वेबसाइट <http://eproc.rajasthan.gov.in> पर रजिस्टर करवाना आवश्यक है।

कम खर्च/दि/26/5708 मुख्य कार्यकारी अधिकारी



**AXIS FINANCE LIMITED**  
CIN: U65921MH1995PL1221079  
Axis House, C-2, Wadia International Centre, Parkside Baktar  
Mumbai, Mumbai - 400 025

Under Section 13 (2) of the Securitisation and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 ("Act") read with Rule 3 of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002 ("Rules").  
Whereas the undersigned being the Authorized Officer of Axis Finance Limited (AFL) under the Act and in exercise of powers conferred under Section 13 (12) read with Rule 3 of the Rules already issued detailed Demand Notice dated below under Section 13(2) of the Act, calling upon the Borrower(s)/Co-Borrower(s)/Guarantor(s) (all collectively or together referred to as "Obligors"/Legal Representative(s)) listed hereunder, to pay the amount mentioned in the respective Demand Notice, within 60 days from the date of the respective Notice, as per details given below. Copies of the said Notices are served by Registered Post A.D. and are available with the undersigned, and the said Obligor(s)/Legal Heir(s)/Legal Representative(s), may, if they so desire, collect the respective copy from the undersigned on any working day during normal office hours.  
In connection with the above, Notice is hereby given, once again, to the said Obligor(s) /Legal Heir(s)/Legal Representative(s) to pay to AFL, within 60 days from the date of the respective Notice(s), the amount indicated herein below against their respective names, together with further interest as detailed below from the respective dates mentioned below in column (d) till the date of payment and / or realization, read with the loan agreement and other documents/ said Obligor(s)/Legal Heir(s)/Legal Representative(s) as to the costs and consequences.  
The said Obligor(s) respectively.

| Sr. No | Loan Account No.                   | Name of Obligor(s)/ Legal Heir(s)/ Legal Representative(s)  | DETAILS OF SECURED ASSET                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | Total Outstanding Dues (Rs.) as on below date'                                                                                        | Date of Demand Notice | Date of NPA |
|--------|------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------|-------------|
| 1.     | 0456MMA00005592                    | PRAVEN GOEL, GOEL TELECOM & MEENA GOEL                      | COMMERCIAL SPACE/UNIT BEARING NO.007, ADMEASURING SUPER AREA OF 51.91 SQ. MTRS (558.76 SQ.FT.),SITUATED ON THE GROUND FLOOR OF CONVENIENCE SHOPPING COMPLEX IN THE GROUP HOUSING COLONY KNOWN AS M3M MERLIN, SITUATED IN THE REVENUE ESTATE OF VILLAGE BADSHAHPUR AT SECTOR-67, TEHSIL, BILASPUR DISTRICT, HARYANA, INDIA ALONGWITH PROPORTIONATE UNDIVIDED, IMPARTABLE SHARES AND INTEREST IN THE LAND ALONGWITH OTHER CO-OWNER                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | INR 81.03,405/- (Rupees Eighty One Lakh Three Thousand Four Hundred And Five Only) due as on 04 June, 2026                            | 17.06.2026            | 03.06.2026  |
| 2.     | 0456AHA00003256                    | MD RASHID, INSHIA MEDIA, SHAHANA                            | ALL THAT PIECE AND PARCEL OF PROPERTY NO. 44513, OUT OF KHASRA NO. 352, VILLAGE MOUJPAR ABADI OF MAIN ROAD, VIJAY PARK MOUJPAR ILLAQA- SHAHDARA, NORTH EAST DELHI- 110053 ADMEASURING 900 SQ. FT.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | INR 1,68,74,627/- (Rupees One Crore Sixty Eight Lakh Seventy Four Thousand Six Hundred And Twenty Seven Only) due as on 04 June, 2026 | 17.06.2026            | 03.06.2026  |
| 3.     | 0456MMA00011180                    | RD DRESSES, SANJAY JAIN, MEENU JAIN & HIMANSHU JAIN         | THIRD FLOOR WITH ROOF RIGHTS, LAND AREA MEASURING 80 SQ. YDS. I.E. 66.88 SQ. MTRS. HAVING ITS PLINTH/COVERED AREA MEASURING 66.88 SQ. MTRS., ALONGWITH ITS WHOLE OF STRUCTURE ACCORDING TO THE SITE THEREIN, CONSISTING OF ONE HALL THEREIN, FITTED WITH ELECTRICITY & WATER SUPPLY CONNECTIONS WITH THEIR SEPARATE METERS, COMMON ENTRANCE, PASSAGE & STAIRCASE, WITH THE RIGHTS TO INSTALL/MAINTAIN THE WATER TANK & T.V. ANTENNA ON THE ROOF OF TOP FLOOR. A PART OF PROPERTY BEARING NO. 4138 (CONSTRUCTED ON OLD PLOT NO.15 & 16), OUT OF KHASRA NO.588/457/73/8, SITUATED IN THE ABADI OF GANESHI DAGG BUILDING, RAGHUBER PURA NO.1, GANDHI NAGAR, IN THE AREA OF VILLAGE SELAMPUR, ILLAQA SHAHDARA, DELHI-110031 | INR 7502634/- (Rupees Seventy Five Lakh Two Thousand Six Hundred And Thirty Four Only) due as on 04 June, 2026                        | 17.06.2026            | 03.06.2026  |
| 4.     | 0456AHA00006891<br>0456AHA00006888 | RAJNEESH KUMAR, A G MISSION SHIKSHAN SANSTHAN & SUNITA DEVI | THIRD FLOOR, WITH COMMON ROOF RIGHTS, BUILT ON PROPERTY NO. WZ-30 (OLD NO. 65), AREA MEASURING 100 SQ. YDS., OUT OF KHASRA NO. 219, 220, SITUATED IN THE AREA OF VILLAGE BASAI DARAPUR COLONY, PRESENTLY KNOWN AS MANOHAR PARK, EAST PUNJABI BAGH, NEW DELHI - 110026                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | INR 1,16,94,920/- (Rupees One Crore Sixteen Lakhs Ninety Four Thousand Nine Hundred and Twenty Only) due as on 04 June, 2026          | 17.06.2026            | 03.06.2026  |

\*with further interest, additional Interest at the rate as more particularly stated in respective Demand Notices dated mentioned above, incidental expenses, costs, charges etc incurred till the date of payment and/or realization. If the said Obligor(s) shall fail to make payment to AFL as aforesaid, then AFL shall proceed against the above Secured Asset(s)/Immovable Property (ies) under Section 1



## Classifieds

### PERSONAL

**I,YOGITA BALA RATTAN,D/O-**KULBHUSHAN GOSWAMI,W/O-RAM KRISHAN,R/O-H.No.3526/2,Narang-Colony,Tri-Nagar,Delhi-110035,HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO YOGITA BALA,for all,future purposes.

0040862652-3

**I,Rajesh Kumar Prasad S/o Sh.** Dhirender Prasad,R/o House No.70 D3 Railway-Colony Tuglakabad Badarpur South Delhi,Delhi-110044 have changed my minor daughter's name,from Ritika to Ritika Rai,for all purposes.

0040862663-9

**I,SAYYED FAZLE ALI S/o** Ibne Ali, Village Lala Nagla, Chamrauwa Rampur, Chamroa, UP-244901 have changed my name to FAZLEY ALI.

0071044121-1

**I,Tahir S/o-Mohd Qasim,R/o-c-77/2 Street No-9 North Ghonda** Delhi,has changed my name to Mohd Tahir,for all purpose.

0040862645-6

**I,Harinder S/o Chaliter R/o 39,** Surera, Delhi-110043 have changed my name to Harinder Kamthi.

0040862663-2

**I,N-15443248X, Rank-NK,** Name-AKHILESH KUMAR residing at VILL-BAMED, PO-SIMARRA-BHOUPUR, TEHSIL-BILSI, DIST-BUDAUN, UTTAR PRADESH-243633 I have changed my father name from RAMAUTAR SINGH to RAMAUTAR for all future purposes vide Affidavit dated 24/06/2026 before Notary Public Delhi.

0071044062-1

**I,AGNES MAMPI D., D/O-RAMESH DAS** and LEONIE REBA DAS(LEONIE REBA D.),R/O KH.NO.637/1,E-96,DEVLI APARTMENT,DEVLI ROAD,NEW DELHI-62,HAVE CORRECTED MY NAME AND SHALL BE HEREAFTER BE KNOWN AS AGNES MAMPI DAS.

0040862652-5

**I,Razia Begum W/o** Abdul Sattar R/o V-33, Gali No-27, V-block, Vijay Park, Maujpur, Bhajan Pura Delhi-110053 have changed my name to Raziya Begum Sworn Before Notary On 24/06/2026

0040862298-1

**I,SIMRANJEET KAUR W/o** Rashminder Singh, WZ-182, 3rd Floor, Gali No-10, Shiv Nagar, Janakpuri B-1, Delhi-58 have changed my name to SIMRANJIT KAUR CHADHA.

0071044125-1

**I,Harish Kumar,S/o-Shri Bacchi Ram,R/o-A-4/244, Sector-4,Rohini,** Delhi-110085,have changed my name to Harish Kumar Sharma,for future purposes.

0040862645-2

**I,Lokesh Sharma,** resident of 37-D, Balajipuram, Aurangabad Khadar, Mathura, Uttar Pradesh, declare that my son's name was wrongly recorded as Ashish Kumar Sharma in Army records. His correct name is Ashish Sharma. Both names refer to the same person.

0040862404-1

**I,Rakesh Kumar,S/o-Satyra Pal Manglani,R/o-74,Vigyan-Lok, Anand-Vihar,PO, Shakarpur, Dist.East-Delhi, Delhi-110092,** have changed my Name to Rakesh Kumar Munglani.

0040862652-7

**I,Lokesh Sharma,** resident of 37-D, Balajipuram, Aurangabad Khadar, Mathura, Uttar Pradesh, declare that my son's name was wrongly recorded as Ashish Kumar Sharma in Army records. His correct name is Ashish Sharma. Both names refer to the same person.

0040862404-1

**I,Ravinder Kr Gupta S/O, Ved** Prakash R/o House No 1302 Sector 17c, Gurgaon State Haryana have changed my name to Ravinder Kumar Gupta.

0040862608-1

**I,Mohammad Azhar Siddiqui,S/o-Mohammad Iqbal,R/o-499,Chatta Lal Mian Darya Ganj Delhi,has** changed my name to Mohd Azhar for all purpose.

0040862645-4

**I,SHIVAM DEV,S/o-Dev Shanker Sharma,R/o Flat No.1210A,Migsun-Ultimo Sun-3 Tower,Sector Omnicron-3,Gretar Noida,U.P.** have changed my name to SHIVAM DEV SHARMA.

0040862663-6

**I,VINEET TAYAL S/O** KAILASH CHAND TAYAL R/O A-139,2nd Floor,Gujrawala Town, Delhi-110009,have changed my name to VINEET KUMAR TAYAL.

0040862663-4

**I,Ayush Goel,S/o Puneet Goel,R/O-SG-6/402, Saya** Gold Avenue-Indirapuram, Ghaziabad, Uttar Pradesh-201014,I have to change my minor Son's name from Aarish Goel to Ayvukt Goel, Permanently.

0040862517-1

**I,SANGAM KUMARI W/O RITESH KUMAR R/O F-2033, WHITE HOUSE** APPARTMENT, PLOT No.08, SECTOR-P1 1 & 2, GREATER NOIDA, DISTRICT-GAUTAM BUDDHA NAGAR, UTTAR PRADESH. HAVE CHANGED MY NAME FROM SANGAM TO SANGAM KUMARI FOR ALL PURPOSES.

0071044055-1

**I,BANO W/O KHALEEL AHMAD, R/O-H-280/A,4TH FLOOR, FLAT-NO.402 JAITPUR EXTN PART-2,BADARPUR, DELHI-44,HAVE** CHANGED MY NAME TO VANON PERMANENTLY,FOR ALL, FUTURE PURPOSES

0040862652-1

**I,NIKHIT SABIA,D/O-MUNIR AHMED,R/O-K-39,SECOND FLOOR,NEAR MADEENA MASJID,ABUL-FAZAL ENCLAVE-1,JAMIA-NAGAR, OKHLA,SOUTH DELHI-110025,HAVE** CHANGED MY NAME NIKHIT SABIA TO NIKHAT SABIA,PERMANENTLY.

0040862652-2

**I,SANTOSH W/o** Krishan Kumar R/o-74, Kushak No.1,Kadi Pur Delhi-11003,have changed my minor daughter name LAHAR to LEHAR

0040862663-8

**I,Mohammad Aalam S/o** Abdul Qayoom R/o House No L-431 Sunder Nagri Delhi-110093 have changed my name to Mohammad Alam Ansari

0071044118-1

**I,Aslam Parveez S/o-**Ahsanuddin R/o-1235 GanjMir Khan Asaf Ali Road Delhi,has changed my name to Aslam Parvez for all purpose.

0040862645-5

**I,SHEKHER KRISHANA,S/O SHEKHER,R/O HOUSE NO-393,BLOCK-12, KALYANPURI, DELHI-110091,HAVE** CHANGED MY NAME,FOR ALL FUTURE PURPOSES TO KRISHANA S.

0040862663-1

**I,N-15443248X, Rank-NK,** Name-AKHILESH KUMAR residing at VILL-BAMED, PO-SIMARRA-BHOUPUR, TEHSIL-BILSI, DIST-BUDAUN, UTTAR PRADESH-243633 I have changed my father name from RAMAUTAR SINGH to RAMAUTAR for all future purposes vide Affidavit dated 24/06/2026 before Notary Public Delhi.

0071044061-1

**I,GARIMA,W/O-SUMIT SAXENA,R/O-11/95,GALI NO-7 EAST AZAD NAGAR-KRISHNA NAGAR,EAST DELHI-110051,Changed** my name to GARIMA SAXENA for all future purposes.

0040862652-4

**I,Rahima W/o** Amir Khan, R/o 321, Third Floor Flat No.302, Canal Road Okhla Village, Jamia Nagar, New Delhi-110025, have changed my name to Rahima Khan.

0071044134-1

**I,BINISH AHMED,D/O-ABRAR AHMED,R/O-4-T,DDA Flat, Sheesh Mahal,Ganj MirKhan, Delhi,declare** that my name,is wrongly written,as DINESH AHMED in my old-Passport No.H4447415. My correct name, is BINISH AHMED,for all purposes.

0040862645-1

**I,Subhash Chand,S/o-Inder Singh,R/O-E-90,Kondli,Delhi-110096,that** my minor-daughter Sاهر aged-8-years is the Holder of the LIC-Policy No.128243416, that her name and Date-of-Birth has been mentioned as Pragyasheel Gautam and-26/01/2019.The Actual-Name and Date-of-Birth of my minor-Daughter is Sاهر and-28/04/2018.

0040862659-1

**I,Nirmala W/o** Sh. Chander Mohan R/o H.No. B-43, Gulab Bagh, Nawada, Uttam Nagar, New Delhi-110059 is also known as Lakshmi Sejwal. Both names are of one and the same person.

0040862652-9

**I,LEONIE REBA D., D/O-AJIT AUGUSTINE DOLOY & SAVITA DOLOY,W/O-RAMESH CH DAS,R/O-E-96,KH.NO.637/1, DEVLI APARTMENT,DEVLI ROAD,NEW DELHI-62,HAVE** CORRECTED MY NAME AND SHALL BE HEREAFTER BE KNOWN AS LEONIE REBA DAS.

0040862652-6

**I,KOMAL KUMARI,D/O-Rajendra prasad sah,R/O 495,4th Floor,Ganesh. NAGAR-2,MADHUBAN Road Near-Naagar Properties shakarpur,DELHI-110092,have** changed my name to KOMAL Gupta.

0040862652-9

**I,Charan Singh S/o Shri Chhote Lal R/o** Servant Qtrs, 19, Akbar Road, New Delhi-11, have changed my son's name from "Aaryan" to "AARYAN SINGH" for all purposes

0050292022-1

**I,MEENU W/O NEERAJ MEHTA R/O-31, UGF, POCKET-11A, SECTOR-23, ROHINI, DELHI-110085,have** changed my name to MEENU MEHTA

0040862645-3

**I,LOVISH alias VIBHOR SHARMA,S/o-KAPIL SHARMA,R/O-446/2,Gali No.4 Bholu Nath Nagar,Shadhara East Delhi-110032,have** changed my name to VIBHOR SHARMA

0040862663-5

**I, Lalita, age 48, W/o Mr. Vineet tyagi, R/o** House no 0972, ATS Greens Village,Sector-93A, Expressway, Gautam Budhha Nagar, Noida-201304, have changed the name to Lalita tyagi for all future purposes.

0040862512-1

**I,SANTOSH DEVI,W/O-LATE SHRI OM PRAKASH SINGH,R/O-1/4921, GALI,NO-6,BALBIR-NAGAR EXTN,SHAHADRA, DELHI-10032,My** Correct-Name is SANTOSH DEVI. SANTOSH DEVI and SANTOSH,both are same-person.

0040862652-8

**I,NIDA HAROON W/O ATHAR SAEED R/O 1011-1012 GALI KHIRKI WALI H.H.H. BALLIMARAN, DELHI** 110006, have changed my name to NIDA ATHAR Permanently.

0071044051-1

**I,Sunita Kumari Yadav,D/O-Sanval Ram,W/o-Pawan Dev,R/o C-288,Phase-3,Sai Kunj,New Palam-Vihar, Gurugram (Haryana)-12017,** have changed my name to Sunita Kumari

0040862663-7

**I,REEMA D/O UDHAM SINGH W/O PAWAN KUMAR R/O N-114, DELTA-3, GREATER NOIDA, DISTRICT- GAUTAM BUDDHA NAGAR, UTTAR PRADESH-201308** HAVE CHANGED MY NAME FROM REEMA TO REEMA BHATI FOR ALL PURPOSES.

0071044056-1

**I,Shabana W/O Arif R/o** KH.NO-473/2, RAJIV NAGAR, BHALASWA DAIRY, Samai Pur, Delhi-110042 have changed my name to shabana begam.

0071044132-1

**I,Masroor Hasan Siddiqui R/o** 526, Hospital Road, Nai Basti, Lakhimpur, Kheri, UP-262701 have changed my name to Masrurul Hasan Siddiqui.

0071044116-1

**Vartika Kapoor W/o** AnkIt Dhawan R/o F2-1402,Cleo Country Sec-121, Gautam Budh Nagar Noida 201301, I have changed my name from Vartika Dhawan To Vartika Kapoor for all future purposes,

0040862556-1

### PUBLIC NOTICE

#### PUBLIC NOTICE

Notice is hereby given to the general public on behalf of our client Bank of Baroda, Nehru Place Branch, New Delhi, that the following immovable properties have been mortgaged by way of Equitable Mortgage in favour of the Bank as security for the credit facilities granted to M/s Geo Miller & Co. Ltd.

1. Industrial Plot No. 133, Block-D, measuring 399.83 Sq. Mtrs., situated at Okhla Industrial Area, Phase-I, New Delhi-110020, standing in the name of M/s CSR Marketing Pvt. Ltd.

2. Industrial Property bearing Khewla/Khata No. 229/235, measuring 26 Kanal 9 Marla (13,379.80 Sq. Mtrs.; 3.36/3 Acres), situated at Village Nizampur Tarni, Tehsil Tarni, District Nal, Haryana.

3. Residential Property bearing Plot No. 488, Sector-17, HUDRA, Faridabad, Haryana, measuring 500 Sq. Yards, together with the residential building constructed thereon, standing in the name of M/s Geo Miller & Co. Ltd.

Any persons(s), Bank(s), Financial Institution(s) or any other person claiming any right, title, interest, charge, lien, mortgage, lease, tenancy, encumbrance or objection in respect of the above properties are requested to submit their claims, along with supporting documents, to the undersigned within 15 days from the date of publication of this notice, failing which it shall be presumed that no such claim exists and the Bank shall proceed in accordance with law without any further reference.

Sd/-  
Gopal Bihari Advocate  
Counsel for Bank of Baroda  
Nehru Place Branch, New Delhi

**PUBLIC NOTICE**  
BE IT KNOWN TO ALL that any clients namely Sh. Vijay Kumar Jain and Smt. Anjali Jain, both residents of House No. P2-75A, First Floor, Indira Park, Uttam Nagar, New Delhi - 110058, have permanently severed all relations with their son Mr. Rohit Jain and daughter-in-law Mrs. Saahika Jain due to their conduct and behaviour. They have further disowned, disowned and disinherited them from all present and future movable and immovable properties, assets and affairs, and they shall have no right, title, interest or claim whatsoever therein. They shall not be responsible for any debt or representation, financial transaction, liability or obligation incurred by them. Any person dealing with them shall do so at their own risk and consequences.

Aditya Kapoor, Advocate  
Enrl No- D/2736/2017

**PUBLIC CAUTION NOTICE**  
Under provisions and as per order of my client Sh. Ishwar Chd Bhaurao, S/o Late Sh. Khuran Lal Bhaurao, P/o S-58, Second Floor, Marg No.14, Saket, New Delhi-110017, I hereby inform the general public that the original title/ownership documents of 10 Property bearing Kp/No. 45, 46, 47, 48, 49, 50, 51, 52, 53, 54, 55, 56, 57, 58, 59, 60, 61, 62, 63, 64, 65, 66, 67, 68, 69, 70, 71, 72, 73, 74, 75, 76, 77, 78, 79, 80, 81, 82, 83, 84, 85, 86, 87, 88, 89, 90, 91, 92, 93, 94, 95, 96, 97, 98, 99, 100, 101, 102, 103, 104, 105, 106, 107, 108, 109, 110, 111, 112, 113, 114, 115, 116, 117, 118, 119, 120, 121, 122, 123, 124, 125, 126, 127, 128, 129, 130, 131, 132, 133, 134, 135, 136, 137, 138, 139, 140, 141, 142, 143, 144, 145, 146, 147, 148, 149, 150, 151, 152, 153, 154, 155, 156, 157, 158, 159, 160, 161, 162, 163, 164, 165, 166, 167, 168, 169, 170, 171, 172, 173, 174, 175, 176, 177, 178, 179, 180, 181, 182, 183, 184, 185, 186, 187, 188, 189, 190, 191, 192, 193, 194, 195, 196, 197, 198, 199, 200, 201, 202, 203, 204, 205, 206, 207, 208, 209, 210, 211, 212, 213, 214, 215, 216, 217, 218, 219, 220, 221, 222, 223, 224, 225, 226, 227, 228, 229, 230, 231, 232, 233, 234, 235, 236, 237, 238, 239, 240, 241, 242, 243, 244, 245, 246, 247, 248, 249, 250, 251, 252, 253, 254, 255, 256, 257, 258, 259, 260, 261, 262, 263, 264, 265, 266, 267, 268, 269, 270, 271, 272, 273, 274, 275, 276, 277, 278, 279, 280, 281, 282, 283, 284, 285, 286, 287, 288, 289, 290, 291, 292, 293, 294, 295, 296, 297, 298, 299, 300, 301, 302, 303, 304, 305, 306, 307, 308, 309, 310, 311, 312, 313, 314, 315, 316, 317, 318, 319, 320, 321, 322, 323, 324, 325, 326, 327, 328, 329, 330, 331, 332, 333, 334, 335, 336, 337, 338, 339, 340, 341, 342, 343, 344, 345, 346, 347, 348, 349, 350, 351, 352, 353, 354, 355, 356, 357, 358, 359, 360, 361, 362, 363, 364, 365, 366, 367, 368, 369, 370, 371, 372, 373, 374, 375, 376, 377, 378, 379, 380, 381, 382, 383, 384, 385, 386, 387, 388, 389, 390, 391, 392, 393, 394, 395, 396, 397, 398, 399, 400, 401, 402, 403, 404, 405, 406, 407, 408, 409, 410, 411, 412, 413, 414, 415, 416, 417, 418, 419, 420, 421, 422, 423, 424, 425, 426, 427, 428, 429, 430, 431, 432, 433, 434, 435, 436, 437, 438, 439, 440, 441, 442, 443, 444, 445, 446, 447, 448, 449, 450, 451, 452, 453, 454, 455, 456, 457, 458, 459, 460, 461, 462, 463, 464, 465, 466, 467, 468, 469, 470, 471, 472, 473, 474, 475, 476, 477, 478, 479, 480, 481, 482, 483, 484, 485, 486, 487, 488, 489, 490, 491, 492, 493, 494, 495, 496, 497, 498, 499, 500, 501, 502, 503, 504, 505, 506, 507, 508, 509, 510, 511, 512, 513, 514, 515, 516, 517, 518, 519, 520, 521, 522, 523, 524, 525, 526, 527, 528, 529, 530, 531, 532, 533, 534, 535, 536, 537, 538, 539, 540, 541, 542, 543, 544, 545, 546, 547, 548, 549, 550, 551, 552, 553, 554, 555, 556, 557, 558, 559, 560, 561, 562, 563, 564, 565, 566, 567, 568, 569, 570, 571, 572, 573, 574, 575, 576, 577, 578, 579, 580, 581, 582, 583, 584, 585, 586, 587, 588, 589, 590, 591, 592, 593, 594, 595, 596, 597, 598, 599, 600, 601, 602, 603, 604, 605, 606, 607, 608, 609, 610, 611, 612, 613, 614, 615, 616, 617, 618, 619, 620, 621, 622, 623, 624, 625, 626, 627, 628, 629, 630, 631, 632, 633, 634, 635, 636, 637, 638, 639, 640, 641, 642, 643, 644, 645, 646, 647, 648, 649, 650, 651, 652, 653, 654, 655, 656, 657, 658, 659, 660, 661, 662, 663, 664, 665, 666, 667, 668, 669, 670, 671, 672, 673, 674, 675, 676, 677, 678, 679, 680, 681, 682, 683, 684, 685, 686, 687, 688, 689, 690, 691, 692, 693, 694, 695, 696, 697, 698, 699, 700, 701, 702, 703, 704, 705, 706, 707, 708, 709, 710, 711, 712, 713, 714, 715, 716, 717, 718, 719, 720, 721, 722, 723, 724, 725, 726, 727, 728, 729, 730, 731, 732, 733, 734, 735, 736, 737, 738, 739, 740, 741, 742, 743, 744, 745, 746, 747, 748, 749, 750, 751, 752, 753, 754, 755, 756, 757, 758, 759, 760, 761, 762, 763, 764, 765, 766, 767, 768, 769, 770, 771, 772, 773, 774, 775, 776, 777, 778, 779, 780, 781, 782, 783, 784, 785, 786, 787, 788, 789, 790, 791, 792, 793, 794, 795, 796, 797, 798, 799, 800, 801, 802, 803, 804, 805, 806, 807, 808, 809, 810, 811, 812, 813, 814, 815, 816, 817, 818, 819, 820, 821, 822, 823, 824, 825, 826, 827, 828, 829, 830, 831, 832, 833, 834, 835, 836, 837, 838, 839, 840, 841, 842, 843, 844, 845, 846, 847, 848, 849, 850, 851, 852, 853, 854, 855, 856, 857, 858, 859, 860, 861, 862, 863, 864, 865, 866, 867, 868, 869, 870, 871, 872, 873, 874, 875, 876, 877, 878, 879, 880, 881, 882, 883, 884, 885, 886, 887, 888, 889, 890, 891, 892, 893, 894, 895, 896, 897, 898, 899, 900, 901, 902, 903, 904, 905, 906, 907, 908, 909, 910, 911, 912, 913, 914, 915, 916, 917, 918, 919, 920, 921, 922, 923, 924, 925, 926, 927, 928, 929, 930, 931, 932, 933, 934, 935, 936, 937, 938, 939, 940, 941,

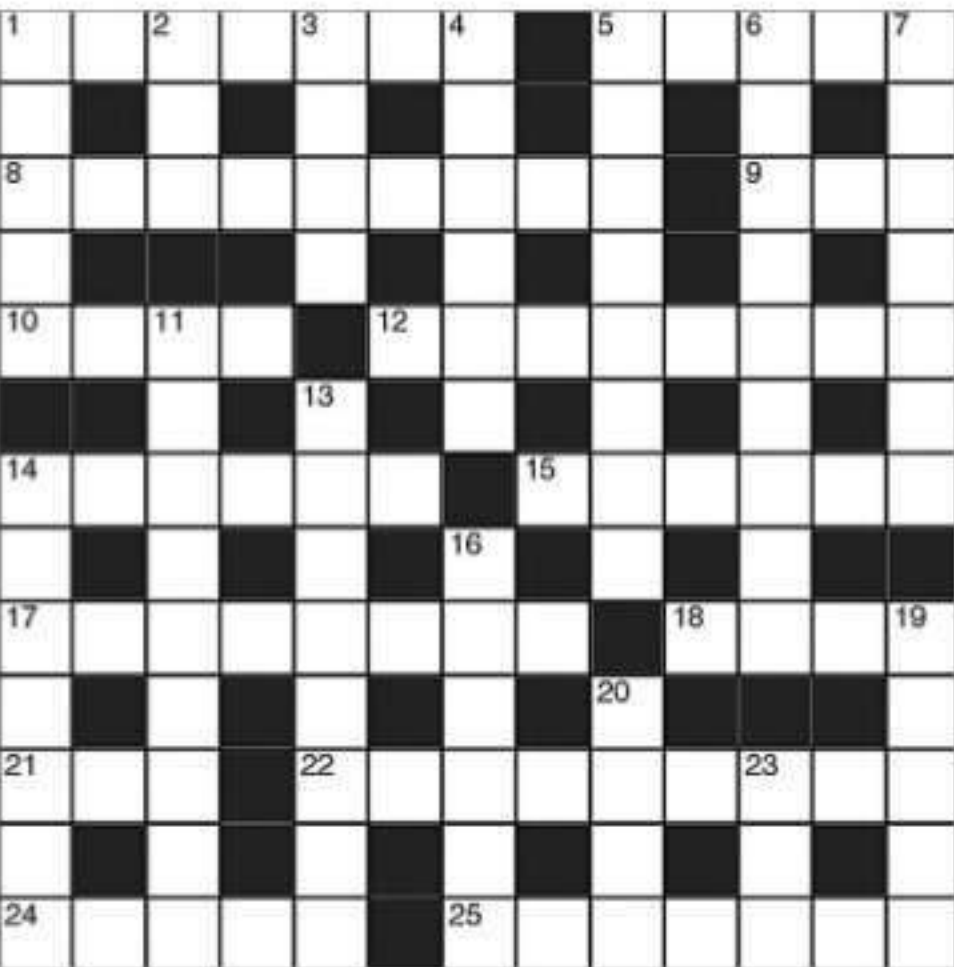






CROSSWORD

6025



- ACROSS
- 1 Sell pet remedy against slugs (7)
- 2 A class or form taking English (5)
- 8 It improves delivery (9)
- 9 The French maid's home address (3)
- 10 Do get directions to follow for amount to take (4)
- 12 Unwelcome in a ship but they pay for accommodation (8)
- 14 Steps inside? (6)
- 15 Frequent chaperon (6)
- 17 Avoid a tackle from the team and stride on (8)
- 18 Stop — this is a hold-up! (4)
- 21 I say nothing (3)
- 22 Get married without desire? Must be under a spell (9)
- 24 Stray around in the woods perhaps (5)
- 25 Pull out to watch returning New Yorkers in play (7)
- DOWN
- 1 Quietly start to pray (5)
- 2 A man the French love (3)
- 3 We must admit these birds can't fly (4)
- 4 Some canvas or tar (6)
- 5 Study an island made of sand and cement (8)
- 6 New Testament account (9)
- 7 Pardoned and released (7)
- 11 Refuses to agree to projects (6,3)
- 13 Helps to define the goal of angry lawyers (8)
- 14 Members of the family I stress are different (7)
- 16 Main road? (6)
- 19 Perhaps some go round a number of ways (5)
- 20 School of exceptional note (4)
- 23 Use speed and get turned on we hear (3)

SOLUTIONS CROSSWORD 6024 ACROSS: 1 Croakers, 5 Plea, 9 Route, 10 Peasant, 11 Second person, 13 Octets, 14 Twirls, 17 Moneylenders, 20 Romance, 21 Index, 22 Eddy, 23 Elegists DOWN: 1 Carp, 2 Opulent, 3 Keep on trying, 4 Rapids, 6 Leads, 7 Astonish, 8 Paper wedding, 12 Commerce, 15 Reredos, 16 Cereal, 18 Nomad, 19 Axis

JUMBLED WORDS

Given below are four jumbled words. Solve the jumbles to make proper words and move them to the respective circles below. Select the letters in the shaded circles and jumble them to get the answer for the given quip.

Boys will be boys, and so will a lot of \_\_\_ \_ men.  
- Kin Hubbard (6-4)

LVAAE

LANDED

CHDIL

GNOMIC

ANSWER: Boys will be boys, and so will a lot of middle-aged men. - Kin Hubbard

OVER THE HEDGE



CALVIN & HOBBS



MARVIN



DIFFICULTY LEVEL 3s INSTRUCTIONS

To solve a Sudoku puzzle, every digit from 1 to 9 must appear in each of the nine vertical columns, in each of the nine horizontal rows and in each of the nine boxes.

DIFFICULTY LEVEL

1s = Very easy; 2s = Easy; 3s = Medium; 4s = Hard; 5s = Very Hard; 6s = Genius

SUDOKU 6361

|   |   |   |   |   |  |   |   |   |
|---|---|---|---|---|--|---|---|---|
|   |   |   | 6 | 2 |  |   |   |   |
|   | 5 | 9 |   | 4 |  | 8 | 3 |   |
| 6 |   |   |   |   |  |   |   | 2 |
|   | 3 |   |   |   |  | 2 |   |   |
|   | 2 | 4 |   | 8 |  | 1 | 7 |   |
|   | 8 |   |   |   |  |   | 4 |   |
| 7 |   |   |   |   |  |   |   | 4 |
|   | 4 | 1 |   | 7 |  | 5 | 6 |   |
|   |   |   | 8 | 4 |  |   |   |   |

SOLUTION SUDOKU 6360

|   |   |   |   |   |   |   |   |   |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 6 | 2 | 4 | 3 | 9 | 8 | 1 | 5 | 7 |
| 7 | 8 | 9 | 6 | 5 | 1 | 3 | 4 | 2 |
| 1 | 3 | 5 | 2 | 4 | 7 | 8 | 6 | 9 |
| 4 | 1 | 2 | 5 | 6 | 3 | 9 | 7 | 8 |
| 3 | 7 | 8 | 4 | 1 | 9 | 6 | 2 | 5 |
| 9 | 5 | 6 | 7 | 8 | 2 | 4 | 3 | 1 |
| 8 | 4 | 3 | 9 | 7 | 5 | 2 | 1 | 6 |
| 5 | 6 | 1 | 8 | 2 | 4 | 7 | 9 | 3 |
| 2 | 9 | 7 | 1 | 3 | 6 | 5 | 8 | 4 |

BY MICHAEL FRY & T LEWIS

BY BILL WATTERSON

BY TOM ARMSTRONG

ROYAL STARS

BY GEORGIA NICOLS

ARIES (MAR 21 - APR 20): This morning, you might feel concerned, even irritated about shared property or a money issue. As the day progresses, you feel warm-hearted, especially to family. Accidents and travel changes might occur late in the day. Tonight: Explore and learn.

TAURUS (APR 21 - MAY 21): Be patient with partners and close friends this morning. As the day wears on, you'll enjoy conversations and short trips. Keep an eye on your possessions to protect yourself against loss at the end of the day. Tonight: Check your finances.

GEMINI (MAY 22 - JUNE 21): Today begins with optimism with your work, your health or a pet. You might see how to boost your income. Unexpected events with partners and close friends will occur. Tonight: Listen and cooperate.

CANCER (JUNE 22 - JULY 23): You'll wake up with playful optimism this morning. Challenges with kids or romantic partners might put a damper on your mood. Later in the day, unexpected changes, high-tech glitches, staff shortages and power outages are likely. Tonight: Get organised

LEO (JULY 24 - AUG 23): Enjoy a second cup of your morning brew and count your blessings. Avoid tension with parents and authority figures. As the day wears on, social plans suddenly change. Parents should be vigilant to avoid children's accidents. Tonight: Socialise.

VIRGO (AUG 24 - SEP 23): You're full of big ideas this morning. You might want to take a short trip. Avoid arguments about politics, religion and controversial issues. Stock the fridge, because late in the day, something unexpected might change your home routine. Tonight: Relax.

LIBRA (SEP 24 - OCT 23): This morning you have a warm feeling in your tummy about your finances. However, you might have a quarrel with someone about money or something you own. Avoid accidents — verbal or physical. Tonight: Conversations.

SCORPIO (OCT 24 - NOV 23): Steer clear of arguments with partners and close friends. Late in the day, stay alert to avoid something unexpected that impacts your money and possessions. Tonight: Check your possessions.

SAGITTARIUS (NOV 24 - DEC 22): This day begins in a gentle way that makes you feel good. You might be annoyed with a co-worker, but it's minor. You'll feel restless and impulsive. An unexpected exchange with a spouse or partner might catch you off guard. Tonight: You win.

CAPRICORN (DEC 23 - JAN 20): It's a friendly morning. You have much to look forward to. Be patient with kids and romantic partners. However, something unexpected might affect your job, health or pet. Be alert. Tonight: Privacy.

AQUARIUS (JAN 21 - FEB 19): Today, people will admire you, especially at work. Don't get sucked into arguments with bosses or supervisors. Later in the day, parents should be vigilant about their kids. Social plans might suddenly change. Tonight: Be friendly.

PISCES (FEB 20 - MAR 20): You might be excited about travel plans or doing something socially. Perhaps romance is in the air. It's a nice way to begin your day. Avoid arguments later in the day, especially if your home routine is interrupted. Tonight: You're admired.

**The Brihanmumbai Electric Supply & Transport Undertaking**  
(OF THE BRIHANMUMBAI MAHANAGARPALIKA)

**TENDER NOTICE**

**E-tenders are invited for the supply of following items.**

1) 81876 - Triennial Rate Contract for Outsourcing of Repairing of Underground L.V. Cable Faults in the area of Electric Supply Distribution of the BEST Undertaking, Mumbai,

**Re – invited e-tenders**

(2) 81537.

**Note:** For more details, log on to website <https://mahatenders.gov.in>

**PRO/AAM(M)/38/2026**

**GENERAL MANAGER**

**PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON**

(See Section 82 Cr. P.C./84 BNSS)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that the accused **Wasim** S/o Yunus R/o Property No. 1117, Mandi Pilkhuwa Dehat, Distt.-Hapur, Uttar Pradesh has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 320/2025 U/s 420/467/468/471/34 IPC, PS Sarai Rohilla, Delhi** and it has been returned to warrant of arrest there upon issued that the said accused **Wasim** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Wasim** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that **Wasim** in **FIR No. 320/2025 U/s 420/467/468/471/34 IPC, PS Sarai Rohilla, Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **04.08.2026**.

By order  
**Sh. Rangat Ghirra**  
Judicial Magistrate First Class-04  
Central, Room No. 513  
Tis Hazari Court, New Delhi

**DP/7733/N/2026**

**PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON**

(See Section 82 Cr. P.C./84 BNSS)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that the accused **Jishan** S/o Rauf Chaudhary R/o H. No. 558, Gali No.5 A-Block, Khadda Colony, Jaitpur, New Delhi has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 31/2024 U/s 356/379/411 IPC, PS Okhla Industrial Area, Delhi** and it has been returned to warrant of arrest there upon issued that the said accused **Jishan** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Jishan** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that **Jishan** in **FIR No. 31/2024 U/s 356/379/411 IPC, PS Okhla Industrial Area, Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **29.07.2026**.

By order  
**Ms. Akansha Gautam**  
Judicial Magistrate First Class  
South East District, Room No. 513  
Saket Courts Complex, Delhi

**DP/7925/SE/2026**

**PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON**

(SEE SECTION 82(2)(ii) Cr.P.C)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person(s) **RAVI TIWARI** S/o Shyam Sunder R/o H.No. 16/215, I-Block, Bapa Nagar & Gali No. 2, Pyare Lal Road, Karol Bagh, New Delhi has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 99/2023, PS Karol Bagh, Central Distt. New Delhi** and it has been returned to a Warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused person(s) **RAVI TIWARI** can not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person(s) **RAVI TIWARI** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused person(s) **RAVI TIWARI** of **FIR No. 99/2023, PS Karol Bagh, Central Distt. New Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before dated **30.09.2026 at 10:00 AM**.

By Order  
**Sh. Nishat Bangarh**  
Ld. Judicial Magistrate First Class-01  
Room No. 180, Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi

**DP/8070/CD/2026 (Court Matter)**

**PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON**

See Section 82(2) (ii) Cr. P.C./84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita

Whereas a complaint has been made before me that accused persons namely **Harsh Kumar** S/o Sh. Pawan Kumar R/o H.No. 3429, Gali Matiyam, Delhi Gate, Daryaganj, Delhi have committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence under **FIR No. 300/23 U/s 406/420/419/120B/34 IPC.,** has been registered at **PS: Lahori Gate, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest there upon issued that the said, **Harsh Kumar** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said, **Harsh Kumar** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused, **Harsh Kumar** under **FIR No. 300/23 U/s 406/420/419/120B/34 IPC.,** registered at **PS: Lahori Gate, Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **27.07.2026**.

By Order  
**Ms. Payal Singhal**  
JMFC-9 (Central), Room No. 286  
Tis Hazari Court, Delhi

**DP/8483/N/2026 (Court Notice)**

**PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON**

See Section 82 Cr.P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Mukul**, S/o: Chaterpal, R/o: H. No. 100, Mandir Wali Gali, Azadpur, Adarsh Nagar, New Delhi has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 540/21 U/s 186/353/307/34 IPC, P.S.: Uttam Nagar, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Mukul** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Mukul** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Mukul** accused of offence in case **FIR No. 540/21 U/s 186/353/307/34 IPC, P.S.: Uttam Nagar, Delhi** and is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **01.08.2026**.

By Order  
**Ms. Shivali Bansal**  
Additional Sessions Judge-02  
Court No. 04, Dwarka Court, Delhi

**DP/8462/DW/2026 (Court Matter)**

**PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON**

See Section 82(2) (ii) Cr. P.C./84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita

Whereas a complaint has been made before me that accused persons namely **Uma** W/o Ashu R/o Gali No. 3, Sigrí Fatak, Modi Nagar, UP have committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence under **FIR No. 462/2025 Dt. 22.07.2025 U/s 137(2)/143/144/64/337/339/61 Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita & 6/21 Pocco Act & 9/10 Prohibition of Child Marriage Act 2006,** has been registered at **PS: Bharat Nagar, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest there upon issued that the said, **Uma** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said, **Uma** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused, **Uma** under **FIR No. 462/2025 Dt. 22.07.2025 U/s 137(2)/143/144/ 64/ 337/ 339/61 Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita & 6/21 Pocco Act & 9/10 Prohibition of Child Marriage Act 2006** registered at **PS: Bharat Nagar, Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **03.08.2026**.

By Order  
**Ms Rajani Ranga**  
ASJ-01 (North-West), Room No. 210  
2<sup>nd</sup> Floor, Rohini Court, Delhi

**DP/8589/NW/2026 (Court Notice)**

**OFFICE OF SUPERINTENDING ENGINEER PWD CIRCLE SIKAR**

No. 652 Date: 12-06-2026

**NOTICE INVITING BID**

Budget Announcement 2026-27 road work of Sikar District is invited from interested bidders from dated 16.06.2026 at 09:30 AM upto dated 07.08.2026 at 06:00 PM, other particulars of the bid may be visited on the procurement portal (<http://eproc.raajasthan.gov.in>, <http://sppp.raj.nic.in>) of the state; and [pwr.raajasthan.gov.in](http://pwr.raajasthan.gov.in) departmental website. The approximate value of the procurement is Rs. 1070.22 Lacs.

NIB No. PWD2627A1127

UBN No. PWD2627WSOB04821, PWD2627WSOB04822, PWD2627WSOB04829, PWD2627WSOB04831, PWD2627WSOB04832, PWD2627WSOB04833

Sd/- (J.P. Yadav)  
Superintending Engineer  
PWD Circle Sikar

**DIPRC/1187/2026**

**भा.वा.अ.सि.प. – वन अनुसंधान संस्थान**  
**वन रक्षक एवं प्रबंधन प्रभाग**  
**डाकवर न्यू फॉरेस्ट, देहरादून-248006**

अतिरिक्त संच- 0-7 / 2026-27 रोज/सिल्ला /77 दिनांक: 25-06-2026

**प्रकाश एवं जलावन नीलामी सूचना**

सर्वसाधारण को सूचित किया जाता है कि वन अनुसंधान संस्थान के रोज डिपो में गोल प्रकाश व जलावन के लॉट की नीलामी दिनांक **10.07.2026** को प्रातः 10:30 बजे वन क्षेत्राधिकारी, वन सर्वेक्षण एवं प्रबंधन प्रभाग के कार्यालय में संपादित की जाएगी।

सभी बोली दाताओं को रु 10,000/- (रुपये दस हजार) मात्र सगद अग्रिम धनराशि जमानत के रूप में बोली से पहले जमा करना होगा। कोई भी बोलीदाता तब तक बोली लगाने का पात्र नहीं होगा जब तक कि गेट मनी की राशि जमा नहीं कर देते। नीलामी में सम्मिलित होने वाले ठेकेदारों का पैम कार्ड नं०, आधार नं० एवं GST रजिस्ट्रेशन नं० होना अनिवार्य है।

उच्चतम बोलीदाता को बोली की 10% राशि जमानत के रूप में बोली छूटने के तुरंत बाद जमा करनी होगी तथा शेष राशि बिक्री स्वीकृति होने के 15 दिन के अंदर जमा करनी होगी। बिक्री के समय लागू नियमों एवं दसों के अनुसार देय समस्त करों (GST एवं TCS इत्यादि) की धनराशि अतिरिक्त से देय होगी। विस्तृत जानकारी के लिए वन क्षेत्राधिकारी रोज कार्यालय, वन अनुसंधान संस्थान देहरादून के कार्यालय (office phone नं० 01352224418) से संपर्क करें। अन्य विदेश नीलामी के दिन नीलामी हॉल में घोषित किए जाएंगे।

प्रमाण प्रमुख  
वन सर्वेक्षण एवं प्रबंधन प्रभाग  
वन अनुसंधान संस्थान देहरादून

**BEFORE THE NATIONAL COMPANY LAW TRIBUNAL, CHANDIGARH BENCH, COURT-I**

**CP (IB) No. 143/Chd/Hry/2026**

**IN THE MATTER OF :**  
**UNION BANK OF INDIA**  
Versus  
**KOTKAPURA MUKTSAR TOLLWAYS PRIVATE LIMITED**  
...Petitioner  
...Respondent / Corporate Debtor

**NOTICE**

Whereas the above-captioned Petition under Section 7 of the Insolvency and Bankruptcy Code, 2016 has been filed by **Union Bank of India** seeking initiation of Corporate Insolvency Resolution Process against **Kotkapura Muktsar Tollways Private Limited** and is pending before the Hon'ble National Company Law Tribunal, Chandigarh Bench, Court-I. And whereas, vide Order dated **11.06.2026**, the Hon'ble Tribunal has directed that in the event service through Speed Post is not effected, substituted service be effected through publication in two daily newspapers (One English and One Hindi) having wide circulation in the area. The matter is fixed for hearing on **01.07.2026**.

Accordingly, notice is hereby given to **Kotkapura Muktsar Tollways Private Limited**, having its Registered Office at 510, 5<sup>th</sup> Floor, ABW Tower, IFFCO Chowk, M. G. Road, Gurugram -122002, Haryana, to appear either in person or through an authorised representative / counsel before the Hon'ble National Company Law Tribunal, Chandigarh Bench, Court-I, and file its reply within one week from the date of receipt/publication of this notice, with an advance copy to the counsel for the Petitioner, failing which the matter shall be proceeded with in accordance with law.

For Union Bank of India  
Through Counsel  
Legal Prism, Solicitors & Advocates  
Office No. 19, 2nd Floor New Bansal Building  
Raja Bahadur Compound Homi Modi Street,  
Fort, Mumbai-400 023  
Date : 25.06.2026  
Place : Mumbai  
E: [dsaxena@legalprism.co.in](mailto:dsaxena@legalprism.co.in)



● RESULTS

GROUP B

Bosnia & Herzegovina 3-1 Qatar  
Seattle Stadium

Switzerland 2-1 Canada  
Vancouver Stadium

GROUP C

Morocco 4-2 Haiti  
Atlanta Stadium

Scotland 0-3 Brazil  
Miami Stadium

GROUP A

Czechia 0-3 Mexico  
Mexico City Stadium

South Africa 1-0 South Korea  
Monterrey Stadium

● MATCH SCHEDULE

GROUP I

Norway vs France  
Boston, 12.30 am

(Saturday)

Senegal vs Iraq  
Toronto, 12.30 am

(Saturday)

GROUP H

Cape Verde vs Saudi Arabia  
Houston, 5.30am

(Saturday)

Uruguay vs Spain  
Guadalajara, 5.30am

(Saturday)

GROUP G

Egypt vs Iran  
Seattle, 8.30am

(Saturday)

New Zealand vs Belgium  
Vancouver, 8.30am

(Saturday)

ZEE5 OTT & UNITE8 CHANNELS



Mateo Chavez celebrates. AP

## Mexico remain perfect and kick Czechs out of WC

MEXICO CONTINUED their perfect start to the World Cup with a 3-0 romp against a hapless Czech Republic on Wednesday, finishing their group-stage campaign with a flourish. The co-hosts had already booked their spot in the last 32 as Group A winners but showed no mercy at the Azteca stadium to complete a third straight victory that left the sorry Czechs bottom of the standings and out of the tournament. REUTERS

## Bosnia end Qatar dreams, all but seal R-of-32 berth

BOSNIA AND Herzegovina kept their World Cup hopes alive thanks to a goal from Kerim Alajbegovic which powered them towards a 3-1 win over Qatar on Wednesday and secured third place in Group B. 18-year-old Alajbegovic broke the deadlock in the 29th minute firing an unstoppable shot, sending the Bosnian fans in the stadium wild. REUTERS

## CARRYING A NATION

# Vini Jr aims to be Vini Sr

Brazilian star underlines status as a phenomenon, now he wants to be on pedestal with country's greats



Sandip G  
Boston, June 25

THE CAMERAS trailed Vinicius Junior into the tunnel at half-time. He turned back with a waspish smile and held up three fingers. He had scored twice, but the goal VAR had chalked off — for a contentious nudge on defender Jack Hendry when he stole the ball — was still playing in his mind. Before he disappeared, he stopped beside the assistant referee and wagged his index finger with a sarcastic smile. It was not the numerical allure of a hat-trick that was disturbing him. It was the wider, intangible significance. Every goal scored takes him, or any Brazilian, closer to gaining unconditional love from their demanding fans. Every goal scored is another crucifixion passed. Every goal takes him closer to the pedestal of Brazilian greats. At no stage — not in leagues at home or Europe, not in crowns for individual glory — does a



Vinicius Junior has scored in all three of Brazil's group stage games. AP

player win the fans' heart more than with goals in a World Cup. Neymar once said: "The shirt is heavier when you play for Brazil in a World Cup." Especially when you are the leading light, as Vinicius is, but not yet fully validated by the public. The public needs moments and memories, not merely goals. Vinicius may not have known it, but had he scored that hat-trick, he could have been the first Brazilian since Pele in 1958 to score three goals in a World Cup game. An invisible line would have connected him and Pele. Brazil's third eventually came from Matheus Cunha, wrapping up their most emphatic day at this World Cup. But it was an evening Vinicius confirmed he was the figurehead — that on days like

these, he could trim his frills and be a cold-eyed finisher. The two goals will not make it into YouTube reels, but they demonstrated the layers of his craft. The first came from a defensive horror. A careless touch from Scott McKenna near the box allowed Rayan, a 19-year-old from a favela in Rio de Janeiro, to steal the ball and pass to Vinicius. He collected it, went round goalkeeper Angus Gunn and lashed it into the net. Nothing spectacular. But watch his touches: piercing and minimalistic, nothing wasted, neither energy nor space. He controlled it with his right, then slid it away with the outside of his right foot. Both touches were velvet-light. No fury exerted on the ball. "He is the most decisive player in the

world," Carlo Ancelotti has said. It was hard to argue. "It's his torque," Brazil's assistant coach Francesco Mauri noted before the World Cup. "He's a phenomenon in how he uses it. He doesn't need to wind up the shot a lot in order to generate power. After controlling it, he doesn't waste time winding up. He uses his ankle and manages to place it and score." His ankles contort as though they are made of wax. The great Ronaldinho too possessed rubbery ankles — little coincidence that both were groomed in the narrow courts of futsal, where close control is a requisite. Rayan, too, began his development at Vasco on futsal courts. Three generations of the same school. The second was a humdrum header from a delightful cross by

Bruno Guimarães. Vinicius, not renowned for thunderbolt headers, was a fraction late. But he leapt just enough to divert the ball goalwards, then pointed an imaginary gun at his head before the customary foot taps ensued. He had made the run from deep after completing his defensive chores. His speed goes understated. His is not an athlete's stride like Mbappe's. He does not seem to move his legs but glides at annihilating speed. There was an instance in the second half when he gleamed past a press of Scottish shirts, received the ball on the run and passed to Matheus Cunha, whose shot the goalkeeper blocked — but here was Vinicius almost at the other end, willing it in. A gorgeous side-footed pass in his own half released Guimarães, even if the move melted away. As with the two goals, he was there when Brazil needed him. There are senior figures around him: Casemiro, Marquinhos, Alisson Becker. But Vinicius sealed his leadership with action and example. He guided the young Rayan through his first World Cup night. He exhorted Cunha to calm down. He urged the crowd to raise the decibels. This was an evening he felt the unconditional love of the Brazilian fans. The missing third goal will hurt him. Before walking away, he again held up three fingers. The magic number that would have linked him and Pele, a legacy passed on. But Vinicius is lighting up this tournament — not in the extravagant insouciance of Brazilian football myth, but in a minimalistic manner that could make them a force again.



## Imperfectly perfect South Africa qualify for the Round of 32

Shuvaditya Bose  
New Delhi, June 25

BARELY ANY facet of South Africa's 1-0 win over South Korea resembled perfection. Certainly not their football. They had 31.5% ball possession — the lowest ever for the team at a World Cup game. The goal itself was hardly perfect, either. The goal-scorer, Thapelo Maseko's first touch was much heavier than ideal. His shot was laced with venom and spite, but it could have been saved if the goalkeeper had positioned himself correctly. Yet, for all their imperfections, South Africa have qualified for the knockouts of the 2026 FIFA World Cup — a statement you would not have believed, had it been furnished in the immediate aftermath of their embarrassing defeat to Mexico. It raises an intriguing question: would they have achieved what they have, becoming only the seventh African nation to reach a World Cup knockout stage, had they been perfect? Maseko most definitely has not had a perfect career so far. It once seemed it would. He was the youngest player in South Africa's 2023 AFCON squad. Given his inexperience, not many expected him to play. Not only did he do so, but he also scored. That, too, with his family in attendance.

the national team. Upon recovering, Sithole acknowledged: "I thought the injury was the end of my career. It was tough mentally." Today, he ran his socks off. And we do not mention the phrase generically. Data backs the claim — 11.43 kilometres covered, 1.88 kilometres of those in high speed; 53 passes, 49 of those successful. In all of these metrics, he leads the charts among South Africans.

### Different path

Coach Hugo Broos has not had a perfect career either. He was sacked as Cameroon manager barely ten months after guiding the nation to its first AFCON title in 15 years. Following a disappointing Confederations Cup campaign, FECAFOOT replaced him with Rigobert Song. His first application to become South Africa's coach was rejected. SAFA went with Stuart Baxter. Only at the second attempt did South Africa hand him the reins. Today, he is second to only Ephraim Mashaba in points-per-game among Bafana Bafana managers to spend at least a year in charge.

Neither of these men has been perfect, nor has their game against South Korea. Perhaps, though, imperfection is something the country has become accustomed to having accentuated. At a White House meeting last year, US President Donald Trump accused South Africa of committing the "opposite of Apartheid." In his defence, Cyril Ramaphosa did try to put up a case on why the allegations of 'white genocide' are false, but he was not listened to.

The imbalance of power meant Ramaphosa was never likely to dominate that conversation. Not against arguably the most powerful man in the world. But when Broos was asked the same question — bizarrely, in the pre-match press conference that had nothing to do with politics — he came up with a genius reply. "I will answer that question," he said at first. Silence filled the room. Now, the Americans were listening. Eagerly awaiting what he has to say. South Africa's media officer may already have been drafting contingency statements. And then came the answer: "My answer is that I will not answer the question." The imperfect South African team is at the knockouts of the World Cup. And they are under no obligation to explain how they got there.

# Boston falls in love with Scotland's Tartan Army

Sandip G  
Boston, June 25

MILES AWAY from Miami, where Brazil beat Scotland 3-0 and damaged their knockout hopes, Boston mourned. In a week in the city, where Scotland played Morocco and Haiti in the group stage, the Tartan Army had captured Bostonians' hearts so completely that Mayor Michelle Wu signed a letter of intent to make Glasgow and Boston sister cities. After Scotland's final group game in Boston against Morocco, *The Boston Globe* devoted a full page to thanking them. It read: "You came for the World Cup, but gave us something more. For a week, you turned train stations into singalongs, Fenway into a football ground, and an ordinary June into something we will be talking about for years. The World Cup will move on. So will the songs, but we will never forget the joy you brought to our city." Patriots owner Robert Kraft has petitioned the NFL to play a regular season game at Glasgow's Hampden Park. The Boston Red Sox wrote to the Scotland Football Association. "What happened at Fenway Park on June 14th was something none of us will forget. We knew the Tartan Army was coming. We

## Scotland's World Cup revelry makes sports city of Boston smitten.



The Boston Globe's letter to the the Tartan army (L). Scotland fans at Fenway Park (R). REUTERS



did not fully understand what that meant until we saw it." Red Sox president Sam Kennedy said. The Scots had marched to Fenway, filled the stands and revelled throughout, elevating the atmosphere beyond anything most of them had known. Governor Maura Healey joined the spirit, sitting down with a Scottish podcaster and signing what she called an executive order declaring haggis legal in Massachusetts — clarifying the next morning it was a joke. On Change.org, a petition started: "Build a Tartan Army statue on the waterfront."

Massachusetts senator Paul Feeney went further, proposing that they return every year. Around 50,000 arrived for their two games against Haiti and Morocco, spending six days in the city. Dressed in kilts and playing bagpipes, they swarmed public spaces and interacted with locals. They donated \$10,000 to Hasbro Children's Hospital. They set a new trend too, placing a traffic cone on the statue of Boston Celtics legend Bill Russell outside City Hall. Even Mayor Wu admitted: "I think we may see some lingering traditions from their visit, and I

have to admit, I also put a cone on Bill Russell's head outside City Hall. So, it's been fun." Benjamin Franklin and Abraham Lincoln were not spared either. It is a Scottish tradition dating from the 1970s, when a group of revellers placed a cone on the statue of Arthur Wellesley, the Duke of Wellington. The pubs almost ran dry. Boston Beer Co. said that in just four days the Tartan Army drank the equivalent of four times the company's 4th of July sales. Devon Savage, from Boston Beer, told NBC Boston: "We had to schedule an emergency de-

livery on Saturday morning." Haven, a Scottish pub in Jamaica Plain, exhausted 65 kegs — in six days. Thomas Mathew, an Indian bartender at Boston's Public Tavern, says the week was unlike anything he had seen. "We had stocked up anticipating the tourists, but never imagined we would run dry. The day after the Haiti match, we ran out of beer. The shops shut around midnight, but they were here till morning. It was fun." He missed the sights and sounds, the swathes of fans, their lyrical English and their lilting music. "I have become a fan of them, though I have not watched any of their games," he says. "As we begin our journeys to South Florida, we hope it's not goodbye, but see you again soon," the Tartan Army wrote on X as they left. If Scotland progress as one of the best eight third-placed teams, there is a realistic chance they play in Boston again, though the defeat to Brazil has toughened that route. "We will never forget the week," says Jimmy Chang, who runs a restaurant in the city's Chinatown. He sighs: "I feel gutted for the fans with the way the team played." The whole of Boston would echo him. And they would live on a prayer. To host the Tartan Army again.

# Not just suits in the dugout PSYCHEDELIC PRINT, WAISTCOAT, WHITE TEE

Shivani Naik  
Mumbai, June 25

WHILE PLAYER jerseys reflect a nation's football philosophy, the outfits worn by managers at the 2026 World Cup are fashion statements of their own. Switzerland coach Murat Yakin had a giant P inscribed on his chest, a tribute to Pep Guardiola on the biggest stage. The tee was specially created by Pumatohonour Guardiola's ten years at Manchester City, and Yakin wore it proudly while defeating Canada 2-1. He had started in white, but was asked to switch to black since Canada were playing in white and it risked causing confusion on the touchline. Touchline fashion has

caught attention this tournament for its personalised touches. USA coach Mauricio Pochettino has come a long way from his famous Sky Sports declaration, "Suit or tracksuit, I look good. I am handsome." Not that far, though. The Argentine has stuck to a navy lightweight overshirt with matching wide-leg trousers and a white T-shirt, assembled by Hugo Boss. Brazil's Italian boss Carlo Ancelotti brought his Real Madrid suit to the Selecao dugout. The three-piece in Miami heat was very Italian, the signature waistcoat and big buttons projecting clockwork authority, with Vinicius Jr and Lucas Paqueta handling the rest. The suits are largely on

brand, with small variations. Didier Deschamps codes his in les bleus. Mexico's Javier Aguirre straps on a Mexican green tie. Canada's Jesse Marsch, whose thin black tie has been photographed whipping around as he sheds his coat, grows visibly more frustrated as his side test his patience. With Spain's Luis de la Fuente, the focus falls on the tie, a denim-print necktie dotted with tiny Spanish flags. He also wears a blue ribbon on his wrist, and his sneakers carry the colours of the Spanish flag. Beating every manager in the fashion stakes is Hervé Renard and his lucky white shirts. They brought scant luck to a broken Tunisia side, who had sacked their previous coach after



Managers at the World Cup have made fashion statements of their own. AP

the opening match before turning to Renard, but the man who won two Africa Cups of Nations with Zambia and Ivory Coast, simply belongs at a World Cup. He wears his rugged tan with a crisp, creaseless, seemingly sweatless white shirt over black trousers. Renard pairs the look with white sneakers, a trend shared by Thomas Tuchel and Graham Arnold. Tuchel, in fact, leads the all-black monochrome tendency, managers projecting authority to their players while receding into the background for everyone else. He is joined by Iran's Amir Ghalenoei, who makes a black jacket feel like a formal ensemble, and Egypt's Hossam Hassan. Uzbekistan's Fabio Cannavaro favours bicep-hugging black tees as well, though his real fashion statement has always been his tattoos.

The standout look of the tournament belongs to Japan's Hajime Moriyasu. The Japanese always arrive impeccably dressed, so the three-piece is expected. What makes Moriyasu the winner are his blue pin-striped shirts, understated signals of professionalism. Germany's Julian Nagelsmann, 38, has traded slim suits for baggy black tees and sweatpants, pragmatic perhaps, but a notable devolution. Brogues have given way to sports trainers. His white watch strap is the one flourish that remains. He has, however, bigger concerns. "I have the feeling that the lens is photographing my nose hairs from a distance of one centimetre," he said of the photographers. Keeping a composed face despite his striped psychedelic tee becoming meme fodder is Ecuador's Sebastian Beccacece. When the tournament began brightly, observers noted a resemblance to Messi with long blond hair. Now that results have turned, it is his outfits that are taking the heat.



## Jyothi finds redemption, seals Asiad spot



Jyothi Yarraji clocked 12.99s. AFI

**Prithish Raj**  
*Bhubaneswar, June 25*

IN THE women's 100m hurdles final at the Inter State National Championships, Jyothi Yarraji stared at the bigscreen after the race. Once it flashed 12.99s in front of her name, she fell on the track, virtually hugging it and feeling it.

The celebration showed how much it had meant to return to the track after a year-long layoff due to an anterior cruciate ligament (ACL) injury. She breezed through the hurdles to breach the Asian Games qualification mark and go under 13s in the final to claim the national title.

Last year, Jyothi was bound for the World Championships, but a freak injury during training, where she hit a hurdle, kept her away from the track. "I felt so good today. Interestingly, exactly one year back, I got injured and today I am here clocking sub 13s, it means a lot for me," Jyothi said. "I was expecting a better race. Something around 12.6s, but that's okay. I have been praying every day since I got injured on this day."

Jyothi was expected to return at the Federation Cup last month. However, a hamstring pull delayed her comeback. "I was planning to come back at the Federation Cup, but I pulled my hamstring. A big thanks to AFI, who allowed me to compete and always encouraged me," said Jyothi.

Jyothi's injury came as a big setback for Indian athletics, given that the calendar was packed with the Commonwealth Games and the Asian Games. "During my recovery, I was praying every day. A lot of thoughts came into my head. Is this the end of the journey? Is it all over for me? But I told myself that, no, there is a lot more for me there," said Jyothi.

When she got back on track, removing the mental fear became more important than the physical recovery. "When I started training again, I was scared of the hurdles. I used cushioning on the top of hurdles, so it doesn't hurt me. Even during the first race today, I was a little scared. But once I completed the race, my nerves calmed down," said Jyothi.

The one-year recovery has seen Jyothi return mentally tougher than before. "The reason I was able to run under 13s today is because I'm mentally stronger. While I'm not sure how much physically I have improved, this injury has made me 10 times strong mentally," she said. Jyothi, who trains at Reliance Foundation, received consistent support from her coach, James Hillier and the team behind the scenes.

# How her late father's dream spurred Sindhushree to break NR

**Prithish Raj**  
*Bhubaneswar, June 25*

G SINDHUSHREE became emotional when she broke the national record in the women's pole vault. Not just for entering the record books but also because she remembered her late father, an electrician who passed away three years ago.

When Ganesh R died following a heart attack, his dream of seeing his daughter represent the country remained unfulfilled. With 4.25 metres to better Baranica Elangovan's mark of 4.23 metres set in March this year, 25-year-old Sindhushree booked her Asian Games spot at the National Inter-State Championships in Bhubaneswar on Thursday.

As she was asked to pose for the pictures, an emotional Sindhushree reached out for

her bag and took out a passport size photo of her late father.

"It was my father's dream to see me representing India at the international level," an emotional Sindhushree told *The Indian Express* afterwards. "Today, when I have achieved that, he is not here to see that."

Post her father's death, the journey wasn't smooth for the Shivamogga native. "Pole Vault is an expensive sport. It is tough for me as only my grandparents support me and take care of the family. My mother is a tailor and it is difficult for her to manage," Sindhushree said.

Even the pole she used in the final was borrowed from another athlete because she couldn't afford a new one.

"I didn't have the right pole for my technique. Due to the financial constraints, I have been training with smaller poles. Be-

fore coming to the Inter State, I took a pole from my friend Rahul who also trains under my coach," Sindhushree said.

She trains at Bengaluru SAI Center under coach Vijeesh MM. "She perfected her technique with the small pole but since she has practiced a lot with that pole, it became loose. As she didn't have the longer pole, we had to work on her technique so she could adjust to the smaller pole," Vijeesh said. "Today, she had to reduce her steps on the runway to get her pole to give a perfect vault. She usually takes 16 steps but today she was doing it with 14."

The duo share a very strong bond as Sindhushree has complete trust in her coach. "My coach puts every bit of effort into training me. I started training under him in 2021 and since then I have improved. I started



Sindhushree shows her medal and father's photo. PRITHISH RAJ

with 3.30 metres and now I am vaulting over 4.25m," Sindhushree said. The coach believes she has potential to improve further. "A lot of people look at her and think that she is too short for a pole vaulter but it's a myth," Vijeesh said.

With a national record and Asian Games qualification in her bag, Sindhushree hopes

**“Due to the financial constraints, I have been training with smaller poles. Before coming to the Inter State, I took a pole from my friend.”**

**G SINDHUSHREE,**  
POLE VAULTER

that she gets access to better training facilities and equipment. "This national record means everything to me. It is going to change the fortunes of my family. With the national record, I think I will get more support and hopefully my diet and training facilities will improve. I will continue to train under my coach," she said.

# Teen spirit: Belfast revels in Sooryavanshi fever

**Ireland scrambles to cater to high demand as tickets sell out within minutes ahead of youngster's debut**

**Venkata Krishna B**  
*Chennai, June 25*

IN CRICKET Ireland's office, there is already a sense of missed opportunity. Since the India tour was finalised only towards the end of March, they couldn't slot the two T20Is at Dublin's Malahide cricket stadium, home to 12,000 seats which is now being taken up for a concert series.

Instead, as Vaibhav Sooryavanshi is on the cusp of making history by becoming the youngest-ever to play international cricket on Friday, they are finding ways to answer the overwhelming requests to find a seat at the Stormont cricket ground, which at the most can only accommodate 5,000.

When Cricket Ireland slotted the fixtures to Belfast, there were apprehensions whether the Indian diaspora would make the trip to the northern most part of the country. The recent violence around the area, only cast more doubts. Instead, ever since Sooryavanshi's name was included in India's touring party, the hype around the fixtures has been beyond Cricket Ireland's (CI) expectations.

"My phone is buzzing all the time with people looking for tickets," CI chair Brian MacNeice told *The Indian Express*. "Unfortunately, we can host only 4,500-5000 fans. We could have filled it three times over if we had the room for it. Tickets were sold in minutes and even now people are looking for tickets."

While all India fixtures tend to get traction in these parts, this time it is undoubtedly the presence of Sooryavanshi,



Captain Shreyas Iyer addresses the team huddle during training in Belfast on Thursday. (R) Vaibhav Sooryavanshi is set to make his India debut in T20Is against Ireland on Friday. BCCI/X

whose legend has travelled already to all parts of Ireland. Despite the FIFA World Cup being the big attention, that cricket is already being discussed among the public is largely down to the teenager.

"It's huge," MacNeice says when asked about what Sooryavanshi's arrival has done to the city. "Everybody's talking about it. He's obviously a really exciting talent. And that potentially he's making his debut tomorrow means people want to be in the 'I was there' moment. He's just grabbed everybody's attention."

### Temporary stands

The interest among the locals was such that for the game, CI held discussions with local government authorities to put up temporary stands. "All of the infrastructure that you'll see for the game tomorrow, is all temporary infrastructure that is put in specifically for the game. We had a couple of meetings with the government to get the permits," MacNeice said.

In many ways it is what Ireland cricket needed. With their focus firmly on the 50-over World Cup qualifiers, they are not scheduled to play any T20Is till 2027 summer. With almost half of their first team players injured, there were concerns if even a series against India

would help them a great deal. After all, this is a series that Ireland expects will help them host New Zealand and Afghanistan later in the summer as well as for the women's team.

The Sooryavanshi factor is so huge that during the time of the FIFA World Cup the Irish Times dedicated some space to the boy wonder. The BBC Northern Ireland has been cutting to cricket in the middle of its news broadcast.

Word around is that the Irish cricketers are already tired of answering most of their questions around Sooryavanshi. One of the questions that the BBC NI posted to Ireland opener Ross Adair was, "What is it like batting at Stormont? This fella (Sooryavanshi) wants to score a T20 double century on his debut?" The show host then points out to the windows of the club house saying, "those would be in danger if he plays the slog sweepers. And those straight boundaries are certainly hittable."

Nathan Johns, who covers cricket among other sports for The Irish Times sums up the mood in Belfast for the two fixtures to be held on Friday and Sunday. "It's quite funny. I get the sense the Irish players are a little bit sick and tired of being asked about Sooryavanshi. I think everybody is expecting



heavy defeats.

"When there's that lack of competition and the games don't mean as much, it's hard to sell to the general public. But when you throw in a 15-year-old, there are stories about him having to use his own changing room, his parents have to fly with him, all that type of stuff. Suddenly, people who might not necessarily be normally that into cricket are going, what is going on? Why is a 15-year-old here? Why are we hearing all these slightly crazy stories? The newspapers are slightly more interested. The local BBC radio station is more interested than normal," Johns notes.

With all the focus firmly on Sooryavanshi, it is now for the India team management to take the tough call. For the left-hander to make his international debut, one of Abhishek Sharma, Sanju Samson or Ishan Kishan — who were their top three at the T20 World Cup they won, needs to make way.

Having already dropped their captain Suryakumar Yadav, and a new era beginning under Shreyas Iyer, they already face a problem of plenty. Now, everything else also threatens to become a Sooryavanshi sideshow.

**India vs Ireland, first T20I, 6 PM onwards; live on Sony Sports**

# India beat Bangladesh to stay alive but fielding woes remain

**Shankar Narayan**  
*Mumbai, June 25*

NIGAR SULTANA Joty's heart must have known what the repercussions would be. Bangladesh's captain had just given Shafali Verma a life on the fourth ball of Marufa Akter's first over, failing to hold on to a catch that could have set the tone for Bangladesh's defence of their modest total of 136.

Instead, she watched from behind the stumps as the right-hander made her side pay for the reprieve. Shafali batted her way to 53 off 34 balls, taking the attack to Bangladesh and ensuring India never allowed the required rate to climb. Her innings laid the foundation for a nervy five-wicket victory in Manchester that kept India's semifinal hopes alive ahead of Sunday's must-win clash with Australia at Lord's.

Harmanpreet Kaur's team is in second place on the group table, with six points and a net run rate of +2.268.

Shafali signalled her intent almost immediately, thumping Marufa over extra cover for four before clearing her front leg to launch Shanjidia Akter Meghla over long-on for a 75-metre six. Boundaries through the offside followed with regularity as Bangladesh's bowlers repeatedly erred in length.

Shafali was particularly severe on anything overpitched, driving fluently through cover and extra cover, while width was punished with a series of crisp cuts. Her assault helped India race to 63/1 by the end of the Powerplay, effectively putting the chase on cruise control.

The Rohtak girl brought up her fifty off just 29 balls with another authoritative cut through extra cover. Her innings ended when she overbalanced while facing Nahida Akter and was stumped, but the damage had already been done.

Yastika Bhatia, again promoted to number three, made a steady 23, but with an eye on the net run rate, India promoted Richa Ghosh at number four. The promotion did not give the desired result, as the wicketkeeper-batter fell LBW

Vijeesh wants to improve further before she is completely ready for the Asian Games.

"4.25 metres is a good mark for her. She definitely has the potential to go further. A good thing about her is her resilience. She was stuck at 3.80m for a couple of years, however, she didn't give up," he said. "We figured out what was wrong. What she needs to improve on and we worked on it. Today, the result is here."

For Sindhushree, participation at the Asian Games is more than just realising a dream. "It is going to be a moment of a lifetime for me. Right now, I am soaking everything in," she quipped. With a borrowed pole, a passport photo of her late father, and dreams to have India on the back of her jersey, Sindhushree is ready to jump to greater heights.



Nandni Sharma (R) celebrates the wicket of Juairiya Ferdous. AP

for 10 to Rabeya Khan.

It took a fifth-wicket stand of 30 runs between Jemimah Rodrigues and Harmanpreet to help India cross the line in a match that nevertheless exposed lingering concerns about their ability to put together a complete performance.

### Fielding concerns

India's victory, however, did little to mask what had transpired in the field during the first innings. India's fielding woes, which proved costly against South Africa on Sunday, showed no signs of easing against Bangladesh. Having split two crucial chances in that defeat, they endured an even more forgettable start here, dropping four catches inside the first five overs.

Juairiya Ferdous was handed three reprieves. The first came when Yastika, running in from short fine leg, could only get a fingertip to a top-edged sweep.

Radha Yadav then put down a far more straightforward chance at deep midwicket, failing to cling on despite getting both hands to the ball.

Juairiya's luck continued when Nandni Sharma spilled a diving chance at short third after covering good ground to reach a skier.

One ball earlier, she had failed to hold on to a drive from Sobhana Mostary, who survived on one after a chance went down at cover.

The errors handed Bangladesh an early foothold. Juairiya made the most of her luck with 33, while Mostary chipped in

## Kujur qualifies for Asian Games

SPRINTER ANIMESH Kujur booked his berth for the Asian Games with a timing of 20.74s in the final. Animesh aimed to qualify for the Asian Games and wasn't looking to register a spectacular timing.

The qualification standard for the Asiad is 20.88s. In men's decathlon, Thowfeeq N and Kushal Mohite breached the qualification mark of 7,251 points for the Asian Games with 7,296 and 7,251 points respectively.

National record holder Mohammad Afsal P and Krishan Kumar also booked their berths in the 800 metres.

EXPRESS NEWS SERVICE

## { F I F A W O R L D C U P }

# Uruguay coach Bielsa, an enigma who is rated by Guardiola, disliked by Suarez

**Shuvaditya Bose**  
*New Delhi, June 25*

WHEN PEP Guardiola arrived at the house in Rosario, at his former teammate Gabriel Batistuta's insistence, he assumed he would only have a brief conversation on coaching. He was there for 11 hours instead. When Héctor and Amalia Pochettino heard a knock on their door at 1 am in Murphy, they feared one of two things: trouble or tragedy. Instead, they found a football coach, who had heard a lot about their 13-year-old son, Mauricio, and wanted to meet him.

Both Guardiola and Pochettino now regard the man they met as the best coach of all time.

Given their résumés — Guardiola being one of football's decorated managers, and Pochettino being a Ligue 1 champion — you would assume their shared idol ought to

be a serial winner. He is not. He is Marcelo Bielsa — a man with six major trophies in a managerial career spanning nearly four decades.

One could consider Bielsa a trailblazer who transcended conventional thinking to prove footballing success has little to do with trophies.

Or, is he a benefactor of a facade, with radical ideas that only work in theory but are inefficacious in reality?

We would never know.

Bielsa is expected to step down as Uruguay manager after the 2026 FIFA World Cup. Saturday's meeting with defending European champions Spain could be his final match on the touchline. If it is, he will depart as he lived — impossible to decipher and even harder to explain.

Under Bielsa, Uruguay began with promise, but it has since unravelled. They are staring at their first group stage exit

since 2002. Uruguay have drawn against Saudi Arabia and Cape Verde, and now face Spain.

### The madman

Colloquially known as 'El Loco,' or the madman, there is a bizarre legend behind the nomenclature. Then managing Newell's Old Boys, Bielsa oversaw a 6-0 defeat to San Lorenzo at the Copa Libertadores. Furious supporters gathered outside his home to confront him. They could barely believe what happened next. Bielsa showed up with a grenade, and threatened, "I will pull the pin if you don't go away."

Did it actually happen? We might never have a definitive answer. Such has been his life that exaggeration cannot be separated from reality. Instead, we could analyse the tenets of Bielsa's coaching philosophy, and draw our own conclusions. Bielsa has an obsession with



With Uruguay struggling, Saturday's meeting with Spain could be Marcelo Bielsa's final match on the touchline. AP

football. Among his earliest jobs was to scout talented kids for the Old Boys. He scoured through the entire nation with his Fiat 517, hunting for talent in forgotten towns and over-

looked fields. This is how Pochettino was discovered.

He also has a moral compass that remains untainted. Despite winning the league with Old Boys, he resigned be-

**Under Bielsa, Uruguay began with promise, but it has since unravelled. They are staring at their first group stage exit since 2002**

cause the club did not punish players when they broke curfew after attending a wedding. At the Athletic Club in Bilbao, he got into an argument with a construction worker. The disagreement was quickly forgotten by everyone involved. Everyone, except Bielsa. He showed up at the police station and demanded an arrest. Not the worker's, but his. Iker Muniain, then playing for Athletic, was asked by a journalist: "Is Bielsa really as mad as we all think?" The winger replied: "No. He is even madder."

In his own right, Bielsa is

also a rebel. Following Chile's impressive run at the 2010 World Cup, the squad was invited to La Moneda by President Sebastián Piñera. Players and staff queued to greet the country's first democratically elected right-wing president since the end of military rule, but Bielsa chose not to. Until he was almost forced.

Bielsa has never voiced his political position, though his values paint a picture. At Leeds United, Bielsa once ordered his players to spend three hours picking up litter around the city. The intention was simple — players must know roughly how long working-class supporters had to work to afford a match ticket.

At the World Cup, he is the only person who chose not to pose during the photoshoot. The reason was simple: "I'm not a model." Rebellion, as opposed to subservience.

Rosario, after all, is famous

not only as the birthplace of Lionel Messi, but also of Che Guevara. Luis Suarez, who has been a vocal critic of the Argentine, had urged fans: "I ask people not to take it out on the players if something goes wrong. Bielsa has separated the whole group."

Bielsa's response could not have been more Bielsa: "I'm a generator of tension. When I arrive, the environment becomes tense. I'm toxic. To associate yourself with me makes you worse off."

Who is Bielsa? To some, he is a prophet whose intellect and ideas shaped a generation of coaches. To some, he is the master of illusion, masquerading as a legend. Oscillating between a god and a fraud, Bielsa remains one of football's greatest paradoxes.

At Leeds, a Bielsa mural reads: "A man with new ideas is a madman, until his ideas triumph."